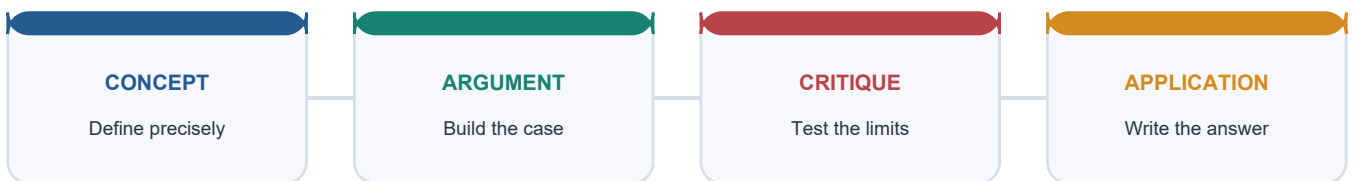


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Later Wittgenstein - Complete Learning Session

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section A | 13 teaching sessions, 32 diagnostics, 7 solved PYQs, 6 original Mains models and register notes

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Later Wittgenstein - Complete Learning Session

Syllabus, verbatim: *Later Wittgenstein : Meaning and Use; Language-games; Critique of Private Language* - UPSC Philosophy Paper I, Section A, item 8. Three printed limbs and one method. Meaning is investigated through **use**, uses are organised as **language-games**, and the critique of **private language** is what that investigation does when it is turned on the inner life. **Evidence discipline:** FACT: marks doctrine on which the standard sources converge, ANALYSIS: marks analytical reconstruction for exam use, and CAUTION: marks a live scholarly dispute or a contested attribution. Remarks are cited by **Section number**, because Part I numbering is identical across editions and translations, and works are cited by **author, title and year of composition and of publication** wherever the two differ - this topic is full of posthumous texts, and the examiner can test the gap. Model answers below are independent learner practice and are **never** official UPSC keys: UPSC publishes no descriptive model answer for Philosophy Paper I. **Terminology rule:** the English concept leads and the German term follows immediately in parentheses - *language-game (Sprachspiel)*, *form of life (Lebensform)*, *family resemblance (Familienähnlichkeit)*, *criterion (Kriterium)*, *symptom (Symptom)*, *avowal (Äußerung)*, *surroundings (Umgebung)*, *the dawning of an aspect (das Aufleuchten eines Aspekts)*, *when language idles or goes on holiday (wenn die Sprache feiert)*. Wittgenstein wrote in German; the *Investigations* is a **posthumous compilation**, so a rendering is always reported as a rendering and never as the author's printed English.

What this package contains

Component	Count
Progressive teaching sessions in the Basic block	13
Original diagnostic MCQs - 24 core plus 8 remedial drills	32
Question-specific option explanations	128
Unique examiner traps	32
Directly owned verified PYQs solved in full, 2018-2025	7
Supporting routed parts that bear on this clause but are owned elsewhere	3
Original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	6
Consolidated register parts	13 (A-M)
ASCII master flow panels authored	33

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

CONCEPT SPINE - ENGLISH FIRST, SOURCE TERM IMMEDIATELY AFTER

captive - 123 'I don't know my way about' - 255 treatment of an illness - 309 show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle - 124 'philosophy leaves everything as it is' - 133 methods, LIKE DIFFERENT THERAPIES, in the PLURAL

|

WHAT IS NOT OWNED HERE

PICTURE THEORY, SAYING/SHOWING,

'WHEREOF ONE CANNOT SPEAK' ... Topic 06 - a TARGET, not a limb

VERIFICATION, PSEUDO-STATEMENTS,

THE VIENNA CIRCLE Topic 07 - a RIVAL, not an ally

TWO DOGMAS, HOLISM, PERSONS Topic 11, Quine and Strawson

FIDEISM, RELIGIOUS LANGUAGE,

'FORM OF LIFE' THEOLOGY Paper II, Religious Language

RYLE, AUSTIN, SPEECH ACTS broader ordinary-language owners

Concept spine: read it downward. One abandoned essence, one change of question, three printed limbs, one firewall against behaviourism, one method - and a fence around what belongs to other clauses.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the three limbs, "U-G-P"**. Use -> Games -> Private language. Write the limbs in that order and the answer has a spine before it has content, because the third limb is a *consequence* of the first two and collapses into assertion if it is written first. MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the four supports, "O-F-R-T"**. Ostensive definition needs background; Family resemblance removes the demand for an essence; Rule-following supplies the normativity; Therapy states what the whole exercise is for. These four are not decoration: without them the printed limbs cannot be executed. MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the private-language target, "L-O-U"**. Logically private sensations, fixed by private Ostension, and therefore in principle Unteachable. A candidate who cannot state all three has almost certainly attacked a secret code instead. MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the firewall, "C-D-A"**. Criteria are grammatical, they are Defeasible, and the first person uses an Avowal rather than a report. Those three words are the entire difference between Wittgenstein and behaviourism. MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the hedge that must never be dropped, "LARGE CLASS"**. Section 43 says *for a large class of cases - though not for all*. Quoting "the meaning of a word is its use in the language" without that clause is the single most frequent misquotation in this syllabus item, and it converts a careful remark into the slogan Wittgenstein was avoiding.

ANSWER-WORTHINESS - WHAT EARNS MARKS AND WHAT DOES NOT

Classification	Content
CORE MAINS	Meaning as use with the Section 43 qualification stated and explained; the rejection of the Augustinian picture (Section 1) as <i>one primitive language-game</i> rather than as a falsehood; words as tools and understanding as mastery of a technique ; ostensive definition and the sample, and why pointing presupposes a place in grammar; family resemblance (Section 66-67) with <i>"Don't think, but look!"</i> and the exact scope of what it denies; the language-game (Sprachspiel) with the builders' "Slab!" and the list at Section 23; form of life (Lebensform) at Section 19, agreement in judgments (Section 241-242) , the lion remark and the bedrock of Section 217; the rule-following paradox (Section 201) and its resolution in a grasping of a rule that is not an interpretation ; the critique of private language (Section 243-271) with the exact target, the diary "S" (Section 258) , the beetle-in-a-box (Section 293) and the five-step criterion-of-correctness core; the criteria/symptom distinction with its defeasibility , Section 580 , the avowal (Section 244) , and the behaviourism charge answered at Section 304 and 307-308 ; philosophy as therapy (Section 38, 109, 115, 123, 124, 128, 133, 255, 309) and perspicuous representation ; the break from the Tractatus* with its actual reasons; and all seven routed 2018-2025 question-parts
CORE SUPPORTING	The colour-exclusion difficulty that pressured the independence of elementary propositions and prompted the 1929 return to philosophy - a pressure , not a one-step refutation; the treatment of solipsism at <i>Tractatus</i> 5.62 through saying and showing, retained because the 2019 part routes solipsism through the later critique; Kripke's sceptical reading (<i>Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language</i> , 1982) reported as "Kripke's Wittgenstein" and set against the anti-sceptical reading of Baker and Hacker and of McDowell; the Crusoe / solitary speaker objection and the distinction between logical privacy and physical solitude; the provenance rail - posthumous publication in 1953, Anscombe and Rhees as editors, the 2009 fourth edition revised by Hacker and Schulte, and the renaming and renumbering of Part II as <i>Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment</i>

Classification	Content
SUPPORTING	Aspect-seeing and the duck-rabbit (Part II Section xi / PPF; the figure is Jastrow's , 1899) as bounded enrichment for the experience of meaning; On Certainty (<i>notes of 1949-51, published 1969</i>) and <i>hinge certainty as a comparison only</i> ; the Blue and Brown Books* (dictated 1933-35, published 1958) as the source of the criterion/symptom vocabulary and the angina example; the contrast with logical positivism , which shares the anti-metaphysical direction but not the single criterion
OPTIONAL ADVANCED	Whether the "sceptical solution" is a legitimate Wittgensteinian move or a constructive theory his own method forbids; whether language requires an actual community or only standards of correctness that are in principle shareable ; and whether "meaning is use" is a substantive theory of meaning or a therapeutic reminder against essentialism
NOT OWNED HERE	The picture theory, logical atomism, saying and showing, and <i>"Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent"</i> as doctrine (Topic 06 - they appear here only as the position being revised); the verification principle, pseudo-statements and the Vienna Circle (Topic 07); Quine's holism and Strawson's persons (Topic 11); fideist and Wittgensteinian religious-language applications of <i>form of life</i> (Paper II); Ryle, Austin and speech-act theory as systems of their own

ANALYSIS: Ownership boundary, stated once. This clause owns **7 of 112** Western Philosophy question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus, and **2021 is the only year without an owned part**. Two consequences follow, and both are visible in the first paragraph of a script. First, the clause is examined **through its transition**: two of the seven parts (2023 and 2025) ask directly why the early position was abandoned, so a candidate who cannot state the *Tractatus* position accurately cannot answer 35 of the 100 marks this clause has carried. The early doctrine must therefore be known well enough to be **left behind precisely** - and then left alone, because expounding it is Topic 06's work. Second, three of the seven parts (2019, 2020 and 2024) are private-language parts asked in three different ways, which means the argument must be held as a **structure** rather than as two illustrations: a candidate who can only retell the diary and the beetle has anecdotes where the examiner wanted a proof.

HOW TO READ THIS SESSION

Every subtopic below runs in the same order, so the shape becomes automatic:

Step	What it gives you
DEFINITION	plain-language definition, then the technical one
ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING	a sentence you can adapt directly as an introduction or a conclusion
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS	the terms that signal control of the topic
Plain-language visual	the idea before the vocabulary
VISUAL: VISUAL	the diagram that carries the argument
Numbered teaching	the doctrine, remark by remark, with Section number, work and date
HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH	claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification, written out for this subtopic
Exam link	which routed PYQ this subtopic answers, and how
UPSC traps	the specific ways candidates lose marks here
Revision notes	the compressed recall list
CLOSING RECALL FLOW	the subtopic reduced to one flow you can redraw from memory

Complete the Basic block first. Interpretive depth - whether Kripke's sceptical solution is Wittgensteinian at all, whether an actual community is required, and whether meaning-as-use is a theory or a reminder - is deliberately withheld until the clearly labelled optional block after the practice sections. Nothing in that block is needed to write a complete answer to any of the seven routed questions.

ORIGIN AND CHRONOLOGY - THE MINIMUM NEEDED TO AVOID ANACHRONISM

ANALYSIS: This clause is unusual: almost every text it depends on was **published after its author had died**, and the exam rewards a candidate who says so accurately in one clause. The rail below prevents the six commonest anachronisms - saying that Wittgenstein *published* the *Investigations*; dating the English *Tractatus* to 1921; attributing the duck-rabbit drawing to Wittgenstein; citing "Part II Section xi" as though the numbering were stable; treating Kripke's reading as Wittgenstein's own statement; and treating the *Tractatus* as though it had said nothing about solipsism or about the logical order of ordinary language.

THE EARLY POSITION THAT IS LATER REVISED

1921 Logisch-Philosophische Abhandlung, published in German
1922 Bilingual TRACTATUS LOGICO-PHILOSOPHICUS
NEVER date the English text 1921 TOPIC 06
Contents that matter HERE: one general propositional form;
sense through PICTURING; elementary propositions asserted to be
logically INDEPENDENT; solipsism handled at 5.62 through
saying and showing; and the explicit claim that the
propositions of our everyday language are, JUST AS THEY ARE,
in perfect logical order

THE INTERVAL, AND THE CRACK THAT REOPENED THE QUESTION

1922-28 Wittgenstein is out of academic philosophy - village
schoolteacher, gardener, architect of his sister's house
1929 He returns to Cambridge. The COLOUR-EXCLUSION problem is
acknowledged in print in 'Some Remarks on Logical Form'
(Proceedings of the Aristotelian Society, supplementary
volume): 'this spot is red' and 'this spot is green' cannot
both be true, yet the Tractatus required elementary
propositions to be independent
WARNING this is a PRESSURE on the early system, not a
one-step refutation, and Wittgenstein himself later
disowned the 1929 paper
1929-32 Conversations with SCHLICK and WAISMANN. Verificationist
formulations do occur there - which is why Topic 07 can cite
them - but Wittgenstein was NEVER a member of the Circle

THE LATER METHOD IS DICTATED, THEN WRITTEN

1933-35 THE BLUE AND BROWN BOOKS are DICTATED to students
(published 1958). Source of the CRITERION / SYMPTOM
distinction and of the ANGINA example. Say 'in the Blue
Book', never 'Wittgenstein wrote'
1936-49 PHILOSOPHICAL INVESTIGATIONS Part I is composed and
repeatedly rearranged. It is a book of REMARKS
1945 Wittgenstein's own preface is written for the projected book
1949-51 The notes later published as ON CERTAINTY are written; the
last entries date from days before his death
1951 WITTGENSTEIN DIES. He published, in his lifetime, one
philosophical book and one article

EVERYTHING ELSE IS POSTHUMOUS - AND THE DATES ARE EXAMINABLE

1953 PHILOSOPHICAL INVESTIGATIONS, edited by G. E. M. ANSCOMBE and
RUSH REEES, translated by Anscombe, German and English on
facing pages. Part I: 693 numbered remarks
1958 The Blue and Brown Books
1969 ON CERTAINTY (Über Gewissheit), notes of 1949-51
1982 KRIPKE, Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language. Kripke
presents it as the argument AS IT STRUCK HIM, not as
exegesis. Standard scholarly shorthand: 'Kripkenstein'
2009 4th edition, revised by P. M. S. HACKER and JOACHIM SCHULTE.
Part II is RENAMED 'Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment'
and RENUMBERED. So 'PI Part II section xi' (older editions)
= 'PPF sections 111ff' (4th edn). Cite the duck-rabbit as
'Part II xi / PPF', never as a bare number

ONE FIGURE THAT IS NOT HIS

1899 JASTROW publishes the DUCK-RABBIT. Wittgenstein REPRODUCES
it. Never attribute the drawing to Wittgenstein

ANALYSIS: **What the rail earns you.** Four separate marks are commonly available from it, and none costs more than a clause: that the *Investigations* is **posthumous** and **editorially arranged**; the **1921/1922** split for the *Tractatus*; the **2009 renaming and renumbering** of Part II, which is why a bare "Part II Section xi" citation is unsafe; and the fact that **Kripke's reading is a reading**, which is the cheapest way to show that a candidate has read about the debate

rather than only about the doctrine.

ONE-SCREEN ROUTE MAP

THE SEVEN ROUTED QUESTIONS, SORTED BY THE SUBTOPIC THAT ANSWERS THEM

FAMILY RESEMBLANCE AND WHY	2018 Q1(c) 10
'LANGUAGE IS A GAME'	Sessions 4 and 5
SOLIPSISM CULMINATING IN THE	2019 Q3(b) 15
PRIVATE-LANGUAGE CRITIQUE	Session 10 (with 8)
'COULD WE IMAGINE A LANGUAGE ...	2020 Q4(c) 15
FOR HIS PRIVATE USE?'	Session 8 (with 9)
LANGUAGE AS FORM OF LIFE -	2022 Q1(c) 10
'ESTABLISH THE TENABILITY'	Session 6
WHY THE SHIFT FROM PICTURE-THEORY	2023 Q4(c) 15
TO USE-THEORY	Sessions 1, 2 and 3
WHY NO ESSENTIALLY PRIVATE	2024 Q1(d) 10
LANGUAGE	Session 8
THE TRANSITION, WITH THE QUOTED	2025 Q3(a) 20
STATEMENT	Sessions 1-13, routed by 13

2021 IS THE ONLY YEAR WITHOUT AN OWNED PART - and the year is not empty: its Wittgenstein part, 2021 Q4(c) on 'Whereof one cannot speak', is owned by TOPIC 06, and knowing that is itself a boundary mark

THE FIVE SENTENCES THAT OPEN FIVE DIFFERENT ANSWERS

USE	"Wittgenstein does not replace one theory of meaning with another; he replaces the demand for a theory with the instruction to look at what is done with the word."
GAMES	"The word 'game' was chosen because games have rules, training, moves and points without having an essence - which is exactly the combination language was said to lack."
FORM OF LIFE	"Language rests not on agreement in opinions but on agreement in judgments and in the trained ways of acting that make disagreement itself possible."
PRIVATE LANGUAGE	"The private linguist is not accused of lying; he is shown to have provided himself with no way of being wrong, and a sign that cannot be misused has not yet been used."
TRANSITION	"The later work does not refute the <i>Tractatus</i> so much as withdraw the question it was answering, and the two books are continuous in exactly one respect: both hold that the philosopher's business is clarification."

THE FOUR VERDICT-WORDS THAT MUST NOT BE MISTAKEN FOR ONE ANOTHER

IMPOSSIBLE	 a private language, in the defined sense
UNNECESSARY	 a single essence shared by all uses of a word
DEFEASIBLE	 a criterion; it grounds without entailing
INEXPRESSIBLE	 the solipsist's thesis, once its own vocabulary is examined. NOT 'false', and NOT 'refuted by evidence'

SESSION 1 - THE BREAK FROM THE TRACTATUS: WHAT CHANGED, WHY IT CHANGED, AND WHAT DID NOT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The same man wrote two philosophies. The first says that a sentence means something because it is a picture of a possible fact; the second says that we should stop looking for the one thing that makes all sentences meaningful and instead look at the many different jobs words actually do. The second philosophy is not a correction of a detail in the first. It withdraws the question the first was answering.

Technical definition: The **later philosophy** is the position developed in *Philosophical Investigations* - composed between 1936 and 1949 and published **posthumously in 1953**, edited by G. E. M. Anscombe and Rush Rhees - which abandons the *Tractatus* commitment to **one general propositional form**, to sense as **depiction** of a possible state of affairs through a shared **logical form**, and to a **depth analysis** terminating in logically independent elementary propositions. In its place it puts a **descriptive, grammatical** investigation of the **use** of expressions in **language-games** embedded in **forms of life**. ANALYSIS: The break is a change of **method and of the demand for essence**, not a move from an "artificial" to an "ordinary" language: the *Tractatus* itself (4.002, 5.5563) already insists

that the propositions of everyday language are, just as they stand, in perfect logical order.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Later Wittgenstein does not refute the *Tractatus* so much as withdraw the question it was answering: the demand that something single and hidden explain how any sentence can mean anything is not answered better, it is diagnosed as the source of the trouble - and the one thing that survives the change is the conviction that philosophy's business is clarification rather than discovery.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **one general propositional form** - the precise commitment that is dropped, and the phrase that shows you know *what* was dropped
- **picturing / logical form** - the early account of sense, named accurately in four words
- **colour exclusion** - the internal difficulty, correctly labelled a **pressure**
- **Augustinian picture (Section 1)** - the model of meaning that both books' opponents share
- **description, not explanation (Section 109)** - the methodological change in three words
- **continuity of clarification** - what does *not* change, and the mark most candidates leave on the table

How to use them: name *one general propositional form* in the first sentence rather than "picture theory", because it identifies the exact commitment abandoned; introduce **colour exclusion** with the word "pressure" attached, since calling it a refutation is a marked error; and reserve **continuity of clarification** for the verdict, where it converts a description of two positions into an argument about one philosopher.

Plain-language visual - the same man, two pictures of meaning

ONE PHILOSOPHER, TWO QUESTIONS	
=====	=====
EARLY (Tractatus: German 1921, bilingual 1922)	LATER (Investigations, composed 1936-49, published 1953)
-----	-----
QUESTION	QUESTION
'What must a sentence BE, for it to be capable of sense at all?'	'How is this expression actually USED, and what puzzles us here?'
-----	-----
ANSWER	ANSWER
It must PICTURE a possible state of affairs; it shares a LOGICAL FORM with what it depicts	Look. There are countless different uses, learned in training, woven into activities. No single essence is required for them to be language
-----	-----
METHOD	METHOD
ANALYSIS down to elementary propositions; then draw the limit of the sayable and be silent about the rest	DESCRIPTION: assemble reminders, compare cases, display grammar; 'philosophy leaves everything as it is' (124)
-----	-----
WHAT BOTH SHARE	
Philosophy is not a body of doctrine but an ACTIVITY of clarification; philosophical trouble comes from MISREADING the workings of language; ordinary language is not accused of being defective	
=====	=====

In simple words: imagine someone who spends years asking "what is the one thing all tools have in common that makes them tools?" and then one morning opens the toolbox and notices that a hammer, a ruler, a pot of glue and a saw have nothing single in common - and that nothing has gone wrong. The workshop still works. That is the shape of the change. The early Wittgenstein wanted the hidden common feature; the later Wittgenstein says the demand for it was the disease, not the diagnosis.

Remember first	Meaning
The break is about essence , not about vocabulary	he does not say ordinary language is bad and should be replaced
The <i>Tractatus</i> is not a positivist book	its criterion of sense is depiction , not verification - Topic 07's boundary

Remember first	Meaning
Colour exclusion is a pressure	it strains elementary independence; it does not prove no analysis was possible
1929 is the hinge year	the return to Cambridge and the acknowledged difficulty
The 1953 book is posthumous	never write "Wittgenstein published the <i>Investigations</i> "

One-line memory: the early book asks what language *must* be; the later book asks what we are *doing* with it - and the second question makes the first look like a craving rather than an enquiry.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the five commitments dropped, and the exact reason each fell

THE TRACTATUS COMMITMENT	WHY IT COULD NOT BE HELD
1 ONE GENERAL PROPOSITIONAL FORM 'This is how things stand' covers every meaningful proposition	Inspection of use shows irreducible diversity: ordering, joking, praying, thanking, greeting, calculating, play-acting, cursing (PI 23). The demand for one form is a CRAVING FOR GENERALITY, not a finding
2 SENSE = DEPICTION OF A POSSIBLE STATE OF AFFAIRS THROUGH A SHARED LOGICAL FORM	'Game' pictures nothing single. Nor do 'the', 'if', 'five', 'perhaps', 'meaning', 'pain'. Picturing is ONE thing language does, not what it IS
3 NAMES MEAN BY STANDING FOR OBJECTS; the AUGUSTINIAN PICTURE (PI 1) generalised	Ostension cannot fix a name's meaning by itself (PI 28-32): the same pointing can teach colour, shape, number, material or direction. Naming needs a PLACE IN THE LANGUAGE ALREADY PREPARED
4 ELEMENTARY PROPOSITIONS ARE LOGICALLY INDEPENDENT	COLOUR EXCLUSION: 'this spot is red' and 'this spot is green' cannot both be true, yet neither looks analysable further. Acknowledged in 'Some Remarks on Logical Form' (1929) CAUTION: a PRESSURE on the system, not a knock-down refutation - and Wittgenstein later disowned that paper
5 A COMPLETE ANALYSIS TERMINATES IN SIMPLES	No example of a Tractarian 'simple object' was ever produced. 'Simple' and 'composite' turn out to be RELATIVE to a language-game (PI 47): is a chair simple? relative to what?
WHAT IS NOT DROPPED - AND SAYING SO IS WHERE THE VERDICT MARK LIVES * Philosophy as an ACTIVITY of clarification, not a science * The diagnosis that philosophical problems arise from MISUNDERSTANDING the logic / grammar of our language * The refusal to add a competing metaphysical theory * Respect for ordinary language: the Tractatus says everyday propositions are 'in perfect logical order' JUST AS THEY ARE (4.002, 5.5563)	
THE TWO TRAPS THIS DIAGRAM EXISTS TO KILL X 'He moved from an ideal language to ordinary language' - the Tractatus never held ordinary language to be defective X 'Colour exclusion refuted the Tractatus' - it pressured ONE commitment	

ANALYSIS: Caption. The 2023 fifteen-mark part asks for the **main reasons** for the shift, and the 2025 twenty-mark part asks for the **transition** with a quoted statement. Both are answered by the left-hand column paired with the right-hand column - five commitments, five reasons - and both are damaged by a script that treats the change as a change of subject-matter rather than of the demand for essence.

1. What the *Tractatus* actually claimed FACT:

FACT: The early work holds that a proposition has sense because it is a **logical picture** of a possible state of affairs: the elements of the proposition go proxy for objects, and the arrangement of those elements depicts a possible arrangement of the objects. What proposition and fact must share is **logical form**, and logical form itself cannot be said - it **shows** itself. The general propositional form is given as "*This is how things stand.*"

ANALYSIS: Two features of the early book must be stated correctly or the later break cannot be described correctly. First, the *Tractatus* does **not** propose to replace ordinary language: at 4.002 and 5.5563 it insists that everyday propositions are in perfect logical order as they stand, and that only the outward form of language disguises the thought. Second, the *Tractatus* does **not** ignore the self and the limits of the subject: it handles **solipsism** at 5.62, where what the solipsist means is said to be correct but incapable of being said, showing itself instead in the limits of language. Both points matter directly: the first blocks the commonest caricature of the transition, and the second is the reason the 2019 part can route solipsism through the later critique without inventing a topic.

2. The internal pressures FACT:ANALYSIS:

FACT: **Colour exclusion.** "This spot is red all over" and "this spot is green all over" cannot both be true. If they are elementary - and they look as though nothing further can be analysed out of them - then elementary propositions are not logically independent, which the *Tractatus* required. Wittgenstein acknowledged the difficulty publicly in "**Some Remarks on Logical Form**" (1929), the paper he wrote on returning to Cambridge.

ANALYSIS: **State the strength of this correctly.** It is a difficulty that opens a system, not a proof that closes it. The 1929 paper attempts a repair, Wittgenstein soon regarded that repair as unsatisfactory, and he later disowned the paper. Writing "colour exclusion refuted the picture theory" converts a philosopher's long dissatisfaction into a single knock-down move and is one of the marked errors in this clause.

FACT: **The missing simples.** The *Tractatus* asserted that analysis terminates in simple objects, but no example was ever given. Section 47 of the *Investigations* turns this into a diagnosis rather than a complaint: "simple" and "composite" have no absolute sense. Is a chair simple? Are its legs? Is the visual image of the chair simple? The question has an answer only once a language-game fixes what is to count as a part - which means the early requirement was not unsatisfied but **unintelligible as stated**.

FACT: **The failure of ostension to found naming.** If names mean by standing for objects, something must connect name to object. Pointing looks like the connection - and Section 28-32 show that it is not, because a learner shown a sample can take it to teach colour, shape, number, material or place. That argument is Session 3's business, and it is the pressure that converts a difficulty about *analysis* into a difficulty about *meaning as such*.

3. The positive change: from analysis to description FACT:

FACT: "*We must do away with all explanation, and description alone must take its place*" (Section 109, in substance), and the problems are to be solved "*not by giving new information, but by arranging what we have always known.*" This is not modesty. It is a claim about what philosophical trouble **is**: not ignorance of a further fact, but disorientation among facts we already possess.

The consequence for method is exact: instead of asking *what must meaning be*, we ask *how is this word used here* and *how is this word used there*, and we place the two side by side. The tool is **perspicuous representation** - an arrangement that lets us "see connections" (Section 122). ANALYSIS: Note that description in this sense is not passive reporting: assembling reminders is a piece of work, and Wittgenstein's own text is full of arguments, comparisons and reductios. A script that turns "no theory" into "no argument" has swapped one dogma for another, and Wittgenstein's own Section 133 speaks of **methods, in the plural**, "like different therapies".

4. What continuity survives - the mark most scripts miss ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: Four things survive the change, and naming them is what separates a report of two positions from an account of one philosopher:

Continuity	Early statement	Later statement
Philosophy is an activity , not a body of doctrine	philosophy clarifies propositions; its result is not "philosophical propositions"	philosophy is a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language (Section 109)

Continuity	Early statement	Later statement
Philosophical trouble comes from misreading language	the outward form of language disguises the thought (4.002)	a picture held us captive (Section 115); language idles (Section 38)
Ordinary language is not the culprit	everyday propositions are in perfect logical order (5.5563)	philosophy leaves everything as it is (Section 124)
The book is self-consuming	the ladder must be thrown away after climbing it (6.54)	there is no doctrine, only methods, like different therapies (Section 133)

ANALYSIS: This is also where the sharpest available criticism lives: the objection that the therapeutic method is itself a philosophical thesis about philosophy applies to **both** books in structurally the same way, and Wittgenstein accepts a version of it in each. Saying so in one sentence is a first-class exam observation, because it shows the transition as a development inside one problem rather than as a change of mind between two.

5. How to state the transition without caricature ANALYSIS:

WRONG: "He moved from an artificial ideal language to ordinary language." - The *Tractatus* held ordinary language to be in order. WRONG: "He replaced the picture theory with the use theory." - He replaced the **demand for one theory** with an instruction to look; Section 43's hedge exists to prevent "use" becoming a second essence. WRONG: "The later Wittgenstein is a logical positivist." - The positivists impose a **single criterion** (verifiability) on meaning; the later Wittgenstein's objection to the *Tractatus* applies with equal force to any single criterion, which is why he is a **pressure on Topic 07** and not a member of it. WRONG: "He abandoned logic." - He abandoned the claim that one calculus underlies all use; grammar, rules and normativity remain central throughout. FACT: **The safe formula: the later work retains the early aim of dissolving philosophical confusion, and abandons the early assumption that dissolving it requires exhibiting one hidden logical essence common to all meaningful language.**

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The shift from the *Tractatus* to the *Investigations* is best described not as the replacement of one theory of meaning by another but as the abandonment of the demand that meaning have a single hidden essence, and the substitution of description for analysis as the philosopher's method. **Named evidence.** The *Tractatus* offers one general propositional form, sense as depiction through shared logical form, and an analysis terminating in logically independent elementary propositions; by 1929 the colour-exclusion difficulty had shown, in "Some Remarks on Logical Form", that two apparently elementary propositions can exclude one another, and Section 47 of the *Investigations* shows that "simple" has no sense apart from a language-game that fixes what counts as a part. Against that background Section 109 states that description must take the place of explanation, and Section 23 exhibits the diversity - ordering, thanking, cursing, play-acting, calculating - that no single form covers. **Analysis.** Each early commitment falls to a different pressure, and the pressures are cumulative rather than singular: the diversity of use undermines one form, the failure of ostension undermines naming as the foundation of meaning, colour exclusion strains independence, and the absence of any exhibited simple makes the terminus of analysis unstatable. What connects them is a single diagnosis - that a picture of how language *must* work had been mistaken for a discovery about how it *does*. **Qualification.** The transition should not be caricatured as a movement from artificial to ordinary language, since the *Tractatus* already held everyday propositions to be in perfect logical order, and colour exclusion is a pressure on one commitment rather than a refutation of the system; what genuinely survives is the conception of philosophy as clarifying activity, so that the two works are continuous in aim while opposed in the assumption that clarification requires an essence.

Exam link

- **2023 Q4(c)** (15 marks) asks for the **main reasons** that led to the shift. Section 2 supplies them, Section 3 supplies the positive replacement, Section 4 supplies the "critically discuss" half.
- **2025 Q3(a)** (20 marks) quotes a statement contrasting an ideal language with the ways languages are actually used. Section 1 prevents the caricature the quotation invites, and Section 5 supplies the safe formula for the verdict.
- **2018 Q1(c), 2022 Q1(c)** and the three private-language parts all begin more strongly if the first sentence places the doctrine as the *replacement of an essence-demand*, which is this session's contribution to every other answer.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"He moved from ideal language to ordinary language"	The <i>Tractatus</i> says everyday propositions are in perfect logical order (4.002, 5.5563)
"Colour exclusion refuted the <i>Tractatus</i> "	It pressured elementary independence; Wittgenstein's own 1929 repair failed and he disowned that paper
"Wittgenstein published the <i>Investigations</i> in 1953"	It is posthumous , edited by Anscombe and Rhees; he died in 1951
"The <i>Tractatus</i> said nothing about the self or solipsism"	5.62 treats solipsism through saying and showing - which is why the 2019 part is answerable
"The picture theory was replaced by the use theory"	Section 43 is hedged precisely to stop "use" becoming a second essence
"The later Wittgenstein is a verificationist"	The objection to one essence applies to one criterion too; Topic 07 is a rival, not a continuation

Revision notes

- *Tractatus*: German **1921**, bilingual **1922**; one general propositional form; sense = **depiction** through shared **logical form**; elementary propositions **independent**; analysis ends in **simples**.
- *Investigations*: composed **1936-49**, published **posthumously 1953**, edited **Anscombe and Rhees**; Part I = **693** numbered remarks.
- Five commitments dropped: one form · depiction as the essence of sense · naming as foundation · elementary independence · analysis into simples.
- Five reasons: diversity of use (Section 23) · ostension's insufficiency (Section 28-32) · **colour exclusion** (1929, a **pressure**) · "simple" is game-relative (Section 47) · the craving for generality diagnosed rather than satisfied.
- Method changes from **analysis** to **description** (Section 109), aiming at **perspicuous representation** (Section 122).
- Four continuities: philosophy as **activity** · trouble from **misreading language** · ordinary language **not** at fault · the book **consumes itself** (6.54 / Section 133).
- 1929 = return to Cambridge; 1933-35 = *Blue and Brown Books* dictated (published 1958).

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE TRANSITION

```

TRACTATUS: one general form -> sense by picturing -> shared logical form
|
|   -> analysis into independent simples
|
+--> PRESSURE 1  diversity of actual use (PI 23) - no one form covers it
+--> PRESSURE 2  ostension does not fix meaning (PI 28-32)
+--> PRESSURE 3  colour exclusion (1929) - independence strained
+--> PRESSURE 4  'simple' has sense only inside a game (PI 47)
|
v
DIAGNOSIS: the demand for ONE HIDDEN ESSENCE was a CRAVING, not a finding
|
v
INVESTIGATIONS: look at USE -> language-games -> forms of life
method: DESCRIPTION, not explanation (109); perspicuous representation (122)
|
v
CONTINUITY: philosophy = clarifying ACTIVITY; ordinary language not at fault
|
v
ANSWER LINE: the question is withdrawn, not answered better - and the same
philosopher is at work on both sides of the change

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SESSION 2 - MEANING AND USE: THE AUGUSTINIAN PICTURE, THE TOOLBOX, AND THE HEDGE AT Section 43

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Asking what a word means usually feels like asking what it stands for - as if every word were a label and meaning were the thing behind the label. Wittgenstein's proposal is to stop hunting for the thing and to watch what people do with the word: how it is taught, when it is used, what counts as using it correctly, what would show that someone had not understood it. For a very large range of words, that is all there is to find.

Technical definition: The doctrine of **meaning as use** holds that, *"for a large class of cases - though not for all - in which we employ the word 'meaning' it can be defined thus: the meaning of a word is its use in the language"* (Section 43). "Use" here means an expression's **norm-governed role** within a practice: the circumstances in which it is applied, the training by which it is learned, the moves it permits, and the standards by which application counts as correct or incorrect. ANALYSIS: The doctrine is directed against the **Augustinian picture of language** (Section 1) - the model on which every word names an object and every sentence combines names - which Wittgenstein treats not as a false theory but as **one primitive language-game mistaken for the essence of all language**.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Wittgenstein's claim that meaning is use is not the discovery of what meaning secretly was all along; it is the removal of a question - the question "what does this word *stand for*?" - which had seemed compulsory only because one primitive model of language had been mistaken for its essence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Augustinian picture** (Section 1) - name the target before naming the thesis
- **"for a large class of cases - though not for all"** (Section 43) - the hedge, quoted, not paraphrased
- **tools in a toolbox** (Section 11) - the image that does the philosophical work in one line
- **mastery of a technique** - understanding, defined without a mental episode
- **norm-governed role** - the phrase that keeps "use" from meaning "usage frequency"
- **the lever image** (Section 12) - uniform appearance concealing different functions

How to use them: open on the **Augustinian picture**, because a thesis stated without its target reads as an assertion; quote the **Section 43 hedge** verbatim in the same paragraph, since dropping it is the single commonest misquotation in this clause; and use **norm-governed role** the first time you write "use", to close off the "use means whatever people happen to do" reading before the examiner can raise it.

Plain-language visual - the toolbox, and what the label-model cannot handle

```

THE LABEL MODEL SAYS:  word ---- stands for ----> thing
=====
IT WORKS TOLERABLY FOR      'table'  'chair'  'apple'  'Ram'
IT COLLAPSES IMMEDIATELY FOR
'he'      - which object?      'if'      - which object?
'five'    - point to the five   'not'    - point to the not
'perhaps' - a mood? a thing?    'meaning' - a further object??
'pain'    - a private object? -> Session 8 shows where that ends
=====
THE TOOLBOX MODEL SAYS: word ---- has a JOB in an activity ----> use
hammer saw ruler glue-pot screwdriver nails
They look like one kind of thing lying in one box. Their FUNCTIONS
have nothing single in common. (PI 11)
-----
THE LEVER WARNING (PI 12)
In a locomotive cab all the handles LOOK alike. One is a crank that
can be moved continuously; one is a switch with two positions; one
is a brake-lever that works harder the harder you pull. UNIFORM
APPEARANCE, DIFFERENT FUNCTION. Words are like the handles.
=====
THE RESULT
'What does it mean?' becomes 'How is it used, and how was that use
learned, and what would count as getting it wrong?'

```

In simple words: the label-model is not stupid - it is the first thing anyone would think, and it is roughly right for a small class of words. What is wrong is the generalisation. Once you assume every word must be a label, you start inventing invisible objects for the words that plainly have no visible object: a mental image behind "meaning", a private sensation behind "pain", an abstract entity behind "five". Wittgenstein's method is to refuse the first step, and most of the invented objects then have nothing to do.

Remember first	Meaning
Section 1 quotes Augustine , not a modern opponent	the picture is ancient, natural and therefore hard to see as a picture
The Augustinian picture is not <i>false</i>	it is one primitive language-game over-generalised
"Use" ≠ usage frequency	a rare word is not a less meaningful word
"Use" ≠ usefulness	a useless sentence can be perfectly meaningful
"Use" ≠ whatever I choose	correctness is built into the practice, not into the speaker

One-line memory: don't ask what the word points at; ask what the word is *for*, who taught it to you, and what would count as using it wrongly.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the thesis, its hedge, and the four things it does not say

PI 43, WITH ITS ARCHITECTURE MADE VISIBLE

'For a large class of cases - THOUGH NOT FOR ALL - in which we employ the word "meaning" it can be defined thus: the meaning of a word is its use in the language.'

SCOPE LIMITER	WHAT IS BEING DEFINED	THE DEFINITION
'a large class of cases, though not for all'	our EMPLOYMENT of the word 'meaning' - not a metaphysical entity called Meaning	USE IN THE LANGUAGE i.e. the norm-governed ROLE of the expression in a practice

WHAT THE REMARK DOES NOT SAY - FOUR REFUSALS, EACH WORTH A LINE

X It does NOT say that meaning is FREQUENCY of employment
X It does NOT say that meaning is USEFULNESS or practical payoff
X It does NOT say that any use a speaker likes is thereby CORRECT
X It does NOT offer a UNIVERSAL DEFINITION of 'meaning' - the hedge is doctrine: proper names, for instance, are handled separately at 79, and 'the bearer of a name' is expressly distinguished from 'the meaning of a name' at 40

THE THREE POSITIVE MOVES THAT REPLACE THE LABEL MODEL

- 1 REJECT the referential generalisation PI 1, 10, 11, 12
- 2 REDESCRIBE understanding as MASTERY OF A TECHNIQUE, shown in going on correctly PI 143-155, 199
- 3 RELOCATE meaning in CONTEXT: the same words in a different game do different work PI 117, 432

THE WORKED CASE THE EXAMINER CAN CHECK

'Water!' shouted at a fire = an order / an alarm
asked at a table = a request
written on a phial = a label / a classification
said while pointing at
a chemical formula = an identification

SAME WORD. SAME SOUND. FOUR JOBS. The 'meaning' is not a fifth thing standing behind the four.

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** This is the diagram to redraw first in the 2023 and 2025 transition answers, because it shows exactly what replaced picturing - and it is also the diagram that protects you in the 2018 and 2022 parts, since both family resemblance and forms of life are *consequences* of taking use seriously.

1. The Augustinian picture, quoted and diagnosed FACT:

FACT: Section 1 opens with a passage from Augustine's *Confessions* describing how the child learns language: elders name objects, move towards them, and the child grasps that the sound stands for the thing. Wittgenstein's comment is precise and often misread. He does **not** say the description is false. He says it gives us "*a particular picture of the essence of human language*": that individual words name objects, that sentences are combinations of such names, and that in this picture we find "*the roots of the following idea: every word has a meaning; this meaning is correlated with the word; it is the object for which the word stands.*"

ANALYSIS: The diagnosis, at Section 2-Section 4, is a comparison rather than a refutation: he constructs the **builders' language** - a complete primitive language in which "Slab!", "Block!", "Pillar!", "Beam!" are the whole vocabulary - and observes that Augustine's account fits *that* language perfectly. So the picture is not wrong; it is **a description of one language-game, offered as the essence of all**. ANALYSIS: Writing "Wittgenstein refuted Augustine's theory of meaning" loses this, and with it the entire method: the later Wittgenstein's characteristic move is to shrink an alleged essence into one case among many.

2. Words as tools; handles that look alike FACT:

FACT: **Section 11:** "*Think of the tools in a tool-box: there is a hammer, pliers, a saw, a screwdriver, a rule, a glue-pot, glue, nails and screws. The functions of words are as diverse as the functions of these objects.*" FACT: **Section 12:** in the cabin of a locomotive there are handles all looking more or less alike - but one is a crank movable continuously, one a switch with two positions, one a brake-lever that resists more the harder it is pulled.

ANALYSIS: The philosophical work these images do is exact, and worth stating rather than merely quoting: uniformity of **appearance** across words tempts us to expect uniformity of **function**, and the expectation is a grammatical illusion. That is why a list of examples is not a substitute for the point. The point is that we were misled by the *look* of language - nouns lined up like nouns - into assuming one job.

3. Understanding as mastery of a technique FACT:

FACT: If meaning were an object, understanding would be a private encounter with it - a mental picture, a flash, an inner "now I've got it". Section 143-155 examine exactly that suggestion through the case of a pupil learning to continue a numerical series, and Section 199 concludes that *"to understand a sentence means to understand a language. To understand a language means to be master of a technique."*

The argument has three steps:

1. The inner "aha" can occur without understanding - the pupil who feels the flash and then continues wrongly did not understand.
2. Understanding can be present without any distinctive inner episode - the fluent reader has no "aha" at each word.
3. What settles the question in every actual case is whether the person **goes on correctly** in the appropriate circumstances.

ANALYSIS: **Step 3 is not behaviourism**, and the difference must be stated: the criterion of understanding is what one does, but performance is **defeasible** - someone can understand and be unable to perform (fatigue, distraction, paralysis), and can perform once by luck without understanding. Wittgenstein's claim is about **what the concept of understanding requires**, not about an identity between understanding and behaviour. That distinction is Session 9's business and is the reason it exists.

4. Context: the same words, different work FACT:

FACT: Meaning is not fixed in isolation. "Water!" is an alarm, a request, a label or an identification depending on the game it is a move in; "It is five o'clock on the sun" (Section 350-Section 351) has an impeccable surface and no settled use; "I know I am in pain" looks like a report and does no reporting work at all (Section 246). ANALYSIS: The conclusion is not that words have no stable meanings but that stability is conferred by **regular practice with standards**, not by a correlated object. That is why the doctrine leads directly to language-games (Session 5) and to forms of life (Session 6) rather than stopping at "context matters".

5. The three misreadings that cost the most marks ANALYSIS:

Misreading	Why it is wrong	The one-line correction to write
"Meaning is how often a word is used"	Frequency is a statistical fact about a population, not a normative role	Use is a role , not a rate
"Meaning is whatever the speaker intends "	This restores a private mental determinant, which the private-language argument then destroys	A speaker can misuse a word, and that possibility is what makes it a word
"Meaning is use, therefore anything goes"	Grammar, training and correction supply standards without a hidden essence	No essence is not no norm

ANALYSIS: There is also a genuine tension worth conceding rather than hiding, because conceding it earns the "critically discuss" mark: if meaning is use, how do we distinguish a **new** use from a **wrong** one? Poetic extension, metaphor, technical redefinition and simple error all look, from outside, like departures from established practice. Wittgenstein's resources are grammar, training and the surroundings of the utterance; whether those resources fix the boundary in every case is a live objection and appears in Session 13's ledger.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The doctrine that the meaning of a word is its use is not a rival theory of what meaning *is* but a redirection of enquiry away from the search for a correlated object and towards the norm-governed role an expression has in a practice. **Named evidence.** Section 1 quotes Augustine's account of learning language and identifies in it a picture on which every word names an object and every sentence combines names; Section 2-Section 4 answer it not by refutation but by constructing the builders' language of "Slab!", "Block!", "Pillar!", "Beam!", for which the picture is exactly right - showing it to be one primitive language-game generalised into an essence. Section 11 replaces the picture with the tool-box, Section 12 with the locomotive handles that look alike and work differently, and Section 43 states the thesis with its own limitation: "for a large class of cases - though not for all". **Analysis.** The redirection dissolves rather than answers a series of questions: what "the" or "five" or "perhaps" stands for; what object understanding consists in encountering; what sort of entity a meaning is. Section 199's formula - to understand a language is to be master of a technique - replaces an inner episode with an ability displayed in going on correctly, and Section 143-155 show why: the inner flash can occur without understanding and understanding can occur without the flash, so the flash was never the criterion. **Qualification.** The thesis is hedged in its own statement and must be quoted with the hedge, since Wittgenstein separates a name's bearer from its meaning at Section 40 and treats proper names distinctly at Section 79; nor does "use" mean frequency, usefulness or the speaker's private intention, since a speaker can misuse a word and that very possibility is what makes it a word. The residual difficulty, which Wittgenstein does not fully settle, is how established use is to be distinguished from innovation and from error without appeal to the essence he has removed.

Exam link

- **2023 Q4(c)** (15 marks): Section 1-2 supply the positive content of the "use-theory" the question names, and Section 5 supplies the critical half.
- **2025 Q3(a)** (20 marks): the quoted statement contrasts an ideal language with "the ways in which languages are actually used" - Section 1, 2 and 4 are the exposition of that phrase, and the Section 43 hedge prevents the answer from replacing one essence with another.
- **2018 Q1(c)** (10 marks): family resemblance is the *reason* meaning-as-use does not need an essence, so this session is the necessary first paragraph of that answer.
- **2020, 2024** (private language): the diary argument only bites because meaning requires a **rule of use**; without this session, the third limb has no premise.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
Quoting "the meaning of a word is its use" without the hedge	Section 43 says "for a large class of cases - though not for all"; the hedge is doctrine
"Wittgenstein refuted Augustine's theory"	Section 2-4 show the picture fits one primitive language-game; it is over-generalisation, not falsehood
"Use = usage frequency / usefulness"	Use is a norm-governed role ; a rare or useless sentence can be fully meaningful
"Meaning is use is a theory of meaning"	It is a reminder against essentialism; whether it is nevertheless a theory is the optional-block dispute
"Understanding is just behaviour"	Understanding is mastery of a technique ; performance is defeasible in both directions
"The bearer of the name is its meaning"	Section 40 separates them explicitly - when Mr N. N. dies, the name does not become meaningless

Revision notes

- **Section 1** Augustine -> picture: word names object, sentence combines names, meaning = the object correlated with the word.
- **Section 2-4** builders' language ("Slab!", "Block!", "Pillar!", "Beam!") - the picture fits **this** game; that is its status.

- **Section 11** tools in a tool-box · **Section 12** locomotive handles: uniform appearance, diverse function.
- **Section 40** the **bearer** of a name ≠ the **meaning** of a name.
- **Section 43** the thesis **with** its hedge: "for a large class of cases - though not for all".
- **Section 199** to understand a language = to be **master of a technique**; **Section 143-155** the pupil and the series.
- Use is a **norm-governed role**: not frequency, not usefulness, not private intention.
- Live objection: how to separate **new use** from **wrong use** - conceded, not concealed.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - MEANING AND USE

```

QUESTION 'What does this word mean?'
|
+--> LABEL MODEL (Augustinian picture, PI 1): find the object it stands for
|       works for 'table', 'Ram'
|       collapses for 'the', 'if', 'five', 'perhaps', 'meaning', 'pain'
|       STATUS: not false - ONE PRIMITIVE GAME over-generalised (2-4)
|
+--> TOOLBOX MODEL (11) + LEVER WARNING (12): uniform look, diverse function
|
v
THESIS (43): for a LARGE CLASS of cases - THOUGH NOT FOR ALL - the meaning
of a word is its USE in the language
|
+--> USE = norm-governed ROLE in a practice: circumstances + training +
|       permitted moves + standards of correctness
+--> NOT frequency · NOT usefulness · NOT private intention · NOT licence
|
v
UNDERSTANDING (199) = MASTERY OF A TECHNIQUE, shown in going on correctly
inner flash: neither necessary nor sufficient (143-155)
|
v
LEADS TO family resemblance (no essence needed) -> language-games (how uses
are organised) -> forms of life (what holds them in place)
|
v
ANSWER LINE: the question 'what does it stand for?' is not answered better -
it is shown to have been the wrong question for most of language

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SESSION 3 - OSTENSIVE DEFINITION, SAMPLES AND TRAINING: WHY POINTING IS NOT A FOUNDATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: It feels obvious that language gets connected to the world by pointing: you show a child a red patch, say "red", and the word is fixed. Wittgenstein's observation is that pointing on its own settles nothing, because the child has to already know *what kind of thing* is being pointed out - the colour? the shape? the number? the material? the direction? Pointing teaches only to someone who has already been prepared to be taught.

Technical definition: An **ostensive definition** explains a word by pointing at an object or sample and uttering the word. Wittgenstein argues (**Section 28-38**) that ostensive definition is **systematically ambiguous**: "*an ostensive definition can be variously interpreted in every case*" (Section 28). It succeeds only where the learner's **place in the language is already prepared** (Section 31) - where training, attention and the surrounding language-game have fixed what role the sample is to play. A **sample** used in explanation belongs to the **means of representation** rather than to what is represented: the colour chart used to explain "sepia" functions as a **standard within a practice**, not as an object whose nature guarantees its own application.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Ostensive definition looks like the point at which language touches the world, and Wittgenstein's argument is that it is nothing of the kind: pointing can teach only where a practice has already decided what is being pointed at, so the supposed foundation turns out to presuppose the building it was to support.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- "**can be variously interpreted in every case**" (**Section 28**) - the argument in one quoted clause

- the place in the language is already prepared (Section 31) - the positive condition, quoted
- sample as part of the method of representation (Section 50) - why the sample is not a super-object
- training (Abrichtung) - the primitive teaching that precedes explanation (Section 5, Section 6)
- regress of interpretations - the link forward to Section 201
- the chess-king analogy (Section 31) - showing what "already prepared" means

How to use them: state the ambiguity with **Section 28's** clause quoted, then immediately give the positive condition from **Section 31**, because an answer that only shows ostension failing sounds sceptical; use the **chess-king** analogy to make "already prepared" concrete in one sentence; and end by pointing forward to the **regress of interpretations**, which turns this session into the premise of the rule-following argument rather than an isolated observation.

Plain-language visual - one act of pointing, five possible lessons

```

THE TEACHER POINTS AT TWO RED SQUARES AND SAYS  'TWO'
=====
WHAT MIGHT THE LEARNER TAKE THE WORD TO MEAN?
'TWO'  ->  the NUMBER           (correct, as it happens)
'TWO'  ->  the COLOUR red       (why not? the samples are red)
'TWO'  ->  the SHAPE square     (why not? the samples are square)
'TWO'  ->  the MATERIAL card    (why not? both are card)
'TWO'  ->  THIS PARTICULAR PAIR (a proper name for these objects)
'TWO'  ->  the DIRECTION over there (the finger does point somewhere)
=====
NOTHING IN THE POINTING ITSELF EXCLUDES ANY OF THESE.
Adding words does not end the problem, it postpones it:
'This NUMBER is called two' - only helps if 'number' is already known
'This COLOUR is called sepia' - only helps if 'colour' is already known
=====
WHAT ACTUALLY MAKES IT WORK
PRIOR TRAINING      the learner has been drilled into a practice
A PREPARED PLACE (31) the language already has a slot for a
                     number-word, and the learner can recognise it
THE SURROUNDING GAME counting, sorting, ordering, checking
CORRECTION          the teacher intervenes when the learner
                     generalises wrongly, and this is the point at
                     which meaning is actually fixed
=====

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In simple words: teaching by pointing is like handing someone a chess piece and saying "this is the king". If they already play a board game with pieces, ranks and moves, the sentence teaches them something. If they have never seen a game at all, the sentence tells them almost nothing - they do not yet know that pieces have *roles*. Section 31 uses exactly this comparison, and it is the cheapest way to make the argument vivid in an answer.

Remember first	Meaning
The problem is not doubt	it is indeterminacy : nothing in the gesture selects a category
Adding "this colour..." helps	but only by borrowing understanding you already have
Training (<i>Abrichtung</i>) precedes explanation	Section 5-Section 6: the child is drilled before it is told
The sample is a tool , not a thing described	Section 50: the standard metre "has no length" in the game where it is the standard
The moral is not scepticism	ostension works - it just is not a foundation

One-line memory: pointing teaches only those who already know what sort of question the pointing answers.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the failure of ostension as a foundation, and what replaces it

THE FOUNDATIONALIST HOPE	THE ACTUAL STRUCTURE
=====	=====
WORD	WORD
^ meaning fixed by	^ meaning fixed by
OSTENSIVE DEFINITION	ROLE IN A LANGUAGE-GAME
^ which fixes itself by	^ sustained by
THE OBJECT POINTED AT	TRAINING + CORRECTION + SURROUNDINGS
	^ within which
	OSTENSION AND SAMPLES ARE USEFUL
	INSTRUMENTS - not foundations
=====	=====
THE THREE STEPS OF THE ARGUMENT	
1 AMBIGUITY (28) 'an ostensive definition can be variously interpreted in every case'. Pointing at two nuts and saying 'two' may teach number, colour, shape, material or name	
2 THE APPARENT REPAIR (29-30) add a category word: 'this NUMBER is called two'. But that only works if the learner already has the category. The repair BORROWS what it was meant to supply	
3 THE REAL CONDITION (31) the ostensive definition explains the use of a word 'when the place is already prepared'. Compare: 'this is the king' teaches a chess-learner who knows the shape of a game, and teaches almost nothing to someone who has never seen a game at all	
=====	
SAMPLES: WHAT KIND OF THING THEY ARE (50, 16)	
* A sample used in explaining a word belongs to the MEANS OF REPRESENTATION, like the colour chart or the standard metre	
* PI 50: of the standard metre in Paris one can say neither that it is one metre long nor that it is not - not because of a mysterious property, but because that is its ROLE in the game of measuring	
* So the sample does not carry its own instructions. It is a tool whose use has to be learned like any other	
=====	
WHAT THIS SESSION SETS UP -> if no explanation is self-applying, then understanding cannot consist in attaching a further INTERPRETATION. That is exactly the paradox of PI 201, and this is where the private-language argument gets its premise.	

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** This diagram is the hinge of the whole clause. The 2023 and 2025 transition answers use it to explain why naming could not remain the foundation of meaning; the 2020 and 2024 private-language answers use it because a **private** ostensive definition is exactly an ostensive definition stripped of the training, correction and prepared place that make public ostension work.

1. The argument from ambiguity FACT:

FACT: **Section 28:** one can ostensively define a proper name, a colour word, a number word, the name of a point of the compass - *"an ostensive definition can be variously interpreted in every case."* Point at two nuts and say "This is called 'two'", and the learner may take "two" to name that group of nuts, or their colour, or their kind, or their shape. Nothing in the pointing decides.

ANALYSIS: **The exact strength of the claim.** Wittgenstein is not saying that we cannot in fact teach words by pointing - obviously we can, and do, all day. He is saying that when we do, the success is not explained by the pointing. Something else is carrying the weight, and the philosophical picture that made ostension look foundational had concealed it. **WRONG:** Reading the passage as scepticism about ostension is a marked error; the passage is an inventory of what ostension needs.

2. Why adding a category-word does not repair the foundation FACT:

FACT: **Section 29-30:** the natural repair is to say "This **number** is called 'two'", or "This **colour** is called 'sepia'". But then the word "number" or "colour" must already be understood - and if it is explained ostensively in turn, the same ambiguity recurs. FACT: Section 30 draws the conclusion: *"one has already to know (or be able to do) something in order to be capable of asking a thing's name."*

ANALYSIS: This is a **regress**, and naming it as such is what raises an answer above narration. Each explanation stands in need of an explanation of the same kind, and the series terminates not in a self-explaining explanation but in **something one does**: reacting to training, going on in the trained way. That terminus is Section 201's "way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation" and Section 217's "This is simply what I do", and the connection should

be stated explicitly in any answer about either.

3. The prepared place, and the chess-king FACT:

FACT: **Section 31:** *"When one shows someone the king in chess and says: 'This is the king', this does not tell him the use of this piece - unless he already knows the rules of the game up to this last point: the shape of the king."*

Wittgenstein's conclusion is that an ostensive definition *"explains the use - the meaning - of the word when the overall role of the word in language is clear"*, or, in the formula worth quoting: **when the place is already prepared.**

ANALYSIS: **What "prepared" does and does not mean.** It does not mean that the learner must already possess the concept being taught - that would be viciously circular and would make learning impossible. It means the learner must already occupy the **practice**: be able to attend, to imitate, to be corrected, to recognise that a word is being introduced and that words have roles. Wittgenstein's account of that entry-level condition is **training (Abrichtung)** at Section 5-Section 6: the child is not first told what words mean and then set to use them; it is drilled into use, and explanation becomes possible later. ANALYSIS: *Abrichtung* is the word used for training an animal, and the choice is deliberate: the primitive stage is pre-explanatory. That is a point of interpretation and should be marked as one.

4. Samples belong to the method of representation FACT:

FACT: **Section 16:** if colour samples are shown along with the words in a language-game, it is most natural to count the samples as part of the **language** itself, not as objects the language is about. FACT: **Section 50:** of the standard metre in Paris one can say neither that it is one metre long nor that it is not - *"this is, of course, not to ascribe any extraordinary property to it, but only to mark its peculiar role in the language-game of measuring with a metre-rule."*

ANALYSIS: The philosophical payoff is large and directly examinable. If a sample were an ordinary object whose nature fixed the word's application, then a **private** sample - a remembered sensation - might do the same job in a private language. Section 50 removes that possibility in advance: a sample functions as a **standard** only because a practice of comparing, applying and correcting has given it that office. A private sensation has no such office, which is why the diary argument (Session 8) is not an isolated puzzle but the direct consequence of this session.

5. What survives: ostension is useful, not foundational ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: The positive residue should be stated explicitly, since "critically discuss" questions reward a candidate who says what a critique **leaves standing**:

1. Ostensive teaching genuinely works, and Wittgenstein never denies it.
2. Samples are indispensable instruments of explanation - colour charts, the standard metre, a paradigm shade.
3. What fails is only the **philosophical office** ostension was given: the office of connecting language to reality once and for all, from outside all practice.
4. Meaning is therefore constrained but not arbitrary: human reactions, materials, purposes and established practice narrow what can count as teaching or as following. ANALYSIS: **No essence is not no norm.**

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Ostensive definition cannot be the foundation of meaning, because it explains a word only where a practice has already fixed what is being indicated - so the supposed point of contact between language and world presupposes the language it was to ground. **Named evidence.** Section 28 states that an ostensive definition can be variously interpreted in every case: pointing at two nuts while saying "two" may teach the number, the colour, the shape, the material or a proper name. Section 29-30 show that the obvious repair - "this *number* is called two" - merely borrows an understanding of "number", so that "one has already to know (or be able to do) something in order to be capable of asking a thing's name". Section 31 gives the positive condition through the chess-king: being shown the king teaches the piece's use only to someone who already knows the shape of the game, and the ostensive definition works "when the place is already prepared". Section 50 adds that a sample belongs to the means of representation, since the standard metre is neither one metre long nor not. **Analysis.** The argument is a regress argument rather than a sceptical one. Every explanation of a word stands in need of an explanation of the same kind, and the series does not terminate in a self-interpreting item; it terminates in trained action, which is why Section 5-Section 6 place *Abrichtung* before explanation and why Section 201 will deny that grasping a rule is attaching an interpretation. The immediate consequence for the third printed limb is decisive: a private ostensive definition is precisely ostension stripped of training, correction and prepared place, so whatever weight public ostension could not bear alone, private ostension cannot bear at all. **Qualification.** None of this makes ostensive teaching ineffective or samples dispensable; what is refused is only the philosophical office of grounding meaning from outside every practice. Nor does the argument make meaning conventional in the sense of arbitrary, since human reactions, the materials involved and established applications constrain what can count as teaching and as following - the absence of an essence is not the absence of a norm.

Exam link

- **2023 Q4(c)** (15 marks): ostension's failure is one of the "main reasons" for the shift and is the reason *naming* could not stay foundational.
- **2025 Q3(a)** (20 marks): the quoted contrast between an ideal language and actual use is sharpened by showing that even the most "direct" link - pointing - is practice-dependent.
- **2020 Q4(c)** and **2024 Q1(d)** (private language): this session supplies the premise. A private ostensive definition is an ostensive definition minus every condition Section 31 identified.
- **2018 Q1(c)**: Section 31's "prepared place" is the same idea that makes family-resemblance concepts teachable without a definition.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Wittgenstein says we cannot teach words by pointing"	We plainly can; his claim is that the pointing is not what does the work
"Adding 'this colour' solves the problem"	Section 29-30: it borrows the understanding it was to supply, and the regress restarts
"The prepared place means already having the concept"	It means already occupying the practice - attending, imitating, being corrected
"The standard metre has a mysterious property"	Section 50: it has a role in the game of measuring, not an extraordinary length
"Samples are objects the language describes"	Section 16, Section 50: they belong to the means of representation
Treating this session as separate from private language	It is the premise of the diary argument; say so

Revision notes

- **Section 28** an ostensive definition "can be variously interpreted in every case" - number, colour, shape, material, proper name, direction.

- **Section 29-30** the category-word repair borrows understanding: "one has already to know (or be able to do) something in order to be capable of asking a thing's name."
- **Section 31 chess-king**: "This is the king" teaches only one who knows the shape of the game - the **place must already be prepared**.
- **Section 5-6 training (Abrichtung)** precedes explanation; the term is that used for animal training, and the choice is deliberate.
- **Section 16, Section 50** samples belong to the **means of representation**; the standard metre is neither one metre long nor not.
- Structure: **ambiguity -> failed repair -> prepared place -> regress -> trained action**, which is Section 201's terminus.
- Positive residue: ostension **works**; what fails is its philosophical office as a foundation.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - OSTENSION AND SAMPLES

```
POINTING + WORD ('two', while indicating two nuts)
|
+--> AMBIGUITY (28): number? colour? shape? material? this pair? direction?
|
+--> REPAIR ATTEMPT (29): 'this NUMBER is called two'
|   -> only works if 'number' is already understood (30)
|   -> REGRESS: each explanation needs an explanation of the same kind
|
v
CONDITION (31): the ostensive definition explains the use WHEN THE PLACE IS
ALREADY PREPARED [chess-king: teaches only one who knows what a game is]
|
+--> what prepares the place: TRAINING (Abrichtung, 5-6) + the surrounding
game + CORRECTION when the learner generalises wrongly
|
+--> SAMPLES (16, 50): part of the MEANS OF REPRESENTATION; the standard
metre is neither one metre long nor not - that is its ROLE
|
v
TERMINUS: explanation ends not in a self-interpreting item but in TRAINED
ACTION -> PI 201 'a way of grasping a rule which is not an
interpretation' -> PI 217 'This is simply what I do'
|
v
CONSEQUENCE FOR LIMB 3: private ostension is ostension minus training,
minus correction, minus a prepared place - so it cannot fix a standard
|
v
ANSWER LINE: pointing does not connect language to the world; a practice
already connected to the world makes pointing intelligible
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SESSION 4 - FAMILY RESEMBLANCE: "DON'T THINK, BUT LOOK!" AND THE END OF THE ESSENCE-DEMAND

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Ask what all games have in common and you will find nothing that fits every case: not winning and losing (patience), not competition (ring-a-ring-a-roses), not skill (dice), not amusement (professional sport is work). Yet "game" is a perfectly good word that nobody has trouble using. Wittgenstein's point is that a word can be in perfect order without there being one feature shared by everything it applies to.

Technical definition: Family resemblance (Familienähnlichkeit) is the relation Wittgenstein finds among the things a general term covers when no single feature is common to them all: *"a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing" - "sometimes overall similarities, sometimes similarities of detail"* (Section 66). He names it at **Section 67**: *"I can think of no better expression to characterise these similarities than 'family resemblances'; for the various resemblances between members of a family - build, features, colour of eyes, gait, temperament, etc. etc. - overlap and criss-cross in the same way."* The instruction that introduces it is **Section 66's** *"Don't think, but look!"* - an instruction about **method** before it is a claim about concepts.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Family resemblance is not the discovery that concepts are vague; it is the removal of a demand - the Socratic demand that anyone who uses a word competently must be able to state what all its instances share - and once that demand goes, the claim that language is a game stops being a metaphor and becomes a description.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **"Don't think, but look!" (Section 66)** - the methodological instruction, quoted
- **overlapping and criss-crossing similarities** - the exact image, not "vagueness"
- **the thread and its fibres (Section 67)** - the strength-without-a-core analogy
- **boundary that can be drawn but has not been (Section 68-69)** - the precise status of open texture
- **"blurred edges" and the photograph (Section 71)** - why an inexact concept is still usable
- **extensible / open-textured concept** - the technical label for the result

How to use them: lead with the **method** (*"Don't think, but look!"*) rather than with the conclusion, because the examiner in 2018 asked how family resemblance *helps* Wittgenstein - which is a question about argumentative work, not about definition; and reach the **thread analogy** early, since it pre-empts the standard objection that resemblance without a core cannot hold a concept together.

Plain-language visual - five games, and the feature that keeps failing

LOOK FOR THE ONE THING THEY ALL SHARE

	AMUSE- MENT	COMPE- TITION	WIN / LOSE	SKILL	RULES	LUCK
CHES	yes	yes	yes	yes	yes	no
PATIENCE	yes	no	yes*	some	yes	yes
RING-A-RING- A-ROSES	yes	no	no	no	yes	no
THROWING A BALL AT A WALL	yes	no	no	some	no	no
OLYMPIC FINAL	not for the player	yes	yes	yes	yes	some

EVERY COLUMN HAS AT LEAST ONE 'no'. There is no row of all-yes features.

* even 'winning' shifts sense: in patience one wins against the cards

WHAT WE SEE INSTEAD: chess ~ patience (rules, winning)
 patience ~ ball-at-wall (solitary, pastime)
 ball-at-wall ~ ring-a-ring (no winner, bodily play)
 ring-a-ring ~ chess (rules, turns)

A CHAIN OF OVERLAPS, WITH NO LINK RUNNING THROUGH THE WHOLE.

In simple words: think of a large family photograph. One brother has the father's nose and the mother's eyes; a sister has the father's build and neither nose nor eyes; a cousin has the gait and the temperament and nothing else. Everyone looks unmistakably like a member of that family, and no single feature runs through all of them. Wittgenstein says that many of our most important words - *game, language, number, proposition, understanding* - hang together in exactly that way.

Remember first	Meaning
Family resemblance is a claim about some concepts	"triangle" and "prime number" are still sharply defined
It denies a requirement , not a possibility	it says an essence is not <i>needed</i> , not that one can never be found
It is not the claim "no two games share anything"	plainly they do; there is simply no feature shared by all
Blurred edges do not disable a concept	Section 71: an indistinct photograph is often exactly the picture we need
The boundary can be drawn for a purpose	Section 69: we can fix one; we have not needed to

One-line memory: the word works because the family is real, not because a hidden ancestor is common to every member.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the argument's four moves, and the four things it does not claim

MOVE 1 - THE METHOD (PI 66)

'Don't say: "There MUST be something common, or they would not be called 'games'" - but LOOK and SEE whether there is anything common to all.'

-> The word MUST is doing the damage. It is a demand carried to the facts, not a result read off them.

MOVE 2 - THE SURVEY (PI 66)

Board-games, card-games, ball-games, Olympic games, war-games, ring-a-ring-a-roses, patience, throwing a ball at a wall. Amusement fails · competition fails · winning and losing fails · skill fails · rules fail · luck fails.

RESULT: 'a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing'.

MOVE 3 - THE NAME AND THE ANALOGY (PI 67)

FAMILY RESEMBLANCES: build, features, colour of eyes, gait, temperament - overlapping and criss-crossing.

THE THREAD: 'we extend our concept ... as in spinning a thread we twist fibre on fibre. And the strength of the thread does not reside in the fact that some one fibre runs through its whole length, but in the overlapping of many fibres.'

-> STRENGTH WITHOUT A CORE. This single image answers the objection that a concept without an essence must fall apart.

MOVE 4 - THE STATUS OF THE BOUNDARY (PI 68-71, 75-77)

68 The concept of number is a family too: cardinal, rational, real - related as fibres, not as species of one genus

69 We can DRAW a boundary for a special purpose. 'We do not know the boundaries because none have been drawn' - not because they are hidden

70 'But then the use of the word is unregulated!' - It is not everywhere circumscribed by rules; nor is tennis, and tennis is still a game

71 The blurred concept: 'Is an indistinct photograph always preferable to a sharp one? Isn't the indistinct one often exactly what we need?'

FOUR THINGS THE DOCTRINE DOES NOT CLAIM - each is a marked error

X That NO concept has necessary and sufficient conditions

X That no two games have anything in common

X That definition is impossible or worthless

X That anything may therefore be called a game (unlimited resemblance)

THE STANDARD OBJECTION, AND THE REPLY THE EXAMINER WANTS

OBJECTION Everything resembles everything in SOME respect. A network of 'similarities' is therefore no constraint at all: a chair resembles chess in being man-made.

REPLY Relevance is fixed by the PRACTICE, not by bare resemblance: by what we do with games, how the word is taught, which extensions are accepted and which are corrected. The concept is bounded by USE, not by definition.

RESIDUE Whether 'use' bounds it tightly enough in every case is a genuine open question - concede it, and the answer earns the 'critically' mark.

ANALYSIS: Caption. The 2018 ten-mark part asks how family resemblance **helps** Wittgenstein uphold that "Language is a game". The right-hand column of Move 4 is the answer's second half, and the Objection-Reply-Residue block is its conclusion.

1. Why the doctrine is a reply, not a discovery FACT:

FACT: The setting is Section 65, where an imagined interlocutor confronts Wittgenstein with exactly the objection his own early work would have pressed: you talk about language-games but never say what the essence of a language-game - and so of language - is; you have let yourself off the very part of the investigation that once gave you most trouble. Section 66 is the answer to that challenge.

ANALYSIS: This context is worth two sentences in any answer, because it fixes the doctrine's **job**. Family resemblance is not offered as a contribution to the theory of concepts; it is offered to show that Wittgenstein's refusal to define "language" is not an evasion. Once the demand for one essence is diagnosed as a demand rather than a requirement, the entire method of Sessions 2 and 5 becomes legitimate. ANALYSIS: That is why the 2018 question is phrased as "helps him to uphold" - it asks for the argumentative service the concept performs.

2. The survey, done properly FACT:

FACT: Wittgenstein does not assert that games have nothing in common; he **conducts an inspection**: *"look for example at board-games, with their multifarious relationships. Now pass to card-games; here you find many correspondences with the first group, but many common features drop out, and others appear."* Ball-games retain much and lose much. In ring-a-ring-a-roses there is amusement but no competition and no winner. Patience is played alone. Throwing a ball at a wall against one's own record has skill and luck but no opponent.

ANALYSIS: **The methodological point is more important than the list.** Any single candidate-feature can be defeated by producing a case, and the survey shows how: not by refuting a definition in the abstract but by walking through instances until the proposed common feature fails. This is precisely the "description, not explanation" of Section 109 in operation, and an answer that says so has connected the doctrine to the method.

3. The thread: strength without a core FACT:

FACT: **Section 67**: *"And I shall say: 'games' form a family."* And of the extension of the number concept: *"we extend our concept of number as in spinning a thread we twist fibre on fibre. And the strength of the thread does not reside in the fact that some one fibre runs through its whole length, but in the overlapping of many fibres."*

ANALYSIS: This is the image that does the argumentative work, because it answers the natural anxiety - *if there is no common core, what holds the concept together?* - with a counter-example from ordinary life. A rope is strong; no fibre runs its length. ANALYSIS: The image also fixes the doctrine's limits: a thread is not infinitely extensible, and fibres must actually overlap. Resemblance is not enough; **continuity of overlap within a practice** is what the analogy asserts.

4. Open texture: exactly how far the concept is undetermined FACT:

FACT: **Section 68**: the concept of number is itself a family - cardinal, rational, real, complex - related through overlapping affinities, and one may say "the concept of number is defined as the logical sum of these", but that is a decision to draw a boundary, not the discovery of one. FACT: **Section 69**: *"How should we explain to someone what a game is? ... And this is how we play it."* And: we do not know the boundaries **because none have been drawn** - though *"we can draw a boundary - for a special purpose"*. FACT: **Section 70-Section 71**: the interlocutor protests that an unbounded concept is unusable; Wittgenstein replies that the use of the word "game" is *not everywhere circumscribed by rules* - but neither is tennis, which has no rule for how high one may throw the ball, and tennis remains a game.

ANALYSIS: **Open texture is not arbitrariness**, and this is the sentence that must appear in an answer. Training, examples, correction and established applications give family-resemblance concepts a **local normative shape** even without one essence. A candidate who writes "so anything can be called a game" has stated the objection and mistaken it for the doctrine.

5. Why this licenses "language is a game" ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: Assembling the 2018 answer requires four connected steps, and it is worth writing them as steps:

1. **The demand disarmed.** Because a general term need not have an essence, the refusal to define "language" is not a defect in the account.
2. **The analogy earned.** "Game" is itself the paradigm family-resemblance concept, so calling linguistic activities *language-games* is not an evasion by metaphor - it is the application of the very concept that showed essences to be unnecessary.
3. **The positive picture supplied.** Games have training, rules, moves, standards and points **without** an essence. That is exactly the combination language was thought to require an essence to possess - so the analogy delivers precisely what the *Tractatus* wanted from logical form, without the metaphysics.
4. **The relativism blocked.** Since games are norm-governed, describing language as a family of games does not make meaning arbitrary; it locates the norms in practice rather than in an essence.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Family resemblance allows Wittgenstein to describe language as a family of games without owing anyone a definition of language, because it shows that a general term can be in perfect working order even where no feature is common to all its instances. **Named evidence.** Section 65 puts the objection in the interlocutor's mouth - that Wittgenstein nowhere says what the essence of a language-game is - and Section 66 replies with an instruction rather than a thesis: "Don't say: 'There must be something common' ... but look and see." The survey of board-games, card-games, ball-games, Olympic games, ring-a-ring-a-roses and patience defeats amusement, competition, winning and losing, skill and luck in turn, leaving "a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing"; Section 67 names the relation from the resemblances among members of a family and illustrates its strength by the spun thread, whose strength lies not in one fibre running the whole length but in the overlapping of many. **Analysis.** The doctrine therefore performs a specific argumentative service. It removes the Socratic requirement that competent users be able to state necessary and sufficient conditions, and in doing so it converts "language is a game" from a metaphor into a description: games possess training, rules, moves and standards without possessing an essence, which is exactly the combination the *Tractatus* believed only a shared logical form could supply. Section 69-71 fix the status of the resulting boundary - it is undrawn rather than hidden, may be drawn for a special purpose, and its absence no more disables "game" than the absence of a rule about throwing height disables tennis. **Qualification.** The claim is bounded in three ways that a careless answer loses: it does not assert that no concept admits of strict definition, since "triangle" plainly does; it does not assert that no two games share any feature; and it does not license the inference that anything may be called a game, because the relevant similarities are selected by the practice in which the word is taught and corrected. The strongest surviving objection is that bare resemblance is too cheap to constrain anything - everything resembles everything somehow - and Wittgenstein's reply, that relevance is fixed by use rather than by resemblance, is persuasive without being demonstrative.

Exam link

- **2018 Q1(c)** (10 marks) - "How does the notion of 'family resemblance' help Wittgenstein to uphold that 'Language is a game'? Discuss." Section 5's four steps are the skeleton of the answer; Section 3's thread image is the sentence that earns the analytical mark; Section 4's open-texture caution is the qualification.
- **2023 Q4(c)** (15 marks): the demand for one essence is precisely what colour exclusion and the missing simples had strained, so family resemblance is the constructive half of the "reasons for the shift".
- **2025 Q3(a)** (20 marks): it explains why the later position does not simply install "use" as a new essence.
- **2022 Q1(c)** (10 marks): "form of life" is likewise a family-resemblance notion and must not be turned into a doctrine with sharp edges.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Family resemblance proves definitions are impossible"	It shows not all concepts require them; "triangle" and "prime" still do
"No two games share any property"	Many share several; there is simply no feature shared by all
"So anything can be called a game"	Relevance is selected by the practice; open texture is not arbitrariness
"It is a theory of vagueness"	Section 71 treats blurred edges as often exactly what we need , not as a defect
"Wittgenstein says we don't know where the boundary is"	Section 69: none has been drawn ; we may draw one for a purpose
Listing games instead of arguing	The 2018 verb is "help ... to uphold"; the marks are in the argumentative service

Revision notes

- **Section 65** the interlocutor's challenge: you never say what the essence of language is. Family resemblance is the reply.
- **Section 66** "Don't think, but look!"; the survey defeats amusement, competition, winning/losing, skill, rules and luck in turn; result = "a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing".
- **Section 67** the name (**family resemblances**: build, features, eyes, gait, temperament) and the **thread**: strength from overlapping fibres, not one fibre running through.
- **Section 68** number is itself a family; **Section 69** boundaries are **undrawn**, not hidden, and may be drawn for a purpose; **Section 70** tennis has no rule for throwing height; **Section 71** the indistinct photograph is often what we need.
- Four denials: not "no concept has an essence"; not "no two games share anything"; not "definition is worthless"; not "anything counts".
- Objection: everything resembles everything. Reply: **practice selects the relevant similarities**. Residue: whether it always does so tightly enough.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FAMILY RESEMBLANCE

```
CHALLENGE (65): 'You never say what the ESSENCE of language is'
|
v
INSTRUCTION (66): 'Don't think, but LOOK!' - the word MUST is the disease
|
+--> SURVEY: board · card · ball · Olympic · ring-a-ring · patience ·
|           ball-at-wall. amusement X competition X win/lose X skill X
|           rules X luck X
|
v
RESULT (66): a complicated network of SIMILARITIES OVERLAPPING AND
CRISS-CROSSING
|
v
NAME + ANALOGY (67): FAMILY RESEMBLANCE; the THREAD - strength from
overlapping fibres, no single fibre running the whole length
|
+--> BOUNDARY (68-71): undrawn, not hidden · drawable for a purpose ·
|           not everywhere circumscribed - nor is tennis · blurred edges are
|           often exactly what we need
|
v
SERVICE RENDERED: no essence is REQUIRED -> 'language is a game' is a
description, not an evasion -> games have rules, training, moves and
standards WITHOUT an essence
|
v
OBJECTION everything resembles everything | REPLY practice selects relevant
similarities | RESIDUE does use always bound it tightly enough?
|
v
ANSWER LINE: the demand for one essence is removed, not satisfied - and the
concept survives, as a rope survives without a single fibre
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SESSION 5 - LANGUAGE-GAMES: LANGUAGE WOVEN INTO ACTIVITY, THE BUILDERS, AND GRAMMAR

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A language-game is not a game *about* language. It is any stretch of language taken together with the activity it belongs to - giving an order and obeying it, describing an object, reporting a measurement, telling a joke, asking, thanking, cursing, praying. Wittgenstein invents simple ones, describes real ones, and puts them side by side, because seeing two different uses next to each other cures the illusion that there must be one thing that all uses are.

Technical definition: A language-game (**Sprachspiel**) is "the whole, consisting of language and the actions into which it is woven" (**Section 7**). The term is used for three distinct purposes and an answer should separate them: (i)

for **invented primitive languages** used as objects of comparison (Section 2's builders); (ii) for **the processes of naming and repeating words** by which children are trained into language (Section 7); and (iii) for the **actual, complete practices** of a functioning language, of which Section 23 gives a long, deliberately heterogeneous list. **Grammar**, in Wittgenstein's extended sense, is the body of rules and distinctions that fix what makes sense within such a practice - and grammatical remarks, unlike empirical ones, describe what we call a thing rather than what it is like.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The language-game is not an analogy borrowed to decorate a theory of meaning; it is an instrument of comparison, and its whole point is that placing two uses side by side does what no definition of "language" could do - it makes the craving for a single essence visibly unnecessary.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **"the whole, consisting of language and the actions into which it is woven" (Section 7)** - the definition, quoted
- **objects of comparison (Section 130-Section 131)** - the exact methodological status of invented games
- **the builders: "Slab!", "Block!", "Pillar!", "Beam!" (Section 2)** - the worked case
- **Section 23's list** - ordering, describing, reporting, speculating, play-acting, joking, thanking, cursing, greeting, praying
- **"the speaking of language is part of an activity, or of a form of life" (Section 23)** - the bridge to Session 6
- **grammar / surface and depth grammar (Section 664)** - the tool that exposes category-confusion

How to use them: define the term with **Section 7** quoted, then immediately state the **object-of-comparison** status from Section 130-131, because that single move blocks the objection that Wittgenstein has replaced a theory with an anecdote; use the **builders** as the worked case rather than as a story; and quote **Section 23's** closing clause to make the transition to forms of life a citation instead of an assertion.

Plain-language visual - one order, one action, one complete language

THE BUILDERS' LANGUAGE (PI 2)

A (the builder)		B (the assistant)	
		^	
	calls out 'Slab!'		brings a slab
+-----+			
	calls out 'Block!'		brings a block
	calls out 'Pillar!'		brings a pillar
	calls out 'Beam!'		brings a beam

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FOUR WORDS. NO GRAMMAR OF THE SCHOOLBOOK KIND. NO SENTENCES.
AND YET: 'Conceive this as a COMPLETE primitive language.'

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WHAT THE EXAMPLE ESTABLISHES - four things, all examinable

- 1 A language can be complete FOR ITS PURPOSE without describing anything
- 2 The words are not names in the Augustinian sense: 'Slab!' is nearer to an ORDER than to a label. Its meaning is its role in the transaction
- 3 Meaning is displayed in the TRAINED RESPONSE - B's bringing the slab
- 4 A description of Augustine's picture fits THIS game exactly. That is the picture's true status: one game, not the essence of all

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WHAT THE EXAMPLE DOES NOT ESTABLISH

- X That real languages have no grammar or structure
- X That primitive is 'better' or more fundamental
- X That every language-game is as simple as this one

OBJECTS OF COMPARISON (130-131): invented games are 'set up as objects of comparison which are meant to throw light on the features of our language by way not only of similarities, but also of DISSIMILARITIES'

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In simple words: the builders are not a theory of language and not a claim about how language began. They are a measuring stick laid alongside our language. Held up against them, the question "but what do all these words *stand for*?" starts to look like asking what a hammer and a glue-pot both point at.

Remember first	Meaning
Section 7 defines the term to include the actions	not the words alone, and not the words plus a context
Invented games are objects of comparison	not hypotheses about origins or about children
The builders' language is complete	complete for its purpose - that is the whole of the claim
Section 23's list is deliberately heterogeneous	the disorder is the argument
Games are norm-governed	rules by training and correction , often without a rulebook

One-line memory: language-games are not what language is *like*; they are how language is *looked at*.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the three uses of the term, Section 23's list, and what "grammar" means here

USE 1 INVENTED PRIMITIVE LANGUAGES PI 2, 8, 48, 130-131

Purpose: OBJECTS OF COMPARISON. Not simplified models of our language, not hypotheses about its origin. They illuminate BY DIFFERENCE as much as by likeness.

USE 2 THE TRAINING PROCESSES BY WHICH LANGUAGE IS LEARNED PI 7

Naming, repeating after someone, pointing and saying. 'I shall also call the whole, consisting of language and the actions into which it is woven, the language-game.'

USE 3 ACTUAL COMPLETE PRACTICES PI 23

'Giving orders, and obeying them - Describing the appearance of an object, or giving its measurements - Constructing an object from a description (a drawing) - Reporting an event - Speculating about an event - Forming and testing a hypothesis - Presenting the results of an experiment in tables and diagrams - Making up a story; and reading it - Play-acting - Singing catches - Guessing riddles - Making a joke; telling it - Solving a problem in practical arithmetic - Translating from one language into another - Asking, thanking, cursing, greeting, praying.'

AND THE CLOSING CLAUSE THAT MATTERS MOST:

'the speaking of language is part of an activity, or of a FORM OF LIFE'

WHY THE LIST IS DISORDERLY ON PURPOSE

A tidy taxonomy would suggest an underlying principle of division. The list mixes the trivial with the solemn, the theoretical with the bodily, precisely to defeat that suggestion. 23 also says: 'this multiplicity is not something fixed, given once for all; but new types of language, new language-games, as we may say, come into existence, and others become obsolete and get forgotten.'

GRAMMAR - WITTGENSTEIN'S EXTENDED SENSE

- * Rules and distinctions that fix what MAKES SENSE in a practice
- * 371 'ESSENCE is expressed by grammar' | 373 'Grammar tells what kind of object anything is' -> the question 'what IS an X?' becomes 'how is the word X used?'
- * 496 grammar is not an explanation but a DESCRIPTION of the use of signs
- * 664 SURFACE grammar (how a word is constructed and sounds) vs DEPTH grammar (its actual employment). 'I mean...' and 'I intend...' look alike on the surface; their depth grammar differs
- * The diagnostic use: 'It is 5 o'clock on the sun' (350-351) is grammatically impeccable and has no determined use. The trouble is not falsity - it is that no game has been specified

ANALYSIS: Caption. The 2018 part needs Use 3 and the Section 23 closing clause; the 2023 and 2025 transition parts need Use 1 and the object-of-comparison status; every private-language answer needs the grammar row, because the whole third limb is a grammatical investigation of sensation-words.

1. The definition, and the reason for the word "game" FACT:

FACT: Section 7: having described the builders and the training processes, Wittgenstein writes: *"I shall also call the whole, consisting of language and the actions into which it is woven, the 'language-game'."* The unit of investigation is therefore never the sentence alone. It is sentence-plus-circumstance-plus-activity-plus-response.

ANALYSIS: **Why "game" and not "practice" or "institution"?** Because games are the paradigm of something rule-governed without an essence (Session 4) - which is exactly what Wittgenstein needs language to be. The word also carries three further connotations he uses: that there are **moves**, that there is **training**, and that a move is intelligible only within the game. WRONG: It does **not** carry the connotations of triviality, of arbitrary invention or of competition, and the objection "language is too serious to be a game" trades on precisely the connotations he does not use.

2. The builders, worked rather than told FACT:

FACT: **Section 2:** *"Let us imagine a language ... The language is meant to serve for communication between a builder A and an assistant B. A is building with building-stones: there are blocks, pillars, slabs and beams. B has to pass the stones, and that in the order in which A needs them. For this purpose they use a language consisting of the words 'block', 'pillar', 'slab', 'beam'. A calls them out; - B brings the stone which he has learnt to bring at such-and-such a call. - Conceive this as a complete primitive language."*

The four things the example establishes are set out in the plain-language visual above. ANALYSIS: The subtlest is the second. Is "Slab!" a word or a sentence? Section 19 raises exactly this and refuses to settle it by fiat: it may be an elliptical form of "Bring me a slab", or the "elliptical" sentence in our language may be a lengthened form of theirs. Section 20 draws the moral - whether a word functions as an order does not depend on its length but on its place in the practice. ANALYSIS: This is where the example turns from illustration into argument, and where a script that merely narrates it loses the mark.

3. The heterogeneous list, and the historicity of games FACT:

FACT: **Section 23** first asks how many kinds of sentence there are and answers: *"there are countless kinds"* - and, crucially, *"this multiplicity is not something fixed, given once for all; but new types of language, new language-games, as we may say, come into existence, and others become obsolete and get forgotten."* Then comes the list - orders, descriptions, measurements, constructing from a drawing, reporting, speculating, hypothesis, tables and diagrams, story, play-acting, catches, riddles, jokes, practical arithmetic, translation, asking, thanking, cursing, greeting, praying - and the closing clause: *"the speaking of language is part of an activity, or of a form of life."*

ANALYSIS: Three examinable consequences follow, and they are worth numbering in an answer:

1. **Against one essence** - the list's disorder is the argument, since a common feature covering praying, measuring and cursing is not going to be found by looking harder.
2. **Against the primacy of description** - describing is *one item on the list*, not the paradigm of which the rest are deviations. The *Tractatus*, and logical positivism after it, had made fact-stating the centre.
3. **Language is historical** - games arise and die. This is what allows Wittgenstein to treat conceptual change without a theory of conceptual change.

4. Rules, training, and why this is not conventionalism FACT:

FACT: Language-games are norm-governed, but the norms are typically instilled by **training, examples and correction** rather than stated in a rulebook. Section 54 makes the distinction explicitly: a rule may be taught explicitly, or it may be learned as one learns a game - by watching how others play, and by being corrected. Section 31 (Session 3) has already shown that explicit statement cannot be the foundation in any case.

ANALYSIS: **Three cautions that keep this from collapsing into conventionalism.** First, "rule-governed" does not mean "everywhere circumscribed by rules" (Section 68, Section 84): games have unregulated regions and remain games. Second, the participants do not choose the rules the way a committee chooses a constitution; they are trained into them. Third - and this is the point that separates Wittgenstein from a merely sociological account - the possibility of **correction** is what makes something a rule at all, and correction is not the same as majority behaviour. Session 7 supplies the argument; here it is enough to mark that "game" implies **standards**, not caprice.

5. Grammar, surface and depth FACT:

FACT: **Section 371:** "Essence is expressed by grammar." FACT: **Section 373:** "Grammar tells what kind of object anything is." The metaphysical question *what is a number? what is time? what is the mind?* is thereby transformed into a question about the use of a word - which is the therapeutic method (Session 11) in its working form. FACT: **Section 496:** grammar does not explain but **describes** the use of signs. FACT: **Section 664:** in the use of a word one may distinguish **surface grammar** - how it is constructed, what part of speech it appears to be - from **depth grammar**, its actual employment. "I mean this" and "I intend this" have similar surface grammar and different depth grammar.

ANALYSIS: **The diagnostic pay-off.** Section 350-351 supply the standard case: "It is 5 o'clock on the sun" is impeccable on the surface and has no settled application, because our practice of telling the time is tied to local noon on the earth. The sentence is not **false**; no game has been specified in which it makes a move. ANALYSIS: This is the exact form the private-language diagnosis will take: the diarist's "S" is not a lie and not a falsehood, it is a sign for which no game has been provided.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The language-game is best understood as an instrument of comparison rather than as a theory: by taking as the unit of investigation "the whole, consisting of language and the actions into which it is woven", Wittgenstein makes the diversity of linguistic function visible and thereby makes the demand for a single essence look like a craving rather than a requirement. **Named evidence.** Section 2 constructs the builders' language of "block", "pillar", "slab" and "beam" and instructs us to conceive it as a *complete* primitive language; Section 7 gives the definition, and Section 19-20 refuse to settle by fiat whether "Slab!" is a word or a sentence, since what makes it an order is its place in the transaction rather than its length. Section 23 states that there are countless kinds of sentence, that new games arise and old ones are forgotten, and lists orders, descriptions, measurements, reports, hypotheses, tables, stories, play-acting, riddles, jokes, translation, asking, thanking, cursing, greeting and praying, before concluding that "the speaking of language is part of an activity, or of a form of life". Section 130-131 fix the status of the invented cases as objects of comparison meant to illuminate by dissimilarity as much as by likeness. **Analysis.** Three consequences follow directly. The disorder of Section 23's list is itself the argument against one essence, since no feature covering praying, measuring and cursing will be found by looking harder. Describing appears in the list as one item, which demotes fact-stating from the paradigm it had been in the *Tractatus* and in logical positivism. And because games are norm-governed through training and correction rather than through codification, the account supplies standards without an essence - which is what the *Tractatus* had believed only a shared logical form could do. **Qualification.** The analogy must not be pressed where Wittgenstein does not press it: language-games are not trivial, not invented at will, and not everywhere circumscribed by rules, any more than tennis is; nor are the invented languages hypotheses about the origin of language or about child development. Their function is comparative, and an account that treats them as simplified models of our own language has already lost the methodological point.

Exam link

- **2018 Q1(c)** (10 marks): the second half of the answer - family resemblance removes the essence-demand, and the language-game supplies the positive description that replaces it.
- **2022 Q1(c)** (10 marks): Section 23's closing clause is the textual bridge to "form of life" and should be quoted there.
- **2023 Q4(c)** and **2025 Q3(a)**: Section 130-131 explain what replaced analysis - comparison, not a rival theory.
- **2020 Q4(c)**, **2024 Q1(d)**: the grammar row (Section 350-351, Section 664) is the model for the private-language verdict: not false, but no game specified.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Language-games are games about language"	Section 7: language plus the actions into which it is woven
"The builders' language is a model of real language"	Section 130-131: an object of comparison , illuminating by dissimilarity too
"Language-games are arbitrary, invented at will"	They are entered by training ; correction is possible; standards are real
"Wittgenstein says language has no rules"	It is not everywhere circumscribed by rules - nor is tennis (Section 68, Section 84)
Treating description as the paradigm case	Section 23 lists describing as one kind among many; that demotion is the point
Reading Section 23 as a taxonomy	Its disorder is deliberate and is itself the argument

Revision notes

- **Section 7** definition: *the whole, consisting of language and the actions into which it is woven*.
- **Section 2** builders: "block", "pillar", "slab", "beam"; a **complete primitive language**; **Section 19-20** whether "Slab!" is word or sentence is settled by **role**, not length.
- **Section 23** countless kinds; the multiplicity is **not fixed**; games arise and are forgotten; the list (orders, measurements, hypotheses, tables, story, play-acting, riddles, jokes, arithmetic, translation, asking, thanking, cursing, greeting, praying); closing clause: **part of an activity, or of a form of life**.
- **Section 130-131** invented games are **objects of comparison** - by dissimilarity as much as similarity.
- **Grammar**: Section 371 essence is expressed by grammar · Section 373 grammar tells what kind of object anything is · Section 496 description not explanation · Section 664 **surface** vs **depth** grammar.
- Diagnostic model: **Section 350-351** "It is 5 o'clock on the sun" - impeccable surface, no specified game.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LANGUAGE-GAMES

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UNIT OF INVESTIGATION (7) = LANGUAGE + THE ACTIONS INTO WHICH IT IS WOVEN
|
+--> USE 1  invented primitive languages  (2, 8, 48)
|         builders: 'Slab!' 'Block!' 'Pillar!' 'Beam!' - COMPLETE for its
|         purpose; meaning shown in the TRAINED RESPONSE; 19-20 word or
|         sentence is settled by ROLE, not by length
|         STATUS (130-131): OBJECTS OF COMPARISON, illuminating by
|         DISSIMILARITY as much as by likeness
|
+--> USE 2  the training processes by which language is learned (7)
|
+--> USE 3  actual practices (23): orders · descriptions · measurements ·
|         reports · hypotheses · tables · stories · play-acting · riddles ·
|         jokes · arithmetic · translation · asking · thanking · cursing ·
|         greeting · praying      -> 'part of an activity, or of a FORM OF LIFE'
|         and: NEW GAMES ARISE, OLD ONES ARE FORGOTTEN
|
v
GRAMMAR: 371 essence is expressed by grammar | 373 what kind of object
         anything is | 496 description, not explanation | 664 SURFACE vs DEPTH
|
+--> DIAGNOSTIC (350-351): 'It is 5 o'clock on the sun' - not false; NO
|         GAME SPECIFIED. This is the exact form the verdict on 'S' takes
|
v
ANSWER LINE: comparison replaces analysis, and the multiplicity that
              defeats one essence is the same multiplicity that keeps meaning ordered

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SESSION 6 - FORMS OF LIFE: AGREEMENT IN JUDGMENTS, THE LION, AND BEDROCK

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Language-games do not float. They are played by creatures who share reactions, needs, activities and ways of going on: we point and follow the finger rather than staring at the hand, we find the same things similar, we count and measure and get the same results, we wince at the same injuries. That shared background, which is mostly not stated and mostly not chosen, is what Wittgenstein gestures at with "form of life".

Technical definition: A **form of life (Lebensform)** is the shared pattern of activity, natural reaction, training and settled response that a language-game presupposes and within which linguistic agreement is possible. The term is deliberately sparse: it occurs only a handful of times in the *Investigations* - at **Section 19**, **Section 23**, **Section 241**, and in the material now printed as *Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment*. Its three load-bearing statements are: "to imagine a language means to imagine a form of life" (**Section 19**); "the speaking of language is part of an activity, or of a form of life" (**Section 23**); and the answer to the interlocutor's charge of relativism at **Section 241**: "It is what human beings say that is true and false; and they agree in the language they use. That is not agreement in opinions, but in form of life." **Section 242** adds the further condition: agreement in **definitions** and, however strange it sounds, agreement in **judgments**.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

"Form of life" is Wittgenstein's name for what must already be shared before agreement or disagreement is even possible, and the reason it cannot be turned into a doctrine of cultural relativism is that a relativist needs the very thing it describes - a stable practice within which claims can conflict.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- "To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life" (**Section 19**) - the shortest quotable statement
- **agreement in judgments, not in opinions (Section 241-242)** - the discrimination that carries the tenability mark
- "If a lion could talk, we could not understand him" - cited to Part II / PPF, not to Part I
- "This is simply what I do" (**Section 217**) - bedrock, with its correct location in rule-following
- **natural history (Section 25, Section 415)** - the naturalist reading's textual anchor
- **the sparse-occurrence caution** - mark the interpretation as interpretation

How to use them: the 2022 part says "establish the tenability", which is a demand for a **defended thesis**; so state the discrimination between agreement in opinions and agreement in judgments in the first two sentences, since it is what makes the notion tenable rather than merely evocative; and place the sparse-occurrence caution near the end, where it reads as scholarship rather than as hedging.

Plain-language visual - what has to be in place before anyone can agree or disagree

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TWO PEOPLE DISAGREE ABOUT THE LENGTH OF A TABLE
=====
WHAT THEY DISAGREE ABOUT ..... whether it is 180 cm or 182 cm
                                an AGREEMENT IN OPINIONS is absent
-----
WHAT THEY MUST ALREADY SHARE FOR THE DISAGREEMENT TO EXIST AT ALL
* that laying a rule alongside an object is how length is settled
* that the marks on the rule are read in this direction, not that
* that a result is repeatable, and a wildly varying result means
  something went wrong
* that 'longer' and 'shorter' apply as they do to these cases
* that when we count together we mostly reach the same number
THIS is AGREEMENT IN JUDGMENTS - and it is not a shared opinion, because
nobody was ever asked. It is the trained practice inside which opinions
become possible.
=====
PI 242, in substance: communication by language requires agreement not
only in DEFINITIONS but - queer as it may sound - in JUDGMENTS. If
measuring results varied wildly from person to person, there would be no
such thing as measuring - not 'inaccurate measuring'.
=====
THE TEST THAT MAKES THE NOTION TENABLE
  Remove the shared background -> you do not get DISAGREEMENT
                                -> you get NO SUBJECT-MATTER AT ALL
  That asymmetry is the whole argument, and it is what a relativist
  reading of 'form of life' cannot accommodate.
=====

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In simple words: two chess players can argue about whether a move was wise. They cannot argue about whether the bishop moves diagonally - not because that is beyond dispute in some mystical sense, but because someone who denies it is not disagreeing with them, he is not playing. Form of life is Wittgenstein's name for the level at which denying something removes you from the game rather than putting you on the other side of it.

Remember first	Meaning
The term is spare	a handful of occurrences; do not build a system and call it his
Agreement in judgments , not opinions	the discrimination that answers the relativism charge
It includes natural as well as cultural facts	Section 25, Section 415: commanding, questioning and playing are part of our natural history
Section 217's bedrock belongs to rule-following	quote it there, and only extend it here with a marker
The lion remark is from Part II / PPF	not from the numbered Part I

One-line memory: you cannot disagree with someone until you already agree with him about a great deal that neither of you has ever mentioned.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the four things "form of life" is doing, and the two readings of it

JOB 1 IT COMPLETES THE ACCOUNT OF LANGUAGE-GAMES 19, 23
A game needs players, training and circumstances. 'To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life.' 23: 'the speaking of language is PART OF an activity, or of a form of life.'

JOB 2 IT ANSWERS THE RELATIVISM CHARGE 241, 242
Interlocutor: 'So you are saying that human agreement decides what is true and what is false?'
Reply: 'It is what human beings SAY that is true and false; and they agree in the LANGUAGE they use. That is not agreement in OPINIONS but in FORM OF LIFE.'
242: communication needs agreement in DEFINITIONS and - queer as it sounds - in JUDGMENTS. If results of measuring varied wildly, there would be no measuring, not inaccurate measuring.

JOB 3 IT MARKS WHERE JUSTIFICATION STOPS 217, 211
'If I have exhausted the justifications I have reached bedrock, and my spade is turned. Then I am inclined to say: THIS IS SIMPLY WHAT I DO.'
CAUTION: this is said of RULE-FOLLOWING. Using it to define 'form of life' is a common and marked slide - mark it as an extension.

JOB 4 IT SETS THE LIMIT OF INTELLIGIBILITY PPF / II xi
'If a lion could talk, we could not understand him.'
WHAT IT SAYS: vocabulary alone does not confer understanding where activities, reactions and natural history diverge far enough.
WHAT IT DOES NOT SAY: that cultures are mutually sealed, that translation is impossible, or that criticism across practices is illegitimate. Lions are not a culture.

=====

THE TWO READINGS - NAME BOTH, THEN TAKE A SIDE	
NATURALIST / ANTHROPOLOGICAL	CULTURALIST
'form of life' = the shared	'forms of life' (plural) =
NATURAL HISTORY of human beings:	historically specific practices:
shared reactions, the human body,	religious, scientific, legal
common needs, primitive behaviour	forms of discourse
ANCHORS: 25 'commanding, asking,	ANCHORS: the plural occurrences;
chatting are as much a part of our	23's historicity ('new games come
natural history as walking, eating,	into existence, others become
drinking, playing'; 415 'what we	obsolete'); the manifest variety
are supplying are really remarks	of practices
on the natural history of human	
beings'	

=====

VERDICT TO DEPLOY The readings are not exclusive: the SHAPE of the background is natural, its CONTENT is largely cultural. What the text does not supply is a theory of adjudication between practices - and that gap, not relativism, is the honest limitation to concede.

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The 2022 part asks you to **establish the tenability** of language as form of life. Jobs 1-3 establish it; Job 4 and the two readings are where the "critically" content lives; the verdict line at the bottom is the concession that makes the defence credible.

1. What Section 19 actually says, and what it does not FACT:

FACT: **Section 19** begins with imagined languages - one consisting only of orders and reports in battle, one of only questions and expressions for answering yes and no - and says: *"And to imagine a language means to imagine a form of life."* The context is therefore the **builders**: the sentence arrives while Wittgenstein is asking whether "Slab!" is a word or a sentence.

ANALYSIS: **The consequence of that context is examinable.** The remark is not a grand thesis about culture; it is the observation that you cannot specify a language without specifying what its speakers *do*. A language of orders and reports in battle presupposes battle, ranks, obedience, danger. Change the doing, and the language is a different language - which is why it makes no sense to describe a vocabulary and then ask, separately, what activity it belongs to.

2. Agreement in judgments - the passage that does the real work FACT:

FACT: **Section 241** stages the objection directly. The interlocutor says: *"So you are saying that human agreement decides what is true and what is false?"* Wittgenstein's reply: *"It is what human beings say that is true and false; and they agree in the language they use. That is not agreement in opinions but in form of life."*

FACT: **Section 242** continues: "*If language is to be a means of communication there must be agreement not only in definitions but also (queer as this may sound) in judgments.*" And the measuring example: if the results of measuring varied wildly from person to person, we would not have *inaccurate* measuring; we would have no measuring at all.

ANALYSIS: **Why this is the tenability argument.** The relativist reading says: agreement makes things true. Wittgenstein's reply distinguishes two levels. What is **true or false** is what people *say*, and that is settled by how things are - the table is 180 cm or it is not. What agreement supplies is the **practice within which saying anything determinate is possible**. Remove the agreement and you do not get widespread error; you get the disappearance of the subject-matter. ANALYSIS: That asymmetry - error versus no-subject-matter - is the sentence to write, because it shows why "agreement in form of life" is not the thesis that truth is consensus.

3. Bedrock, and where it belongs FACT:

FACT: **Section 217**: "*How am I able to obey a rule?*" ... *If I have exhausted the justifications I have reached bedrock, and my spade is turned. Then I am inclined to say: 'This is simply what I do.'*" FACT: **Section 211**: in giving reasons for continuing a series as I do, my reasons will soon give out - and then I shall act, without reasons.

ANALYSIS: **Two cautions, both frequently violated.** First, Section 217 is a remark about **rule-following**, and although it is legitimately connected to the form-of-life background, using it as a *definition* of form of life is an interpretive extension that should be marked as one. Second, "this is simply what I do" is **not** "this is simply what we all do, so majority behaviour is the standard". Wittgenstein is describing the terminus of *justification*, not proposing a criterion of correctness. Session 7 shows why the difference matters: a community-behaviour criterion would reintroduce the very collapse of "right" into "seems right" that the private-language argument exploits, only at group level.

4. The lion, correctly cited and correctly limited FACT:

FACT: "*If a lion could talk, we could not understand him.*" The remark belongs to the material formerly printed as Part II Section xi, now *Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment*; cite it that way rather than by a Part I section number.

ANALYSIS: **What it establishes.** Understanding an utterance requires more than decoding a vocabulary: it requires enough shared activity, reaction and natural history for us to know what the speaker is *doing*. A lion's life - its interests, its body, its behaviour - offers too little purchase; even fluent lion-speech would leave us unable to tell an assertion from a threat, a joke from a complaint.

WRONG: **What it does not establish.** It is not a proof that cultures are mutually unintelligible, and Wittgenstein's own remarks work in the opposite direction: the *Investigations* repeatedly imagines exotic tribes and then **describes** what they are doing (Section 143-207 passim), which presupposes that anthropological understanding is possible.

ANALYSIS: The honest formulation is that intelligibility has **conditions** and that those conditions can be more or less well met - a caution against assuming universal transparency, not a doctrine of sealed worlds.

5. Establishing tenability: the defended thesis ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: The 2022 directive is unusual and should be obeyed literally: *establish the tenability*. That means the answer must (a) state what would make the notion untenable, (b) show that it does not follow, and (c) concede what genuinely remains open.

What would make it untenable	Why it does not follow	What remains open
If "form of life" meant that consensus makes statements true	Section 241 separates <i>what is said</i> (true or false) from <i>the language they agree in</i> ; Section 242's asymmetry shows removal yields no subject-matter, not mass error	Whether the line between the two levels is always sharp
If it made every practice immune to criticism	Shared natural history and cross-practice comparison give purchase; Wittgenstein himself describes and criticises practices	Wittgenstein supplies no theory of rational adjudication between practices
If it were a doctrine built on a word used a handful of times	The work is done by Section 241-242 and Section 23, which are argued, not by the phrase itself	How much systematic weight the phrase can bear is genuinely contested

What would make it untenable	Why it does not follow	What remains open
If "natural history" made it biological determinism	Section 25 and Section 415 place linguistic activities alongside walking and eating as <i>natural history</i> , which is a remark about the kind of description offered, not a causal thesis	The naturalist/culturalist balance is an interpretive dispute

ANALYSIS: **The verdict to write:** the notion is tenable as a description of the **enabling background** of language and untenable as a **theory** of truth, of cultural incommensurability, or of the ultimate justification of practices - and Wittgenstein's own sparse use of the phrase is evidence that he intended the first and not the second.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Language as a form of life is tenable when it is read as a claim about the enabling background of linguistic practice rather than as a theory of truth, because what agreement supplies is not the truth of what is said but the possibility of saying anything determinate at all. **Named evidence.** Section 19 states that to imagine a language means to imagine a form of life, and does so while asking whether the builders' "Slab!" is a word or a sentence - that is, while showing that a vocabulary cannot be specified apart from an activity. Section 23 closes its list of countless language-games with the clause that speaking a language is part of an activity, or of a form of life. Section 241 answers the charge that human agreement decides truth by distinguishing agreement in opinions from agreement in form of life, and Section 242 adds that communication requires agreement not only in definitions but, queer as it sounds, in judgments - for if the results of measuring varied wildly from person to person, we should not have inaccurate measuring but no measuring at all. **Analysis.** The measuring example carries the argument, because it exhibits an asymmetry a relativist reading cannot use: the removal of shared judgments does not produce widespread error, which would presuppose a subject-matter, but the disappearance of the subject-matter itself. Agreement therefore operates one level below truth-value, as the condition of determinate assertion rather than as its ground, and this is why disagreement - including radical disagreement - is evidence of a shared practice rather than of its absence. **Qualification.** Three limits must be conceded. The phrase occurs only a handful of times, so an elaborate doctrine erected on it should be presented as interpretation rather than as Wittgenstein's stated theory. The lion remark, which belongs to the material now printed as *Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment*, warns that intelligibility has conditions but does not establish that cultures are sealed from one another, since Wittgenstein himself repeatedly describes imagined alien practices. And while shared natural history and cross-practice comparison constrain relativism, the text supplies no theory of rational adjudication between practices - which is the genuine gap, and a more honest concession than the relativism charge it is usually confused with.

Exam link

- **2022 Q1(c)** (10 marks) - "Establish the tenability of later Wittgenstein's motion of language as form of life."
ANALYSIS: The official English line prints "**motion**"; reproduce the printed word, then say in one clause that the intended notion is language as a form of life, and proceed. Section 5's table is the answer's structure.
- **2018 Q1(c)**: forms of life are what stop the family-resemblance account from collapsing into "anything goes".
- **2019 Q3(b), 2020 Q4(c), 2024 Q1(d)**: the private-language argument needs a standard of correctness that is not the present impression; the form-of-life background is where such standards live.
- **2025 Q3(a)**: this is the terminus of the transition - the *Tractatus*'s logical form is replaced not by another formal structure but by a shared practical background.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Form of life = cultural relativism"	Section 241: agreement in form of life , not in opinions; removal yields no subject-matter, not mass error
"Human agreement decides truth"	What is true or false is what human beings say ; agreement is in the language they use
"Section 217 defines form of life"	Section 217 is a rule-following remark; extending it here is interpretation and must be marked
"The lion remark proves incommensurability"	It states a condition of intelligibility; Wittgenstein describes imagined alien practices throughout
Silently correcting the 2022 printed "motion"	Reproduce the printed wording, gloss it in a clause, and move on
Building a large doctrine on the phrase	It occurs a handful of times (Section 19, Section 23, Section 241, PPF); the arguments are at Section 241-242

Revision notes

- **Section 19** *"To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life"* - said in the context of the builders.
- **Section 23** *"the speaking of language is part of an activity, or of a form of life"*.
- **Section 241** agreement in **form of life**, not in **opinions**; what is true or false is what human beings **say**.
- **Section 242** agreement in **definitions** and in **judgments**; wildly varying measurement results = **no measuring**, not inaccurate measuring.
- **Section 217** bedrock, spade turned, *"This is simply what I do"* - a **rule-following** remark.
- **Section 25, Section 415** commanding, questioning, chatting belong to our **natural history**.
- Lion remark: **Part II Section xi / PPF** - a condition of intelligibility, not sealed cultures.
- Verdict: tenable as the **enabling background**; untenable as a theory of truth, incommensurability or ultimate justification.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FORMS OF LIFE

LANGUAGE-GAME (23) is PART OF an activity, or of a FORM OF LIFE
|
+--> 19 to imagine a language = to imagine a form of life
| (said while asking whether 'Slab!' is a word or a sentence)
|
v
CHALLENGE (241): 'So human agreement decides what is true and false?'
|
v
REPLY: what is TRUE OR FALSE is what human beings SAY; what they AGREE in is
the LANGUAGE they use -> 'not agreement in OPINIONS but in FORM OF LIFE'
|
+--> 242 agreement in DEFINITIONS *and* in JUDGMENTS
| TEST: wildly varying measurements = NO MEASURING, not inaccurate
| measuring -> removal gives NO SUBJECT-MATTER, not mass error
|
+--> 217 justifications exhausted, spade turned, 'This is simply what I
| do' [a RULE-FOLLOWING remark - extending it here is interpretation]
|
+--> LION (PPF / II xi): vocabulary alone does not confer understanding
| NOT: cultures are sealed. Wittgenstein describes alien practices
|
v
TWO READINGS: NATURALIST (25, 415 natural history) | CULTURALIST (plural
occurrences, 23's historicity). SHAPE natural, CONTENT largely cultural
|
v
TENABLE AS the enabling background of determinate speech
UNTENABLE AS a theory of truth · of incommensurability · of ultimate
justification
|
v
ANSWER LINE: you cannot disagree with someone until you already agree with
him about a great deal that neither of you has ever mentioned

SESSION 7 - RULE-FOLLOWING AND THE PARADOX AT Section 201: THE REGRESS OF INTERPRETATIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Suppose you are taught "add 2" and you write 2, 4, 6, 8 ... up to 1000, and then continue 1004, 1008, 1012. You insist you are doing exactly what you were told. Nothing in the examples you were given rules this out - you were never shown what happens after 1000. Wittgenstein's problem is that this is not an odd case: *every* rule can be read in more than one way, so a rule cannot fix its own application by itself. His answer is not a better rule. It is that following a rule is something you do, not something you interpret.

Technical definition: The **rule-following considerations** (Section 138-242, with the decisive statement at Section 201) show that no formulation of a rule, and no finite set of examples, determines a unique continuation, because any continuation can be brought into accord with the rule under some interpretation. **Section 201** states the paradox - *"this was our paradox: no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule"* - and immediately identifies the misunderstanding that generates it: that we are giving one interpretation after another, *"as if each one contented us at least for a moment, until we thought of yet another standing behind it."* The resolution is that there is *"a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call 'obeying the rule' and 'going against it' in actual cases."*

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The rule-following paradox is not a sceptical result but a reductio of a picture: if grasping a rule were attaching an interpretation to it, no rule could ever determine anything - and since rules plainly do determine things, grasping a rule must be something other than interpreting it.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **regress of interpretations** - the mechanism, named in three words
- **"every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule"** (Section 201) - quoted

- a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation (Section 201) - the resolution, quoted
- "add 2" / the pupil at 1000 (Section 185) - the worked case
- "This is simply what I do" (Section 217) - bedrock
- **normativity ≠ regularity** - the discrimination that blocks the behaviourist and the consensus reading

How to use them: state the paradox as a **conditional** ("if grasping a rule were interpreting it, then ..."), because that single grammatical choice already signals that you know it is a reductio; then give Section 185's worked case; then quote the resolution; and reserve **normativity ≠ regularity** for the critical paragraph, where Kripke's reading is assessed.

Plain-language visual - the pupil who has done nothing wrong by his own lights

```

THE ORDER: '+2' - write the series
=====
THE PUPIL WRITES  2  4  6  8  ... 996  998  1000  1004  1008  1012
                  ^
                  |
                here we say: 'No! Look what you've done!'
=====
THE PUPIL'S REPLY (185, in substance):
  'But I went on in the same way. Isn't this what you wanted? I did
  exactly what you showed me - I just did it for these numbers.'
=====
CAN WE REFUTE HIM BY POINTING TO THE RULE?
  'Add 2'          -> he says he added 2 - in HIS reading of 'add 2'
  The examples     -> finite; none of them covered 1000+
  'Add 2 EVERY time' -> 'every' also needs a reading
  'Add 2, and by "add 2" I mean...' -> the explanation needs a reading
=====
THE MECHANISM: REGRESS OF INTERPRETATIONS
  rule -> needs an interpretation to be applied
         -> the interpretation is another formulation
         -> which needs an interpretation to be applied
         -> ... and nothing ever gets applied
=====
WITTGENSTEIN'S MOVE (201): the regress shows that the FIRST STEP was
wrong. Grasping a rule is not attaching an interpretation. There is a way
of grasping a rule EXHIBITED IN OBEYING IT AND GOING AGAINST IT.
=====

```

In simple words: the point is not that we cannot tell the pupil is wrong - of course we can, and we do. The point is that our certainty does not come from a further sign, formula or mental item that pins the rule down. It comes from having been trained into a practice in which 1002 is what you write and 1004 is a mistake. The philosopher's mistake was to look for a *thing* - a formula, a picture, an act of meaning - that does the work that training does.

Remember first	Meaning
The problem is not about doubt	nobody is unsure what "+2" requires; the problem is what makes it required
Interpretation means substituting one expression for another	Section 201's own gloss; that is why it cannot terminate
The resolution is not "there are more rules"	more rules would need more interpretations
Bedrock is action , not agreement	Section 217: "This is simply what I do"
Practice ≠ mere regularity	otherwise "correct" would collapse into "usual"

One-line memory: a rule does not contain its own applications; a trained practice contains them, which is why explanations end in doing rather than in saying.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the paradox, the two misreadings, and the resolution

STEP 1 THE TEMPTING PICTURE

To follow a rule is to have the rule 'in mind' and to derive each application from it. Meaning something determines in advance every future step - 'the steps are really already taken' (188, in substance).

STEP 2 THE PRESSURE (138-155, 185-190)

- * The formula does not apply itself. * The examples are finite.
- * The mental picture is another sign, and needs applying too (139-141).
- * The 'aha!' of sudden understanding can occur and be followed by failure (151-155) - so it is not what understanding CONSISTS in.

STEP 3 THE PARADOX (201, first half)

'THIS WAS OUR PARADOX: no course of action could be determined by a rule, because EVERY course of action can be made out to accord with the rule.'

'If everything can be made out to accord with the rule, then it can also be made out to CONFLICT with it. And so there would be neither accord nor conflict here.'

STEP 4 THE DIAGNOSIS (201, second half)

'It can be seen that there is a MISUNDERSTANDING here from the mere fact that in the course of our argument we give one interpretation after another; as if each one contented us at least for a moment, until we thought of yet another standing behind it.'

-> INTERPRETATION = 'the substitution of one expression of the rule for another'. That is why it can never be the terminus.

STEP 5 THE RESOLUTION (201, third part; 202; 217)

'There is a way of grasping a rule which is NOT an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call "obeying the rule" and "going against it" in actual cases.'

202: 'to obey a rule is a PRACTICE. And to THINK one is obeying a rule is not to obey a rule.'

217: justifications exhausted -> 'This is simply what I do.'

THE TWO MISREADINGS - REJECT BOTH EXPLICITLY IN AN ANSWER

MISREADING A 'So nothing determines meaning; the sceptic wins.'

-> 201 calls the result a MISUNDERSTANDING, not a discovery. The paradox is a REDUCTIO of the interpretation-picture.

MISREADING B 'So the community's actual behaviour is the standard.'

-> Then 'correct' would mean 'what most people do'. But majorities can be wrong, and the whole community could go astray in a case without thereby changing the rule. 202's contrast between OBEYING and THINKING one obeys is a distinction, not a head-count.

KRIPKE'S READING - REPORT IT, THEN RULE ON IT

1982

Kripke, Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language: reads 201 as a SCEPTICAL PARADOX (no fact about me constitutes my meaning addition rather than 'quaddition') answered by a SCEPTICAL SOLUTION (assertion-conditions plus communal agreement).

ESSENTIAL CAUTION: Kripke presents it as 'Wittgenstein's argument as it struck Kripke' - the standard shorthand is 'Kripkenstein'.

THE OPPOSING READING: Baker and Hacker, McDowell - Wittgenstein DISSOLVES the paradox rather than conceding it; a sceptical solution would be the sort of constructive theory his method rejects.

WHAT TO WRITE: name both, take a side, give one reason.

ANALYSIS: Caption. This session is where the private-language argument gets its premise, and the connection should be made explicit in any answer to the 2019, 2020 or 2024 parts: if grasping a rule requires a practice in which obeying and going against it are distinguishable, then a "rule" for which that distinction cannot arise is not a rule.

1. The setting: understanding and continuing a series FACT:

FACT: The considerations grow out of Section 138-155, where Wittgenstein asks how the meaning of a word can be grasped "in a flash" when its use is extended in time. He examines the case of a pupil learning to continue "1, 3, 5, 7 ..." and then the order "+2". Section 151 catalogues what actually happens when understanding "dawns" - the formula occurs to me; I recognise the differences; I simply say "now I can go on" - and Section 152 concludes that none of these processes *is* the understanding, because each can occur without understanding following.

ANALYSIS: Note the shape of the argument: it is the same shape as Section 28-31 in Session 3 and Section 143-155 in Session 2. A candidate item is proposed as what a mental achievement **consists in**; a case is produced in which

the item is present and the achievement absent, and another in which the achievement is present and the item absent; the identification therefore fails. Naming this shape once in an answer is worth a mark, because it shows the sessions are one argument rather than four.

2. Section 185: the pupil who goes on differently FACT:

FACT: **Section 185.** The pupil has been taught the series of natural numbers and then the "+2" series up to 1000. We ask him to continue beyond 1000, and he writes 1000, 1004, 1008, 1012. We say: look at what you have done. He does not understand; he says: *"But I went on in the same way."* And, Wittgenstein adds, it would be no use to say "But can't you see ...?" and repeat the old examples and explanations - *"such a one as we should perhaps say: it comes natural to this person to understand our order with our explanations as we should understand the order: 'Add 2 up to 1000, 4 up to 2000, 6 up to 3000 and so on.'"*

ANALYSIS: **What the case is designed to show.** Not that the pupil is right - he is not. Not that we cannot correct him - we can. What it shows is that the correction cannot be **derived** from anything already possessed: not from the sign, not from the examples, not from a mental image, and not from any further explanation, since each of those would need the same kind of uptake. ANALYSIS: Wittgenstein's phrase *"it comes natural to this person"* is worth quoting, because it locates the divergence at the level of **reaction**, which is where the form-of-life background (Session 6) does its work.

3. Section 201, in its three parts FACT:

The remark must be given in three parts, because scripts routinely quote the first and omit the third, which converts a *reductio* into scepticism:

Part	Text (in substance)	Function
(i) The paradox	<i>"No course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule." And if everything can be made to accord, everything can be made to conflict, so "there would be neither accord nor conflict here"</i>	States the consequence of the interpretation-picture
(ii) The diagnosis	<i>"It can be seen that there is a misunderstanding here from the mere fact that in the course of our argument we give one interpretation after another; as if each one contented us at least for a moment, until we thought of yet another standing behind it."</i>	Identifies the paradox as a symptom , not a result
(iii) The resolution	<i>"There is a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call 'obeying the rule' and 'going against it' in actual cases."</i>	Supplies the alternative and closes the regress

ANALYSIS: Section 201 itself glosses **interpretation** as *"the substitution of one expression of the rule for another"*. That gloss is the key to the whole argument: because an interpretation is another expression, it stands in exactly the same need as the rule it was meant to fix, and no series of such substitutions can ever terminate. The regress is therefore not a contingent inconvenience but a structural feature of the picture, which is why the picture must go.

4. Practice, and why it is not consensus FACT:ANALYSIS:

FACT: **Section 202:** *"'obeying a rule' is a practice. And to think one is obeying a rule is not to obey a rule. Hence it is not possible to obey a rule 'privately': otherwise thinking one was obeying a rule would be the same thing as obeying it."*

ANALYSIS: This remark does two jobs at once, and both should be stated. It completes the rule-following argument by naming its terminus (**practice**), and it announces the private-language argument forty remarks in advance by drawing the consequence: where seeming and being cannot come apart, there is no rule. Section 258's diary argument is Section 202 applied to a sensation word.

ANALYSIS: **The discrimination that carries the most marks here is normativity against regularity.** A practice is not merely a regularity of behaviour:

- A regularity can be described from outside; a practice involves **standards** by reference to which a performance is criticised.
- A regularity has exceptions; a practice has **mistakes** - and a mistake is not a statistical outlier but a failure by a standard the agent himself acknowledges when it is pointed out.
- A regularity can be shared by a crowd; a **standard** can be misapplied by the whole crowd at once, which is why "what we all do" is not the criterion.

WRONG: Writing "for Wittgenstein, correctness is whatever the community agrees on" is the most damaging single sentence available in this session, because it recreates at group level exactly the collapse of "right" into "seems right" that Section 258 exploits at individual level.

5. Kripke's reading, and the ruling to give CAUTION:

CAUTION: **Kripke, Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language (1982)** reads Section 201 as presenting a **sceptical paradox**: there is no fact about my past usage, dispositions or mental history that constitutes my having meant *addition* rather than the deviant function usually called *quaddition*, and therefore no fact that makes "125" rather than "5" the correct answer to "68 + 57". Kripke then attributes to Wittgenstein a **sceptical solution**: we abandon truth-conditions for **assertion-conditions**, and what licenses the ascription of meaning is the agreement of a **community**.

ANALYSIS: **Three things must be said about this in an answer, and they can be said in three sentences.**

1. **Provenance.** Kripke explicitly presents the argument as "*Wittgenstein's argument as it struck Kripke*", not as exegesis, which is why the scholarly shorthand is "**Kripkenstein**"; saying so is the cheapest available demonstration that the candidate knows the difference between a text and a reading.
2. **The opposing reading.** Baker and Hacker, and McDowell from a different direction, deny that Wittgenstein concedes any scepticism: Section 201 calls the paradox a **misunderstanding** and offers a third part that Kripke's reconstruction under-weights, so the text dissolves the problem rather than answering it.
3. **The ruling.** ANALYSIS: The most defensible position, and the one this package recommends, is that Kripke's reconstruction is philosophically valuable and exegetically doubtful: it sharpens why *no interpretation and no disposition* can by itself fix normativity, and it then supplies a **constructive theory** - assertion-conditions plus community - of exactly the kind Section 109 and 133 forbid. Say that, give the reason, and the "critically discuss" requirement is met.

ANALYSIS: CAUTION: It is also worth marking that the community question is genuinely open in the literature: whether Wittgenstein requires an **actual** community or only standards that are **in principle shareable** is a live dispute, and it is treated in the optional advanced block rather than here, because no routed question requires it.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The rule-following paradox is a reductio of the picture on which grasping a rule consists in attaching an interpretation to it, and its conclusion is not that rules determine nothing but that rule-following is exhibited in trained practice rather than constituted by interpretation. **Named evidence.** Section 185 imagines a pupil taught the "+2" series up to 1000 who continues 1004, 1008, 1012 and protests that he went on in the same way; no repetition of the examples refutes him, because it comes natural to him to take the order as we should take "add 2 up to 1000, 4 up to 2000". Section 201 draws the consequence - no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with it, and hence also to conflict with it - then identifies the misunderstanding in the fact that the argument gives one interpretation after another, each contenting us for a moment until another stands behind it, interpretation being "the substitution of one expression of the rule for another". The remark closes by asserting a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation but is exhibited in obeying and going against it in actual cases, and Section 202 adds that obeying a rule is a practice and that thinking one is obeying a rule is not obeying it. **Analysis.** The argument's force lies in the structural character of the regress: because an interpretation is itself another expression, it stands in precisely the need it was introduced to satisfy, so no series of interpretations can terminate. Removing the first step rather than extending the series therefore dissolves the paradox, and it locates normativity in a trained practice in which correction, mistake and the distinction between obeying and merely seeming to obey have application. That result is immediately load-bearing for the third printed limb, since Section 202's denial that a rule can be obeyed privately is Section 258's conclusion stated in advance. **Qualification.** Two readings must be resisted. Treating the paradox as a sceptical discovery ignores Section 201's own word "misunderstanding" and its third part; and treating community behaviour as the criterion of correctness reinstates at group level the collapse of "right" into "seems right", since a practice involves standards by which even a general performance can be criticised, whereas a regularity involves only frequencies. Kripke's 1982 reconstruction, which he himself offers as the argument as it struck him rather than as exegesis, is valuable for showing that neither interpretation nor disposition fixes normativity, but its sceptical solution supplies the constructive theory Wittgenstein's method disavows.

Exam link

- **2024 Q1(d)** (10 marks) and **2020 Q4(c)** (15 marks): Section 202 is the premise - no rule can be obeyed privately, because seeming and being would coincide. Cite it before the diary.
- **2019 Q3(b)** (15 marks): the solipsist's vocabulary must be rule-governed; Section 201 is what shows that a private determination of the rule is unavailable.
- **2023 Q4(c), 2025 Q3(a)**: the rule-following considerations are the deepest reason the *Tractatus*'s determinate logical form could not be retained - the determination it required is exactly what no formulation can supply by itself.
- **2018 Q1(c)**: family-resemblance concepts are extended by trained judgment, which is rule-following without a formula.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Section 201 proves that meaning is indeterminate"	Section 201 calls the paradox a misunderstanding and supplies a third part
"The community's agreement is the standard of correctness"	That collapses "correct" into "usual"; Section 202 contrasts obeying with thinking one obeys
"Kripke's sceptical solution is Wittgenstein's view"	Kripke offers it as the argument as it struck him ; "Kripkenstein" marks the difference
"The answer is that we follow further rules"	Further rules need further interpretations; the regress is structural
"Rule-following is just behavioural regularity"	A practice has mistakes ; a regularity has only exceptions
Quoting Section 217 as if it meant "whatever I do is right"	It marks where justification ends, not where correctness is decided

Revision notes

- **Section 138-155** understanding "in a flash": every candidate inner item can occur without understanding, and understanding without it.
- **Section 185** the pupil at 1000 writes 1004, 1008, 1012 - "*But I went on in the same way*"; the divergence is at the level of **reaction**.
- **Section 201 (i)** paradox: every course of action can be made out to accord - and so to conflict - with the rule.
- **Section 201 (ii)** diagnosis: the giving of one interpretation after another; **interpretation** = substituting one expression of the rule for another.
- **Section 201 (iii)** resolution: a way of grasping a rule **which is not an interpretation**, exhibited in obeying and going against it.
- **Section 202** obeying a rule is a **practice**; thinking one obeys is not obeying; hence a rule cannot be obeyed **privately**.
- **Section 217** bedrock: "*This is simply what I do.*"
- **Normativity ≠ regularity**: practices have mistakes and standards; regularities have exceptions and frequencies.
- **Kripke 1982**: sceptical paradox + sceptical solution; "Wittgenstein's argument as it struck Kripke"; opposed by Baker and Hacker and by McDowell.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - RULE-FOLLOWING

PICTURE: grasping a rule = having it in mind and DERIVING each application

```
|
+--> 138-155 no inner item IS the understanding (flash without success;
|           success without flash)
+--> 185 the pupil at 1000: 1004, 1008, 1012 - 'I went on in the same way'
|
v
201 (i) PARADOX: every course of action can be made to ACCORD with the rule
      -> and therefore also to CONFLICT -> neither accord nor conflict
|
v
201 (ii) DIAGNOSIS: we keep giving ONE INTERPRETATION AFTER ANOTHER
      interpretation = SUBSTITUTING ONE EXPRESSION OF THE RULE FOR ANOTHER
      -> the regress is STRUCTURAL, so the first step was the mistake
|
v
201 (iii) RESOLUTION: a way of grasping a rule WHICH IS NOT AN INTERPRETATION,
      exhibited in OBEYING and GOING AGAINST it in actual cases
|
+--> 202 obeying a rule is a PRACTICE; thinking one obeys is not obeying
|       -> HENCE NO PRIVATE RULE-FOLLOWING [premise of limb 3]
+--> 217 justifications exhausted -> 'This is simply what I do'
|
v
GUARD: NORMATIVITY != REGULARITY. practice has MISTAKES and STANDARDS;
      regularity has exceptions and frequencies. Community behaviour is NOT
      the criterion, or 'correct' collapses into 'usual'
|
v
KRIPKE 1982: sceptical paradox + sceptical SOLUTION (assertion-conditions +
      community). 'as it struck Kripke' = Kripkenstein. Baker/Hacker and
      McDowell: dissolution, not concession. RULE: valuable, exegetically doubtful
|
v
ANSWER LINE: rules do not contain their applications; trained practices do
```

SESSION 8 - THE CRITIQUE OF PRIVATE LANGUAGE: THE TARGET, THE DIARY "S", AND THE BEETLE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Could you invent a word for a feeling that only you can have, teach it to nobody, and use it correctly in a diary? It sounds obviously possible. Wittgenstein argues that it is not - not because you would be watched, and not because feelings are unreal, but because you would have given yourself no way of being **wrong**, and a sign you cannot misuse is not yet a sign you are using.

Technical definition: A **private language**, in the sense **Section 243** defines and **Section 244-271** examine, is a language whose *"individual words refer to what can only be known to the person speaking; to his immediate private sensations"*, so that *"another person cannot understand the language."* The words are given meaning by **private ostensive definition** - attending to a sensation and associating a sign with it - and the sensations are **logically** private, not merely undisclosed. The critique argues that such a definition establishes no **criterion of correctness**, so that no distinction can arise between applying the sign correctly and merely **seeming** to apply it correctly; where that distinction cannot arise, *"we can't talk about 'right'"* (**Section 258**), and a sign with no possible misuse has no use.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The private linguist is not accused of insincerity, of solitude or of having no inner life; he is shown to have equipped himself with no way of being wrong - and since a sign that cannot be misapplied has not yet been applied, his diary records nothing at all.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **logically private, not merely secret** - the target, stated so the whole answer is on the right object
- **private ostensive definition (Section 258)** - the exact mechanism under attack
- **criterion of correctness** - the missing element, in three words
- **"whatever is going to seem right to me is right" (Section 258)** - quoted, with its conclusion attached
- **the beetle-in-a-box (Section 293)** - *"drops out of consideration as irrelevant"*
- **Section 202: no rule can be obeyed privately** - the imported premise

How to use them: spend the **first two sentences on the target**, because at least half the marks in the 2020 and 2024 parts are lost by candidates who attack a secret code; give the five-step core as a numbered argument rather than as prose; and place the **beetle** *after* the diary, since it removes a residual temptation rather than doing the primary work.

Plain-language visual - four things that are NOT the target

WHAT WITTGENSTEIN IS *NOT* ATTACKING

1 A SECRET CODE

Two spies share a cipher nobody else can read. -> This is an ENCRYPTED PUBLIC LANGUAGE. It is decipherable IN PRINCIPLE, and its words already have public meanings. NOT the target.

2 TALKING TO ONESELF

Muttering, silent rehearsal, an inner monologue. -> Ordinary use of a PUBLIC language, performed alone. NOT the target.

3 HAVING PRIVATE THOUGHTS OR FEELINGS

Undisclosed grief, an unconfessed hope, a pain nobody notices. -> Wittgenstein never denies these. NOT the target.

4 A SOLITARY SPEAKER (Crusoe, a lone survivor, a child raised alone)

-> A person alone may still use a language with PUBLIC-TYPE criteria: stable techniques, repeatable circumstances, checkable applications. Physical solitude is NOT logical privacy. NOT (straightforwardly) the target - see the objection in section 6 below.

WHAT *IS* THE TARGET (243)

A language whose words are given meaning by attending to a sensation that ONLY THE SPEAKER CAN KNOW, so that another person COULD NOT IN PRINCIPLE understand it - not even if told everything. The words would be defined by PRIVATE OSTENSION alone, and would therefore carry their standards of correct use nowhere but in the speaker's own present impression.

WHY THE DISTINCTION IS WORTH HALF THE MARKS

Every one of the four non-targets is REFUTED BY EXAMPLE in a sentence. If your script attacks one of them, the examiner sees an answer to a question that was not asked.

In simple words: imagine trying to check the time by remembering what the clock looked like - and having no other clock, no timetable, no sunrise, nothing. Whatever you remember will feel right, because there is nothing to feel wrong against. Wittgenstein's image at Section 265 is exactly this: buying several copies of the morning paper to assure yourself that what it says is true.

Remember first	Meaning
Logical , not contingent, privacy	in principle unteachable, not merely undisclosed
The attack is on private ostensive definition	not on sensation, not on solitude
The missing item is a criterion of correctness	a standard independent of the present impression
Section 258's conclusion is about "right" , not about "S" alone	<i>"here we can't talk about 'right'"</i>
The beetle is a supplementary move	it removes the private object's relevance to the shared word

One-line memory: where nothing could count as getting it wrong, nothing counts as getting it right - and where nothing counts as getting it right, no rule has been given.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the five-step core, the diary, and the beetle

THE LOGICAL CORE - WRITE THIS AS A NUMBERED ARGUMENT

- =====
- 1 A meaningful sign requires a RULE OF USE: a standard by which its application counts as correct or incorrect.
 - 2 A rule of use requires a CRITERION OF CORRECTNESS independent of the user's mere present seeming. [PI 202 supplies this: obeying a rule is a practice]
 - 3 A purely private 'rule' has NO such independent criterion: the subject is sole judge, and whatever seems right to him IS right. [258]
 - 4 Therefore a purely private 'rule' is not a rule.
 - 5 Therefore a private language - one whose words get their meaning by private ostensive definition - is IMPOSSIBLE.
- =====

THE DIARY ARGUMENT (258, with 260, 265, 270)

- SET-UP 'I want to keep a diary about the recurrence of a certain sensation. To this end I associate it with the sign "S" and write this sign in a calendar for every day on which I have the sensation.'
- STEP 1 No definition can be formulated. -> 'But still I can give myself a kind of OSTENSIVE definition' - by concentrating my attention on the sensation and, as it were, pointing inwardly.
- STEP 2 What is that ceremony for? 'It serves to establish the connexion between the sign and the sensation.' But 'I impress it on myself' can only mean: this process brings it about that I REMEMBER the connexion RIGHT in future.
- STEP 3 And here we have no criterion of correctness. 'One would like to say: whatever is going to seem right to me is right. And that only means that HERE WE CAN'T TALK ABOUT "RIGHT".'
- 260 'Well, I BELIEVE that this is the sensation S again.' - Perhaps you believe that you believe it.
- 265 The memory-check compared to buying SEVERAL COPIES OF THE MORNING PAPER to assure oneself that what it says is true. Also: a table that exists only in the imagination is not a table - 'justification consists in appealing to something INDEPENDENT'.
- 270 THE INSTRUCTIVE VARIANT: suppose writing 'S' turns out to coincide with a rise in blood pressure that a manometer independently registers. Now the sign has a USE - and note that whether I identified the sensation RIGHTLY has become irrelevant. A public criterion did the work.
- =====

THE BEETLE-IN-A-BOX (293)

- 'Suppose everyone had a box with something in it: we call it a "beetle". No one can look into anyone else's box, and everyone says he knows what a beetle is only by looking at HIS beetle.'
- * The thing in the box might be different for each person.
 - * It might even be constantly changing.
 - * The box might be EMPTY.
- CONCLUSION 'If we construe the grammar of the expression of sensation on the model of "object and designation" the object DROPS OUT OF CONSIDERATION AS IRRELEVANT.'
- =====

WHAT THE BEETLE DOES AND DOES NOT SHOW

- DOES the grammar of a SHARED sensation-word cannot be fixed by an item to which only one speaker has access
- DOES NOT prove sensations do not exist; deny that people feel different things; or show that inner differences never matter
- NOTE 293 is explicitly conditional: IF we construe the grammar on the object-and-designation model. The beetle attacks a MODEL.

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Three of the seven routed parts (2019, 2020, 2024) are answered from this diagram. The 2024 part wants steps 1-5 with the target correctly identified; the 2020 part quotes Section 243's own question and wants the diary worked through with the memory objection answered; the 2019 part wants steps 1-5 turned on solipsism, which is Session 10.

1. Section 243: the question, exactly as Wittgenstein asks it FACT:

FACT: **Section 243** is the remark the 2020 question quotes. It begins with a human being encouraging himself, giving himself orders, obeying, blaming and punishing himself - and observes that we could imagine human beings who spoke *only* in monologue. A researcher could learn their language, because it accompanies their ordinary activities. Then comes the real question: *"But could we also imagine a language in which a person could write down or give vocal expression to his inner experiences - his feelings, moods and the rest - for his private use?"* And the immediate clarification: *"the individual words of this language are to refer to what can only be known to the person speaking; to his immediate private sensations. So another person cannot understand the language."*

ANALYSIS: **The structure of Section 243 is itself an argument, and it is regularly missed.** The monologists are introduced precisely to be **set aside**: their language is *not* private in the relevant sense, because it is our language used alone. The question is then narrowed to the case where the words could not be understood by another **in principle**. ANALYSIS: A candidate who begins the 2020 answer by reproducing this narrowing has already secured the target-identification mark that most scripts lose.

2. The diary argument, step by step FACT:

FACT: **Section 258.** The set-up, the inward pointing, the demand for a criterion, and the collapse are given in the diagram above. Three refinements deserve separate statement, because they are where the argument is usually attacked:

(a) **It is not an argument from fallible memory.** ANALYSIS: The objection "but memory is unreliable, and public memory is unreliable too" misses the point. Wittgenstein's claim is not that private memory is *worse* than public memory; it is that in the private case there is **nothing for memory to be reliable or unreliable about**. In the public case, a misremembering can be corrected by a chart, a second speaker, a written record. In the private case the only available check is a further deliverance of the same faculty, which is why Section 265 compares it to buying several copies of the same newspaper.

(b) **"Right" is what collapses, not "S".** ANALYSIS: The conclusion of Section 258 is carefully worded: not "S is meaningless" but *"here we can't talk about 'right'"*. That is the stronger and more interesting claim, and it is what makes the argument an argument about **rules** rather than about **sensations**. Because the distinction between correct and incorrect cannot arise, the notion of a rule for "S" has no application; and by Section 202, where there is no rule there is no meaning.

(c) **Section 270 is the constructive half, and it is regularly omitted.** FACT: Wittgenstein imagines that writing "S" turns out to correlate with a rise in blood pressure detectable by a manometer. Now "S" is genuinely useful - and he notes that *whether the diarist recognises the sensation correctly makes no difference*. ANALYSIS: This is not a concession; it is the diagnosis completed. As soon as the sign acquires a use, the use is supplied by something **public**, and the supposed private identification does no work at all. An answer that includes Section 270 shows that the argument has a positive result and not merely a negative one.

3. The beetle, and the exact scope of its conclusion FACT:

FACT: **Section 293** starts from the tempting thought: *"if I say of myself that it is only from my own case that I know what the word 'pain' means - must I not say the same of other people too?"* The box example follows, and the conclusion is expressly conditional: *"if we construe the grammar of the expression of sensation on the model of 'object and designation' the object drops out of consideration as irrelevant."*

ANALYSIS: **Three precision points.**

1. The three variations (different in each box, constantly changing, box empty) are not sceptical hypotheses; they are a **demonstration of irrelevance**. If all three are compatible with the word's working exactly as it does, the object cannot be what makes it work.
2. The target is the **object-and-designation model**, not the reality of sensations. Section 293's own next remark warns that *"that is to say: if we construe the grammar ... on the model"* - the conditional is doing the work.
3. The beetle is about a **shared** word. It shows that the private item cannot fix the grammar of a word we all use. It is therefore a supplement to Section 258, which shows that the private item cannot fix the grammar even for the person who has it.

4. Why this is the third printed limb and not an appendix ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: The syllabus prints *Critique of Private Language* as a limb in its own right, and the reason should be stated in any answer: the argument is where the account of meaning developed in Sessions 2-7 is turned on the **one domain that had seemed exempt**. The referential model had been driven out of "the", "if", "five" and "game"; sensation-words were its last refuge, because here it really does look as if a word is attached to an object by inner ostension. Section 258 closes that refuge, and with it the empiricist and Cartesian projects that made the inner the foundation of the outer.

The target	What survives the attack
A private-inner foundation for meaning	An inner life; sensations; first-person expression
Classical empiricist foundationalism - private sense-data as the ultimate given	Perception, evidence, and the ordinary use of "looks", "seems", "feels"
The referential model for sensation words	"Pain" as a word with a rich public grammar (Session 9)
Cartesian privileged access as a semantic foundation	Asymmetry between first and third person, redescribed as avowal (Section 244)

5. The five-step core, written out for the exam ANALYSIS:

- 1 A sign has meaning only if there is a rule for its use.
 - 2 A rule for its use requires a criterion of correct application, independent of how things presently seem to the user. [202]
 - 3 A private ostensive definition supplies no such criterion: the only available check is a further seeming of the same kind. [258, 265]
 - 4 Hence, in the private case, 'correct' and 'seems correct' coincide, and where they coincide, 'correct' has no application. [258]
 - 5 Hence there is no rule, hence no meaning, hence no private language.
- ILLUSTRATION, NOT PREMISE the beetle (293): a private object could vary, change or be absent without disturbing the public word, so it is not what gives the word its grammar.

6. Objections, replies and what genuinely remains open CAUTION:

Objection	Reply	Residue
The Crusoe / solitary speaker objection (associated with Ayer's discussion of the argument): a man alone from birth could invent words for his sensations, and checking memory against memory is no worse than checking it against a community	The target is logical privacy, not solitude. A solitary speaker may use public-type criteria - regular circumstances, repeatable behaviour, physical correlates, a stable technique - and Wittgenstein's argument attacks only the case in which <i>no</i> such criterion is available even in principle	CAUTION: Whether an actual community is required, or only in-principle shareable standards, is genuinely disputed; the optional block records the readings
The memory objection: public checks also rely on memory, so the argument proves too much	Public checks rely on memory plus something independent of the present impression - a chart, a second person, a record. The private case has only the impression. Section 265: several copies of the same newspaper	ANALYSIS: Critics reply that the "independent" check is itself accepted on the basis of memory; the debate is unresolved, and saying so is better than pretending it is not
The behaviourism charge: if "pain" gets its meaning from public use, "pain" means pain-behaviour	Answered in Session 9 by criteria against symptoms and by Section 304, 307-308	ANALYSIS: Whether criterial grammar fully respects inner phenomenology remains contested
The phenomenological objection: the argument makes the felt quality of sensation irrelevant	Section 293 attacks a model of the grammar, not the felt quality; Section 304 insists the sensation is "not a something, but not a nothing either"	CAUTION: Whether that formula is a solution or a refusal to answer is a live question

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Wittgenstein's answer to the question whether we could imagine a language for a person's inner experiences, for his private use, is that we could not - because such a language would have to be founded on private ostensive definition, and private ostensive definition establishes no criterion of correctness, so no rule and therefore no meaning is created. **Named evidence.** Section 243 first sets aside the case that is not at issue, imagining human beings who speak only in monologue and noting that a researcher could learn their language, before narrowing the question to words that "refer to what can only be known to the person speaking; to his immediate private sensations", so that "another person cannot understand the language". Section 258 then works the case: the diarist associates "S" with a recurring sensation and gives himself a kind of ostensive definition by concentrating his attention, but the ceremony can only mean that it brings it about that he remembers the connection rightly in future - "and here we have no criterion of correctness ... whatever is going to seem right to me is right. And that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'." Section 265 compares the internal check to buying several copies of the morning paper to assure oneself of its truth, and Section 202 has already established that obeying a rule is a practice, so that thinking one obeys is not obeying. **Analysis.** The argument is therefore about rules and not about sensations, and its conclusion is that the distinction between correct and seemingly correct cannot arise in the private case - where that distinction cannot arise, "correct" has no application, and a sign whose application cannot be wrong has not been given a use. Section 270 completes the diagnosis constructively: once "S" is correlated with a manometer reading it acquires a genuine use, and Wittgenstein observes that whether the diarist identified the sensation rightly has now become irrelevant, which shows that whatever work the sign does is done by the public criterion. Section 293's beetle supplements this by showing that a private item which might differ in every box, change constantly, or be absent altogether cannot be what fixes the grammar of a shared sensation-word. **Qualification.** The argument's target must be stated precisely or it collapses into a much weaker claim: it is not directed at secret codes, which are decipherable in principle, at talking to oneself, at unshared thoughts, or at physical solitude, since a solitary speaker may still employ public-type criteria. Nor does it deny that sensations exist or that they have a felt character; Section 304 insists that the sensation is "not a something, but not a nothing either", and Section 293's conclusion is expressly conditional on construing the grammar of sensation on the model of object and designation. What remains genuinely open is whether an actual community is required rather than merely in-principle shareable standards, and whether the appeal to independent checks can be sustained without itself relying on memory.

Exam link

- **2024 Q1(d)** (10 marks) - *"Why does later Wittgenstein think that there cannot be a language that only one person can speak - a language that is essentially private?"* The target paragraph, the five-step core, the beetle in one sentence, and the solitary-speaker qualification. That is the whole answer.
- **2020 Q4(c)** (15 marks) - the question quotes Section 243 itself. Reproduce the printed quotation, narrow the target as Section 243 does, then work Section 258 with Section 260, 265 and 270, then handle the memory and Crusoe objections.
- **2019 Q3(b)** (15 marks) - Session 10 applies this apparatus to solipsism.
- **2025 Q3(a)** (20 marks) - the private-language critique is the terminus of the transition: it is where the abandonment of the referential model finally reaches the inner domain that model had seemed to fit best.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Private language = a secret code"	A code is a public language encrypted; it is decipherable in principle
"The argument shows sensations do not exist"	Section 304: <i>"not a something, but not a nothing either"</i> ; Section 293 attacks a model
"It shows that a solitary person cannot have a language"	It targets logical privacy; solitude may still use public-type criteria
"It is an argument about unreliable memory"	It is an argument about the absence of an independent standard
Beetle first, diary second	The diary carries the argument; the beetle removes a residual temptation
Omitting Section 270	Section 270 shows what happens when a public criterion is supplied - the diagnosis completed

Revision notes

- **Section 243** monologuists set aside -> the real question: words referring to *what can only be known to the person speaking*, so that **another person cannot understand the language**.
- **Section 258** diary "S"; inward ostension; no criterion of correctness; *"whatever is going to seem right to me is right"* -> *"here we can't talk about 'right'"*.
- **Section 260** "I believe that this is the sensation S again" - perhaps you believe that you believe it.
- **Section 265** several copies of the **same newspaper**; an imagined table is not a table; justification appeals to something **independent**.
- **Section 270** the manometer variant: the sign acquires a use, and correct **identification becomes irrelevant**.
- **Section 293** beetle: might differ, might change, box might be **empty** -> on the object-and-designation model the object **drops out as irrelevant**.
- **Section 202** obeying a rule is a **practice**; hence **no private rule-following** - the imported premise.
- Four non-targets: secret code · talking to oneself · private thoughts · physical solitude.
- Five-step core: rule -> criterion -> none available privately -> "correct" has no application -> no language.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE PRIVATE-LANGUAGE ARGUMENT

243 NOT the monologuists (our language, spoken alone)
BUT a language whose words refer to WHAT ONLY THE SPEAKER CAN KNOW
-> another person COULD NOT IN PRINCIPLE understand it
|
v
MECHANISM UNDER ATTACK: PRIVATE OSTENSIVE DEFINITION - attend to the
sensation, associate the sign, 'point inwardly'
|
v
258 what does the ceremony achieve? only: I shall REMEMBER the connexion
RIGHT. AND HERE WE HAVE NO CRITERION OF CORRECTNESS
'whatever is going to seem right to me is right' -> 'that only means
that HERE WE CAN'T TALK ABOUT "RIGHT"'
|
+--> 260 'I believe this is S again' - perhaps you believe you believe
+--> 265 several copies of the SAME newspaper; an imagined table is no
| table; justification appeals to something INDEPENDENT
+--> 270 manometer variant: give the sign a PUBLIC criterion and it
| works - and correct inner identification becomes IRRELEVANT
|
v
293 BEETLE: contents might differ / change / be absent -> on the
object-and-designation model the object DROPS OUT AS IRRELEVANT
[supplement, not the primary argument; and expressly CONDITIONAL]
|
v
CORE (with 202): rule -> criterion of correctness -> none available
privately -> 'correct' has no application -> no rule -> NO MEANING ->
NO PRIVATE LANGUAGE
|
v
NOT THE TARGET: secret code · talking to oneself · private thoughts ·
solitude (public-type criteria may still be available)
|
v
ANSWER LINE: where nothing could count as getting it wrong, nothing counts
as getting it right

SESSION 9 - SENSATION LANGUAGE: CRITERIA AGAINST SYMPTOMS, Section 580, AVOWALS, AND THE BEHAVIOURISM CHARGE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: If "pain" does not get its meaning by naming a private object, where does it get it? From the whole surrounding practice: from the circumstances in which we say it, the behaviour that goes with it, the treatment that follows, the way children are taught. The obvious worry is that this makes pain *equal* pain-behaviour - which is behaviourism, and plainly false. This session is the machinery that blocks that inference.

Technical definition: A **criterion (Kriterium)** is a **grammatical**, non-inductive ground for applying a concept: it is fixed by the language-game and taught with the word, and it is **defeasible** - it grounds an ascription without entailing it. A **symptom (Symptom)** is an **inductive** correlation discovered by experience. **Section 580** states the governing thesis: "*An 'inner process' stands in need of outward criteria.*" **Section 244** describes how a sensation-word is learned: verbal expressions of pain **replace** crying, so that "*the verbal expression of pain replaces crying and does not describe it*" - the first-person present-tense use is an **avowal (Äußerung)** rather than a report. **Section 354** notes that the grammar itself **fluctuates** between criteria and symptoms. **Section 304 and 307-308** answer the behaviourism charge: what is denied is the **grammatical fiction** of the inner object, not the inner life.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Wittgenstein is anti-Cartesian without being a behaviourist, and the distinction that makes the position possible is that between a criterion and a symptom: behaviour belongs to the grammar of "pain" without being what "pain" means, because a criterion grounds an ascription without entailing it.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **criterion (Kriterium) / symptom (Symptom)** - both terms, both glossed
- **defeasible** - the single word that blocks the behaviourist inference
- **"An 'inner process' stands in need of outward criteria" (Section 580)** - quoted
- **avowal (Äußerung) (Section 244)** - the first-person use, correctly named
- **"not a something, but not a nothing either" (Section 304)** - the anti-eliminativist line
- **"grammatical fiction" (Section 307)** - the exact word Wittgenstein concedes

How to use them: put **defeasible** in the sentence immediately after you first mention criteria, because that is where the behaviourist objection would otherwise land; quote **Section 580** as the thesis and **Section 304** as the guard; and use the **angina** example from the *Blue Book*, since a worked non-psychological case makes the distinction unmistakable in two lines.

Plain-language visual - the same two questions, asked about a sore throat

'HAS HE GOT ANGINA?' - Blue Book example, Wittgenstein's own	
=====	
CRITERION	SYMPTOM
the presence of a particular BACILLUS in the blood	an inflamed throat

Established by DEFINITION	Established by EXPERIENCE
We DEFINED angina as the illness caused by this bacillus	We FOUND that inflamed throats usually accompany it

If it failed, we would no longer know what 'angina' MEANS	If it failed, we would revise a generalisation; the concept is untouched
=====	
NOW THE SAME TWO COLUMNS FOR PAIN	
=====	
CRITERION	SYMPTOM
pain-behaviour IN APPROPRIATE CIRCUMSTANCES - wincing at an injury, nursing the limb, saying 'it hurts', seeking treatment	a raised pulse; sweating; pallor; a groan produced by an ACTOR on a stage

GRAMMATICAL: it is part of what 'being in pain' comes to; it is how the word is TAUGHT	INDUCTIVE: a correlation experience has taught us; it can fail without disturbing the concept

DEFEASIBLE: pretence, acting and suppression are all possible. The criterion GROUNDS without ENTAILING	DEFEASIBLE TOO - but for a different reason: it never pretended to be more than evidence
=====	
THE ONE SENTENCE THAT DOES THE WORK	
The behaviourist asserts an EQUIVALENCE ('pain' = pain-behaviour).	
Wittgenstein asserts a GRAMMATICAL DEPENDENCE (the concept of pain has application only where there are outward criteria for applying it).	
An equivalence is destroyed by one case of successful pretence.	
A grammatical dependence is not.	
=====	

In simple words: a criterion is like the rule that tells you what "checkmate" means - you learn what the word means by learning to recognise the position. A symptom is like noticing that people usually sigh when they are checkmated. If people stopped sighing, "checkmate" would be unaffected. If the position stopped counting, "checkmate" would have lost its meaning.

Remember first	Meaning
Criterion = grammatical , taught with the word	not evidence for a hidden event
Symptom = inductive , discovered	evidence, and only that
Criteria are defeasible	they ground without entailing - pretence is possible
The grammar fluctuates (Section 354)	criterion and symptom are roles , not a fixed taxonomy

Remember first	Meaning
First person is an avowal (Section 244)	it extends natural expression; it is not self-observation
One-line memory: behaviour is not what pain <i>is</i> ; it is what makes the word "pain" a word we can have.	

VISUAL: VISUAL - Section 580's argument, and the four-move reply to the behaviourism charge

THE THESIS (580) 'An "inner process" stands in need of outward criteria.'

WHAT IT SAYS

The CONCEPT of an inner process
has application only where there
are outward criteria for applying it

WHAT IT DOES NOT SAY

That there are no inner processes

'Remembering', 'intending',
'expecting', 'understanding' are
not names of private episodes we
then report

That mental life is nothing but
behaviour

The grammar of psychological words
is learned in SHARED practices

That I infer my own present pain
from my behaviour - first-person
uses often EXPRESS rather than report

THE ARGUMENT, NUMBERED

- 1 To possess a concept is to master a technique of applying a word correctly and incorrectly. [143-202]
- 2 Mastery requires circumstances in which application is right and circumstances in which it is wrong.
- 3 For a putatively 'inner' concept those circumstances cannot themselves be further inner items - that restarts the same problem one level down (a private criterion for a private criterion). [258]
- 4 Therefore the circumstances must be OUTWARD: behaviour, situation, what precedes and follows - the SURROUNDINGS (Umgebung) of the utterance.
- 5 Therefore: an inner process stands in need of outward criteria. [580]

THE OBJECTION, RAISED BY WITTGENSTEIN AGAINST HIMSELF 307-308

'Aren't you at bottom really saying that everything except human
behaviour is a fiction?' - 'If I do speak of a fiction, then it is
of a GRAMMATICAL fiction.'

THE REPLY IN FOUR MOVES - THE PARAGRAPH THE EXAMINER IS WAITING FOR

- 1 THE DENIAL IS OF A PICTURE, NOT A PHENOMENON 304
'Not a something, but not a nothing either! The conclusion was only
that a nothing would serve just as well as a something about which
nothing could be said.' What is rejected is the model of sensation
as an INNER OBJECT privately named - not pain, joy or memory.
- 2 THE FIRST FALSE STEP 308
We begin by talking innocently of mental 'processes and states',
leaving their nature undecided - 'and now the analogy which was to
make us understand our thoughts falls to pieces. ... THE DECISIVE
MOVEMENT IN THE CONJURING TRICK HAS BEEN MADE, AND IT WAS THE VERY
ONE THAT WE THOUGHT QUITE INNOCENT.'
- 3 CRITERIA ARE NOT DEFINITIONS
Because criteria are DEFEASIBLE, 'he is in pain' is NOT EQUIVALENT to
any statement about behaviour. The behaviourist asserts equivalence;
Wittgenstein asserts grammatical dependence. STATING THIS DIFFERENCE
IS WHAT THE EXAMINER IS LOOKING FOR.
- 4 THE FIRST/THIRD PERSON ASYMMETRY 244, 246
'I am in pain' in the central present-tense case is an AVOWAL
(Aeussderung): it replaces crying, it does not describe it.
'He is in pain' uses behavioural and situational criteria.
246: 'I know I am in pain' is not a piece of knowledge - 'it can't be
said of me at all (except perhaps as a joke) that I KNOW I am in pain.'
CAUTION: not every first-person psychological sentence is an avowal
(('I was afraid last Tuesday' is a report), and neither use identifies
pain with behaviour.

THE FLUCTUATION - THE CANDID ADMISSION THAT EARNS A 20-MARK VERDICT 354

'The fluctuation in grammar between criteria and symptoms makes it look
as if there were nothing at all but symptoms.'
What is a criterion in one language-game may be a symptom in another;
the distinction is a GRAMMATICAL ROLE, not a fixed taxonomy. Say
whether you regard that as candour about how concepts work, or as an
admission that the key notion is not sharp - and give a reason.

ANALYSIS: Caption. Without this session the private-language argument is indefensible: every examiner's first objection to Session 8 is "so you are a behaviourist", and this is the only place the answer lives. Two sentences from here belong in every private-language answer.

1. Where the distinction comes from FACT:

FACT: The **criterion/symptom** vocabulary is developed in the *Blue Book*, dictated 1933-35 and published 1958.

ANALYSIS: Because these were dictations to students rather than a work prepared for print, cite them as "*in the Blue Book*" rather than "*Wittgenstein wrote*" - the same provenance discipline that applies to the *Investigations* itself.

FACT: The **angina** example is Wittgenstein's own: we define angina as the illness produced by a particular bacillus, so the presence of that bacillus is the **criterion**; we discover by experience that an inflamed throat usually accompanies it, so the inflamed throat is a **symptom**. ANALYSIS: Using a **non-psychological** example first is a deliberate teaching choice and a good exam choice: it shows the distinction is general, and it prevents the reader from suspecting that it was invented to save a doctrine about the mind.

2. Why the distinction is indispensable ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: State the necessity explicitly, because it converts a piece of exposition into an argument. Without the distinction, the private-language argument has the following shape: sensation-words get their meaning from public use -> public use is behaviour -> therefore "pain" means pain-behaviour. That is **logical behaviourism**, and it is refuted by a single successful piece of pretence.

With the distinction, the shape is different: sensation-words get their meaning from a language-game whose criteria are **behaviour in appropriate circumstances** -> criteria are grammatical and **defeasible** -> therefore "he is in pain" is grounded, but not entailed, by behaviour. Pretence is not a counter-example; it is a possibility the account **predicts**, since a defeasible criterion is precisely one that can be satisfied where the ascription fails.

3. Section 580, unpacked FACT:

FACT: **Section 580**: "*An 'inner process' stands in need of outward criteria.*" The five-step argument is in the diagram. Two features of it should be stressed in an answer.

(a) **Step 3 is the load-bearing step**, and it is the private-language argument in miniature: the circumstances that fix the application of an inner concept cannot themselves be further inner items, because a private criterion for a private criterion restarts Section 258 one level down. ANALYSIS: Saying this connects Sessions 8 and 9 into one argument and is worth a mark by itself.

(b) **The scare-quotes around "inner process" are doing work**. ANALYSIS: Wittgenstein is not asserting that there are inner processes which need outward criteria; he is examining the phrase. Section 305-308 press exactly this: the temptation is to think that denying an inner process is denying that anything happens, and Section 308 diagnoses that temptation as the result of an earlier, apparently innocent move - treating "mental processes and states" as a category whose nature can be left undecided while we go on to talk about them.

4. Avowals, and the first/third-person asymmetry FACT:

FACT: **Section 244** asks how words refer to sensations and answers with a story about **teaching**: a child hurts himself and cries; adults talk to him and teach him exclamations and later sentences; "*they teach the child new pain-behaviour*" - and so "*the verbal expression of pain replaces crying and does not describe it.*"

FACT: **Section 246** draws the consequence for the alleged privileged access: "*In what sense are my sensations private? - Well, only I can know whether I am really in pain; another person can only surmise it. - In one way this is false, and in another nonsense.*" False, because other people very often do know when I am in pain; nonsense, because "*it can't be said of me at all (except perhaps as a joke) that I know I am in pain.*" One does not learn of one's own pain by observation, and where doubt has no place, knowledge has no place either.

ANALYSIS: **Three cautions.**

1. **Not every first-person psychological sentence is an avowal.** "I was frightened last Tuesday" is a **report**, subject to memory and error. The avowal analysis covers the central **present-tense** case.
2. **The asymmetry is a fact about grammar, not a privilege of access.** The Cartesian explains the asymmetry by an inner theatre to which one person has a ticket; Wittgenstein explains it by the different **roles** of the first- and third-person uses.
3. **ANALYSIS: This is where the position is most contested.** Critics ask whether the avowal analysis can accommodate self-knowledge that is genuinely informative, or the difference between sincerely avowing and being mistaken about one's own state. Wittgenstein has resources - the notion of surroundings, the possibility of a confused avowal - but no settled theory, and an honest answer says so.

5. The fluctuation, and the verdict to give ANALYSIS:CAUTION:

FACT: Section 354: "The fluctuation in grammar between criteria and symptoms makes it look as if there were nothing at all but symptoms." Wittgenstein's example is rain: our criterion for rain is a certain sense-impression, but "it is raining" also functions with a barometer reading, and which counts as the criterion shifts with the game.

ANALYSIS: The verdict this invites is genuinely two-sided, and a twenty-mark answer should take one side and say why.

- **Reading A (candour).** The fluctuation is an accurate observation about how concepts work: nothing in the notion of a criterion requires it to be fixed for all time, and treating it as a role rather than a taxonomy is a feature, not a bug.
- **Reading B (instability).** If the distinction between criterion and symptom itself shifts, then the anti-behaviourist firewall is not a firm boundary but a local convenience, and the claim that behaviour is *constitutive* of the concept becomes hard to state in general.

CAUTION: Both readings are defended in the literature. **ANALYSIS:** The recommendation in this package is Reading A with a concession: the distinction is a genuine grammatical role and does the anti-behaviourist work in the cases that matter, but Wittgenstein's own remark shows that it cannot be drawn once and for all, so the firewall is secured case by case rather than in advance.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Wittgenstein's account of sensation-language is anti-Cartesian without being behaviourist, because it holds that behaviour in appropriate circumstances is a criterion for a psychological ascription - a grammatical and defeasible ground - rather than what the ascription means. **Named evidence.** The *Blue Book*, dictated in 1933-35 and published in 1958, distinguishes the criterion of angina, the presence of a particular bacillus which we have defined as constitutive, from its symptom, the inflamed throat that experience has taught us to expect; the same distinction is applied to pain, where wincing, nursing an injured limb and seeking treatment are criteria while a raised pulse or an actor's groan are at best symptoms. Section 580 states the thesis that an "inner process" stands in need of outward criteria, and Section 244 shows how such criteria are acquired: adults teach the child new pain-behaviour, so that the verbal expression of pain replaces crying and does not describe it. Section 246 adds that "I know I am in pain" can be said of me at all only as a joke, since I do not learn of my pain by observation. Section 307 records the objection in the interlocutor's own voice - that everything except human behaviour is being made a fiction - and answers that if it is a fiction it is a grammatical fiction, while Section 304 insists that the sensation is "not a something, but not a nothing either". **Analysis.** The distinction is what makes the position a third way rather than a version of behaviourism. A behaviourist asserts an equivalence between psychological ascriptions and behavioural statements, and a single case of successful pretence refutes an equivalence; Wittgenstein asserts a grammatical dependence, on which pretence is not a counter-example but a possibility the account predicts, since a defeasible criterion is exactly one that may be satisfied where the ascription fails. Section 580's argument is also the private-language argument in miniature, because its load-bearing step is that the circumstances fixing an inner concept cannot themselves be further inner items without restarting Section 258 one level down; and Section 308 explains why the difficulty seemed compelling, by locating the decisive movement in the conjuring trick at the apparently innocent step of speaking of mental processes and states whose nature is left undecided. **Qualification.** Three limits should be conceded. Not every first-person psychological sentence is an avowal, since past-tense reports are subject to memory and error, so the analysis covers the central present-tense case. Section 354's admission that the grammar fluctuates between criteria and symptoms means that the distinction is a grammatical role rather than a fixed taxonomy, and cannot be drawn once and for all. And the residual question - whether criterial grammar adequately respects the felt character of experience and the informativeness of self-knowledge - remains genuinely open, which is why Section 304's formula is read by some as a solution and by others as a refusal to answer.

Exam link

- **2020 Q4(c)** (15 marks) and **2024 Q1(d)** (10 marks): the behaviourism objection is the first thing an examiner will test after the diary argument. Two sentences from Section 304 and 307-308 plus the word **defeasible** answer it.
- **2019 Q3(b)** (15 marks): the first/third-person asymmetry is what allows Wittgenstein to reject solipsism without asserting an inductive argument for other minds.

- **2025 Q3(a)** (20 marks): Section 244's account of learning "pain" is the clearest single case of meaning displaced from reference to use, and it makes the transition concrete.
- **2023 Q4(c)** (15 marks): the failure of the referential model in its **last refuge** is the strongest of the reasons for the shift.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Wittgenstein is a logical behaviourist"	Criteria are defeasible ; a behaviourist asserts an equivalence , which pretence refutes
"Criteria are evidence for a hidden inner event"	They are grammatical : the circumstances in which the concept has its home
"'Pain' means pain-behaviour"	Section 304: not a something, but not a nothing either; Section 307: a grammatical fiction
"I know I am in pain" treated as knowledge	Section 246: sayable of me only as a joke; where doubt is excluded, knowledge has no role
Treating all first-person uses as avowals	Section 244 covers the central present-tense case; past-tense uses are reports
Ignoring Section 354	The fluctuation is Wittgenstein's own admission and is where the verdict mark lies

Revision notes

- **Source:** *Blue Book*, dictated **1933-35**, published **1958** - say "in the Blue Book".
- **Angina:** criterion = the **bacillus** (defined); symptom = the **inflamed throat** (discovered).
- **Pain:** criterion = pain-behaviour **in appropriate circumstances**; symptom = raised pulse, an actor's groan.
- **Criteria are defeasible** - pretence, acting and suppression are all possible; they **ground without entailing**.
- **Section 580** an "inner process" stands in need of **outward criteria**; step 3 = a private criterion for a private criterion restarts Section 258.
- **Section 244** the verbal expression of pain **replaces** crying and does not describe it -> **avowal (Äußerung)**.
- **Section 246** "I know I am in pain" - sayable only as a joke; no observation, hence no knowledge-claim.
- **Section 304** "not a something, but not a nothing either"; **Section 307** a **grammatical** fiction; **Section 308** the decisive movement in the conjuring trick, at the step we thought innocent.
- **Section 354** the grammar **fluctuates** between criteria and symptoms - take a side on what that shows.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SENSATION LANGUAGE

PROBLEM: if 'pain' does not name a private object, does it mean BEHAVIOUR?

|

v

DISTINCTION (Blue Book, dictated 1933-35, published 1958)

CRITERION (Kriterium) grammatical · taught with the word · DEFEASIBLE

SYMPTOM (Symptom) inductive · discovered by experience

ANGINA: bacillus = criterion | inflamed throat = symptom

PAIN: behaviour in appropriate circumstances = criterion |
raised pulse, an actor's groan = symptom

|

v

580 an 'inner process' stands in need of OUTWARD CRITERIA

1 concept = mastery of a technique 2 mastery needs right/wrong

3 the circumstances cannot be further INNER items (that restarts 258)

4 so they are OUTWARD - behaviour, situation, SURROUNDINGS (Umgebung)

5 hence 580

|

v

CHARGE (307): 'everything except human behaviour is a fiction?'

REPLY: 'if a fiction, then a GRAMMATICAL fiction'

1 304 'not a something, but not a nothing either'

2 308 the decisive movement in the conjuring trick - at the innocent step

3 criteria are DEFEASIBLE -> grammatical dependence, NOT equivalence

4 244 first person = AVOWAL, replaces crying, does not describe it

246 'I know I am in pain' - only as a joke

|

v

354 the grammar FLUCTUATES between criteria and symptoms

Reading A candour about concepts | Reading B the firewall is local

RECOMMENDED: A, with the concession that it is secured case by case

|

v

ANSWER LINE: behaviour is not what pain is; it is what makes 'pain' a word
we can have

SESSION 10 - SOLIPSISM: FROM THE TRACTATUS LIMIT TO THE GRAMMATICAL DISSOLUTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The solipsist says: only my own experiences are real; everything else - the world, other people's minds - may be nothing at all. Wittgenstein's later reply is not to prove that other people exist. It is to look at the words the solipsist is using and to ask where he obtained them, on what basis he applies them, and what would count as his applying them wrongly. When those questions are pressed, the thesis loses the vocabulary it needs in order to be stated.

Technical definition: Solipsism is the position that only the subject's own mind, or its experiences, can be known to exist or is real. The **early** treatment (*Tractatus* 5.6-5.641) holds that "*the limits of my language mean the limits of my world*", that what the solipsist **means** is quite correct but **cannot be said** - it **shows** itself - and that solipsism strictly carried out coincides with pure realism, the "I" shrinking to an extensionless point. The **later** treatment is entirely different in route: it applies the **private-language** considerations to the solipsist's own vocabulary, showing that a language whose terms are fixed solely by the speaker's present private seeming has no criterion of correctness, so that the thesis is **self-undermining** rather than false. ANALYSIS: The result is a **dissolution**, not a refutation: no empirical proof of other minds is offered or needed.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The solipsist is not defeated by evidence of other minds but by his own sentence: to say that only his experiences are real he must use words whose application he cannot fix from inside his own experience, so the thesis consumes the language required to state it.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **dissolution, not refutation** - the exact verdict-word, chosen deliberately
- **the limits of my language mean the limits of my world (Tractatus 5.6)** - the early formula

- **saying and showing** - how the early book handled it
- **self-undermining** - the later verdict, precisely
- **logical privacy** - what the argument attacks; solitude is not the target
- **no inductive argument for other minds** - what is *not* claimed

How to use them: open by distinguishing **refutation** from **dissolution**, since the 2019 verb "culminates" invites a candidate to claim a proof that Wittgenstein never offers; then set out the early treatment briefly and accurately, because getting 5.62 right is the cheapest mark in this answer; and close on what remains unproved, which is where the "critically" content lives.

Plain-language visual - three ways to answer a solipsist, and which one is Wittgenstein's

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ROUTE 1  REFUTE HIM  (not Wittgenstein's)
  'Here is one hand, and here is another.' - Moore's style.
  'Other bodies behave as mine does, so they probably have minds.'
  - the ARGUMENT FROM ANALOGY.
  STATUS: an empirical or quasi-empirical case for other minds. The
  solipsist replies that all the evidence is, once again, HIS experience.
-----
ROUTE 2  SHOW THAT WHAT HE MEANS CANNOT BE SAID  (Tractatus, 5.62-5.641)
  'The limits of MY language mean the limits of MY world' (5.6).
  'What the solipsist MEANS is quite correct; only it cannot be SAID,
  but makes itself manifest.'
  'The self of solipsism shrinks to a point without extension, and there
  remains the reality co-ordinated with it' - so solipsism strictly
  carried out COINCIDES WITH PURE REALISM.
  STATUS: a limit-of-language treatment via SAYING and SHOWING.
-----
ROUTE 3  EXAMINE HIS VOCABULARY  (Investigations - the later route)
  Ask: 'only MY experiences are real' - where did you get the words
  'experience', 'real', 'mine', 'only'? On what basis do you apply them?
  What would count as applying them WRONGLY?
  If the answer is 'my present impression', then by 258 correct and
  seems-correct coincide, and the words have no rule.
  If the answer appeals to public-type criteria, the solipsist has
  already conceded the practice he was denying.
  STATUS: DISSOLUTION. The thesis is SELF-UNDERMINING, not false.
=====
WHICH ROUTE THE 2019 QUESTION WANTS
  'Show how Wittgenstein's critique of solipsism CULMINATES in the
  critique of private language.'
  -> Narrate 2, then 3. The word 'culminates' is asking for the
  DEVELOPMENT from the early limit-treatment to the later grammatical
  one - and for the observation that the ROUTE changed even though
  the anti-solipsist direction did not.
=====

```

In simple words: it is like someone announcing, in fluent English, that no language he speaks can be understood by anyone. The claim is not disproved by producing a listener; it is undermined by the fact that he had to use English to make it. The solipsist is in that position with respect to every concept in his thesis.

Remember first	Meaning
The verdict is dissolution	not "solipsism is false", and not "other minds are proved"
The early route is saying/showing	5.62; the later route is grammar and criteria
Do not say the later work simply completes the early	ANALYSIS: the route changes; that is the examinable development
Logical privacy is the target	a solitary survivor is not thereby a solipsist
The asymmetry from Session 9 does the work	avowal versus criterial ascription, not inference from behaviour

One-line memory: you cannot say, in a language you learned from others, that there is nobody but you.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the four-step later argument, and the honest limits of the result

STEP 1 STATE THE THESIS IN ITS STRONGEST FORM

'Only my experiences are real. The external world and other minds may not exist.' Note that the solipsist is not merely doubting: he is making a claim, and a claim needs concepts with determinate use.

STEP 2 ASK WHERE THE CONCEPTS COME FROM

'experience' · 'real' · 'mine' · 'only' · 'exist' · 'pain' · 'seeing'
Each is a word with a grammar. Each was learned. Each has criteria of application that the solipsist is presently using.

STEP 3 APPLY THE PRIVATE-LANGUAGE RESULT

258, 202

If the solipsist says the criteria are fixed by his own present seeming, then correct and seems-correct coincide -> 'here we can't talk about "right" -> the words have no rule -> the thesis has not been stated.

If he says the criteria are stable, repeatable and checkable, he has helped himself to exactly the PUBLIC-TYPE practice his thesis denies.

STEP 4 DRAW THE CORRECT VERDICT

Solipsism is not refuted by evidence; it is SELF-UNDERMINING. The attempt to ground all meaning in what only this subject can identify removes the conditions under which anything determinate is said. COMPARE the Tractatus verdict: strictly carried out, solipsism 'coincides with pure realism' - the early book also declines to treat it as a false empirical thesis.

WHAT IS **NOT** ESTABLISHED - SAY SO, AND THE ANSWER BECOMES CRITICAL

- X That other minds EXIST (that would need a positive argument this method does not offer, and 303: 'just try - in a real case - to doubt someone else's fear or pain')
- X That the external world exists (Moore's proof and On Certainty's hinges are a different discussion, and On Certainty is enrichment here)
- X That a person could not in fact live alone (physical solitude is not logical privacy)

THE SUPPORTING MATERIAL FROM SESSION 9 THAT BELONGS IN THIS ANSWER

- * 244 'I am in pain' is an AVOWAL - it replaces crying. So the first-person case is not a report of a private object that others must guess at
- * 246 'only I can know whether I am really in pain' is FALSE in one way (others often do know) and NONSENSE in another (I do not learn it by observation)
- * 293 the beetle: the private object drops out of the SHARED game
- * 580 an inner process stands in need of outward criteria
-> Together these dismantle the ASYMMETRY the solipsist relies on, without asserting an inductive inference to other minds

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The 2019 part is the only routed question that requires both the early and the later treatment in the same answer. This diagram is its plan: Route 2 briefly, Route 3 in full, then the honest limits.

1. The early treatment, stated accurately FACT:

FACT: *Tractatus 5.6: "The limits of my language mean the limits of my world."* **5.62:** *"This remark provides the key to the problem, how much truth there is in solipsism. For what the solipsist means is quite correct; only it cannot be said, but makes itself manifest."* **5.64:** solipsism, when its implications are followed out strictly, *"coincides with pure realism"* - the self of solipsism shrinks to a point without extension, and there remains the reality co-ordinated with it.

ANALYSIS: **Two points that must not be lost.** First, the early Wittgenstein does **not** say solipsism is false; he says what the solipsist means cannot be *said*. Second, the mechanism is **saying and showing**, which is the doctrine owned by Topic 06 - so it should be named here in one clause and not expounded. ANALYSIS: A candidate who writes "the *Tractatus* ignored the self" or "the early Wittgenstein was a solipsist" has made an error that is visible from the section number alone.

2. Why the later route is genuinely different ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: It is tempting, and wrong, to present the later argument as the early one completed. The **direction** is the same - solipsism is not a false theory but a confusion - but the **route** is entirely changed:

	Early (Tractatus)	Later (Investigations)
Where the trouble is located	at the limit of language and the world	in the grammar of the solipsist's words
The operative distinction	saying versus showing	criterion versus mere seeming
The status of the subject	a metaphysical subject at the boundary, not in the world	a person among others, with a body, a history and a training
Verdict	what he means is correct but unsayable ; strictly carried out it coincides with realism	the thesis is self-undermining : it removes the conditions for saying anything determinate
What replaces the doctrine	silence	a description of how psychological concepts are actually used

ANALYSIS: Saying that the route changed is exactly what the 2019 verb "culminates" is testing: a culmination is a development, not a repetition, and the mark is for showing what developed.

3. The argument in full FACT:

The four steps are in the diagram. Two of them deserve amplification.

Step 2 is not a debating trick. ANALYSIS: The point is not "you used words, so you lose". It is that the solipsist's thesis is a **claim**, and a claim requires concepts whose application can be right or wrong. So the question "what fixes the application of 'experience' in your mouth?" is the same question Section 258 asks of "S", and it is legitimate for the same reason.

Step 3's dilemma is the whole argument, and it should be written as a dilemma. Either the solipsist's terms are fixed by his own present seeming - in which case, by Section 258, correct and seems-correct coincide and no rule has been given, so nothing determinate has been asserted; or they are fixed by stable, repeatable, checkable techniques - in which case he has helped himself to precisely the kind of practice his thesis was denying. ANALYSIS: Presenting it as a dilemma converts the answer from narration into argument and is worth several marks in a fifteen-mark part.

4. What is not proved, and why saying so earns marks ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: Three things are **not** established, and a candidate who lists them demonstrates control of the argument's exact strength:

1. **That other minds exist.** No inductive or transcendental proof is offered. Section 303 makes the relevant observation obliquely: "*Just try - in a real case - to doubt someone else's fear or pain*", which is a remark about where doubt has application, not an argument that doubt is false.
2. **That the external world exists.** That is Moore's territory and, in a different key, *On Certainty's* - enrichment here, not doctrine (Session 12).
3. **That solitude is impossible.** Physical solitude is compatible with a language having public-type criteria; the target is **logical** privacy throughout.

ANALYSIS: There is also a genuine objection to record: a determined solipsist may reply that Wittgenstein's argument only shows he cannot *communicate* his thesis, not that it is untrue. The Wittgensteinian answer is that a thesis whose terms have no determinate application has not been formulated at all, so there is nothing left to be true - but this reply depends on the private-language argument's success and inherits whatever residual doubt attaches to it (Session 8, Section 6).

5. Building the 2019 answer ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: A workable five-part plan, which the model answer in the practice section follows:

1. **Thesis:** the critique is a dissolution, and the private-language argument supplies its decisive ground.
2. **Early:** 5.6, 5.62, 5.64 in three lines - limit, saying/showing, coincidence with realism.
3. **Change of route:** the table in Section 2 above, compressed to two sentences.
4. **The dilemma:** Step 3, stated as a dilemma, with Section 258 and Section 202 cited.
5. **Limits and verdict:** no proof of other minds; solitude not the target; Section 303 on where doubt has application; and the concluding line that the solipsist's thesis consumes its own vocabulary.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Wittgenstein's critique of solipsism culminates in the critique of private language because the later route no longer places solipsism at the limit of what can be said, but examines the solipsist's own vocabulary and shows that it can have no determinate application unless the practice he denies is presupposed. **Named evidence.** The *Tractatus* had already declined to treat solipsism as a false empirical thesis: 5.6 states that the limits of my language mean the limits of my world, 5.62 that what the solipsist means is quite correct but cannot be said and makes itself manifest, and 5.64 that solipsism strictly carried out coincides with pure realism, the self shrinking to an extensionless point. The *Investigations* changes the route: Section 202 establishes that obeying a rule is a practice and that thinking one obeys is not obeying, and Section 258 shows that a sign whose application is fixed by the user's present seeming admits no distinction between being right and seeming right, so that "here we can't talk about 'right'". Section 246 removes the asymmetry the solipsist relies upon, since "only I can know whether I am really in pain" is false in one way, because others often do know, and nonsense in another, because I do not learn of my pain by observation; and Section 244 shows that the first-person utterance replaces crying rather than describing it. **Analysis.** The result is a dilemma rather than a refutation. Either the solipsist's terms - "experience", "real", "mine" - are fixed by his own present impression, in which case Section 258 applies and no rule has been given, so the thesis has not been stated; or they are fixed by stable, repeatable techniques, in which case he has presupposed the very public-type practice his thesis denies. The critique therefore *culminates* in the private-language argument in a precise sense: the early treatment could only say that the solipsist's meaning was unsayable, whereas the later argument identifies exactly what is missing - a criterion of correctness - and shows that its absence is what makes the position unstateable. **Qualification.** The verdict must be stated at its true strength. Nothing here proves that other minds exist, and Section 303's remark that one should try, in a real case, to doubt another's pain concerns where doubt has application rather than establishing an inductive conclusion; nothing here shows that a person could not live in physical solitude, since the target throughout is logical privacy; and a determined solipsist may reply that only the communicability of his thesis has been impugned, to which the Wittgensteinian answer - that a thesis whose terms have no determinate application has not been formulated - inherits whatever residual doubt attaches to the private-language argument itself.

Exam link

- **2019 Q3(b)** (15 marks) - the whole session, structured by Section 5's five-part plan.
- **2020 Q4(c)** (15 marks): the same dilemma, applied to Section 243's question rather than to the solipsist.
- **2024 Q1(d)** (10 marks): the target-identification paragraph is shared; solitude is not the target in either.
- **2025 Q3(a)** (20 marks): the change of route on solipsism is one of the clearest single illustrations of the transition, and it can be used in a sentence to show the transition was of method rather than of subject.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Wittgenstein refutes solipsism / proves other minds"	It is a dissolution ; no proof of other minds is offered
"The <i>Tractatus</i> ignored solipsism"	5.6-5.641 treat it via saying and showing ; 5.64: it coincides with pure realism
"The later argument simply completes the early one"	The route changes - from the limit of language to grammar and criteria
"Language is public, therefore other minds exist"	A non-sequitur, and the exact fatal error the directive decoder flags
"Solipsism is shown to be false"	It is shown to be self-undermining / unstateable
Expounding saying and showing at length	That doctrine is Topic 06 ; one clause is the right budget

Revision notes

- *Tractatus* **5.6** limits of my language = limits of my world; **5.62** what the solipsist means is correct but **cannot be said**; **5.64** strictly carried out it **coincides with pure realism**.
- Later route: **grammar and criteria**, not saying/showing.

- **The dilemma:** present seeming -> Section 258, no rule, nothing stated; stable technique -> the public-type practice conceded.
- **Section 246** "only I can know..." - false in one way, nonsense in another; **Section 244** avowal replaces crying.
- **Section 303** try, in a real case, to doubt another's pain - a remark about the **place of doubt**.
- Verdict: **self-undermining**, not false; **dissolution**, not refutation.
- Not proved: other minds · the external world · the impossibility of solitude.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SOLIPSISM

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THEESIS: 'only my experiences are real'
|
+--> EARLY (Tractatus 5.6-5.64): limits of MY language = limits of MY
|       world | what the solipsist MEANS is correct but CANNOT BE SAID |
|       strictly carried out it COINCIDES WITH PURE REALISM
|       MECHANISM: saying / showing          [doctrine owned by Topic 06]
|
v
LATER ROUTE CHANGES: from the LIMIT of language to the GRAMMAR of his words
|
v
QUESTION: 'experience', 'real', 'mine', 'only' - what fixes their APPLICATION?
|
+--> HORN 1  his present seeming -> 258: correct = seems-correct ->
|       'here we can't talk about "right"' -> no rule -> NOTHING STATED
+--> HORN 2  stable, repeatable, checkable technique -> he has conceded
|       the PUBLIC-TYPE practice his thesis denied
|
v
SUPPORT FROM SESSION 9: 244 avowal | 246 'only I can know' false and
nonsense | 293 beetle | 580 outward criteria
-> the ASYMMETRY the solipsist needs is dismantled WITHOUT an inductive
argument for other minds
|
v
VERDICT: SELF-UNDERMINING - a DISSOLUTION, not a refutation
NOT PROVED: other minds · the external world · that solitude is impossible
|
v
ANSWER LINE: you cannot say, in a language you learned from others, that
there is nobody but you

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SESSION 11 - PHILOSOPHY AS THERAPY: LANGUAGE ON HOLIDAY, THE FLY-BOTTLE, AND WHAT "LEAVES EVERYTHING AS IT IS" MEANS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Wittgenstein thinks most philosophical problems are not questions waiting for answers. They are knots: we take a word out of the setting where it does its work, keep using it as though nothing had changed, and then find ourselves unable to move. The cure is not a new theory but a reminder of how the word actually works - and the sign of success is that the question stops seeming compulsory.

Technical definition: The **therapeutic conception of philosophy** holds that philosophical problems arise from **misunderstandings of the grammar of our language** and are to be **dissolved** by **assembling reminders** (Section 127) and by producing a **perspicuous representation** (**übersichtliche Darstellung**) of the use of our words (Section 122), rather than by advancing explanatory theories. Its key remarks are **Section 38** (problems arise "*when language goes on holiday*" - *wenn die Sprache feiert*, closer to *idles*), **Section 109** (philosophy is "*a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language*"; description replaces explanation), **Section 115** ("*a picture held us captive*"), **Section 123** ("*a philosophical problem has the form: 'I don't know my way about'*"), **Section 124** ("*philosophy leaves everything as it is*"), **Section 128**, **Section 133** ("*there is not a philosophical method, though there are indeed methods, like different therapies*"), **Section 255** ("*the philosopher's treatment of a question is like the treatment of an illness*"), and **Section 309** ("*What is your aim in philosophy? - To show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle*").

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The therapeutic conception is not a modest retreat from philosophy but a reclassification of its difficulties: a philosophical problem is diagnosed as disorientation rather than ignorance, and the test of success is accordingly not a new proposition established but a compulsion removed.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **language goes on holiday / idles (Section 38)** - with the German gloss, which is the mark
- **"a picture held us captive" (Section 115)** - the mechanism named
- **"I don't know my way about" (Section 123)** - the reclassification of the difficulty
- **perspicuous representation (Section 122)** - the positive method
- **"leaves everything as it is" (Section 124)** - quoted, and then correctly bounded
- **"methods, like different therapies" (Section 133)** - plural, and that plural is doctrine

How to use them: give the **Section 38 German gloss** early - *feiert* is closer to "idles" than to "is on vacation", and the image is machinery running without load - because it is the cheapest single mark in this session; and never quote **Section 124** without immediately stating what it does and does not commit Wittgenstein to, since the quietism objection is built on that quotation.

Plain-language visual - the machine that runs without doing work

THE MECHANISM OF A PHILOSOPHICAL PROBLEM

STAGE 1 A WORD AT WORK

'know', 'time', 'meaning', 'I', 'same', 'exist'

In its home game the word does a definite job with definite standards.

'Do you know the way?' 'What time does the train leave?'

STAGE 2 THE WORD IS TAKEN OUT OF THE GAME [38 - language IDLES]

'But do I really KNOW anything?' 'What IS time?'

Surface grammar is unchanged - it still looks like a question with an answer. But no game has been specified in which it makes a move.

The engine turns; the wheels are off the ground.

STAGE 3 A PICTURE FILLS THE GAP [115 - held CAPTIVE]

Something must correspond to the noun. A hidden mechanism of meaning.

An inner object behind 'pain'. A flow behind 'time'.

'And we could not get outside it, for it lay in our language and language seemed to repeat it to us inexorably.'

STAGE 4 DISORIENTATION [123 - 'I don't know my

Not ignorance of a fact. 'I DON'T KNOW MY WAY ABOUT' way about']

One is lost in a familiar town, not short of a map of a strange one.

STAGE 5 THE TREATMENT [122, 127, 133, 255, 309]

Not a rival theory. ASSEMBLE REMINDERS of how the word is used;

produce a **PERSPICUOUS REPRESENTATION** that lets us SEE CONNECTIONS;

compare the puzzling use with unpuzzling ones.

'The philosopher's treatment of a question is like the treatment of an illness' (255).

'What is your aim in philosophy? - To show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle' (309).

THE TEST OF SUCCESS (133, in substance)

'The real discovery is the one that makes me capable of stopping doing philosophy when I want to.' Not a proposition proved - a **COMPULSION DISSOLVED**.

In simple words: the fly is not trapped by anything solid. The bottle is open at the top; the fly keeps going towards the light at the sides because that is what flies do. Nothing needs to be broken. Something needs to be *shown*. That is exactly the relation Wittgenstein claims between his reminders and a philosophical problem.

Remember first	Meaning
<i>feiert</i> = idles , not "vacation"	the image is machinery running without load

Remember first	Meaning
The picture is in our language	Section 115: which is why it feels inescapable
The problem is disorientation	Section 123: not a missing fact
Reminders are assembled , not invented	Section 127: the material is already known
Methods , plural, like therapies	Section 133: there is no single "Wittgensteinian method"

One-line memory: the philosopher is not ignorant; he is lost - and a map of a town he already knows is what he needs.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the five load-bearing remarks, and the two objections that must be answered

THE REMARK	Section	WHAT IT CONTRIBUTES
'Philosophical problems arise when language goes on holiday'	38	LOCATES THE ORIGIN. A word removed from its language-game keeps its surface grammar and loses its use. German: WENN DIE SPRACHE FEIERT - when language IDLES, is not at work. Anscombe's 'holiday' is idiomatic but slightly misleading: the image is an engine running without load, not a vacation.
'A picture held us captive. And we could not get outside it, for it lay in our language and language seemed to repeat it to us inexorably.'	115	NAMES THE MECHANISM. A Bild - the inner object, the essence, the hidden mechanism of meaning. The captivity is linguistic, which is why it cannot be escaped by resolving to think differently.
'A philosophical problem has the form: "I don't know my way about."'	123	RECLASSIFIES THE DIFFICULTY. Not ignorance of a fact - DISORIENTATION. Ich kenne mich nicht aus. This is why more information does not help.
'The philosopher's treatment of a question is like the treatment of an illness.'	255	STATES THE ANALOGY OUTRIGHT. Treatment, not discovery. And note: an illness is not refuted.
'What is your aim in philosophy? - To show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle.'	309	THE GOVERNING IMAGE. Der Fliege den Ausweg aus dem Fliegenglas zeigen. The fly is not held by anything; it is repeating a move that sustains the trap. What is needed is not force but a SHOWING.

THE POSITIVE METHOD - NOT 'DO NOTHING'

- 122 PERSPICUOUS REPRESENTATION (uebersichtliche Darstellung): an arrangement that produces 'just that understanding which consists in SEEING CONNECTIONS'. Wittgenstein calls it 'of fundamental significance for us' and says it earmarks the form of account we give.
- 127 'The work of the philosopher consists in ASSEMBLING REMINDERS for a particular purpose.'
- 128 'If one tried to advance THESES in philosophy, it would never be possible to debate them, because everyone would agree to them.'
- 129 'The aspects of things that are most important for us are hidden because of their SIMPLICITY AND FAMILIARITY.'
- 133 'There is not A philosophical method, though there are indeed METHODS, LIKE DIFFERENT THERAPIES.'

OBJECTION 1 QUIETISM / CONSERVATISM

'Philosophy leaves everything as it is" (124) removes philosophy's critical function, including social critique.'

REPLY 124 is about GRAMMAR: philosophy 'may in no way interfere with the actual use of language; it can in the end only describe it'. The claim concerns conceptual description, not social practice; therapy removes confusion and does not forbid reform.

RESIDUE the range of what philosophy MAY do is deliberately and severely narrowed. The charge is not fully answered, and saying so is better than pretending it is.

OBJECTION 2 SELF-APPLICATION

'The therapeutic method is itself a philosophical thesis about philosophy, so it refutes itself.'

REPLY Wittgenstein accepts a version: his remarks are ladder-like, and 133 speaks of METHODS in the plural, so there is no single doctrine to be self-refuting.

RESIDUE structurally the same problem as the Tractatus ladder (6.54). THE CONTINUITY BETWEEN EARLY AND LATE ON THIS EXACT POINT IS A FIRST-CLASS EXAM OBSERVATION.

OBJECTION 3 SOME PROBLEMS ARE REAL

'Personal identity, free will, the status of mathematics survive any

amount of grammatical clarification.'

REPLY Wittgenstein would treat persistence as evidence that the picture holding us captive has not yet been fully exhibited.

RESIDUE UNFALSIFIABLE AS STATED. This is the most serious methodological complaint, and an honest answer says so.

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** No routed question asks about therapy on its own, and that is exactly why this session matters: it supplies the **verdict paragraph** for the 2023 and 2025 transition parts and the **methodological frame** for every private-language answer, since the private-language argument is itself a piece of grammatical therapy.

1. Language idling: the diagnosis FACT:

FACT: **Section 38** occurs while Wittgenstein is discussing the word "this" and the temptation to treat it as the only genuine name. He observes: *"For philosophical problems arise when language goes on holiday."* ANALYSIS: The German is *"wenn die Sprache feiert"*. *Feiern* is used of a machine or a workman that is **idle** - not working - and the image is of an engine running while disconnected from its load. Anscombe's "holiday" is idiomatic English but suggests recreation, which is the wrong picture. ANALYSIS: Giving the German with a one-clause gloss is the single most economical way to show mastery of the provenance discipline in this clause.

ANALYSIS: **What idling means concretely.** A word's surface grammar survives its removal from a language-game; its **use** does not. "It is 5 o'clock on the sun" (Section 350-351) is the standard demonstration: nothing is grammatically wrong, and nothing has been said, because our practice of telling the time is tied to the sun's position relative to a place on the earth. The philosophical question "but what *is* time?" is diagnosed as the same phenomenon at a deeper level - and Section 89's citation of Augustine ("If no one asks me, I know; if I wish to explain it to one who asks, I know not") is the classic case.

2. The picture that holds us captive FACT:

FACT: **Section 115:** *"A picture held us captive. And we could not get outside it, for it lay in our language and language seemed to repeat it to us inexorably."*

ANALYSIS: **Three features of this remark are examinable.**

1. The captor is a **picture (Bild)** - not a false proposition. One can refute a proposition; a picture has to be **exhibited**, and the exhibiting is the therapy.
2. The captivity is **linguistic**, not psychological: it lies *in our language*, which is why resolving to think differently does not help and why the treatment must be grammatical.
3. The picture is usually **natural and useful** somewhere. The object-and-designation model is right for "table"; the trouble begins when it is carried where it does not belong. ANALYSIS: That is why the method is comparison rather than refutation: the aim is to show the picture's proper home, not to abolish it.

3. Perspicuous representation, and what the method positively does FACT:

FACT: **Section 122:** *"A main source of our failure to understand is that we do not command a clear view of the use of our words. - Our grammar is lacking in this sort of perspicuity. A perspicuous representation produces just that understanding which consists in 'seeing connections'. Hence the importance of finding and inventing intermediate cases."* And: *"The concept of a perspicuous representation is of fundamental significance for us. It earmarks the form of account we give, the way we look at things."*

FACT: **Section 127:** *"The work of the philosopher consists in assembling reminders for a particular purpose."* FACT: **Section 129:** what is most important is hidden by its **simplicity and familiarity**. FACT: **Section 128:** if one advanced theses in philosophy, they could never be debated, because everyone would agree with them.

ANALYSIS: **The method is therefore not passivity.** It has identifiable operations: *find intermediate cases; invent language-games for comparison; ask how the word was taught; ask what would count as a mistake; place the puzzling use beside an unpuzzling one.* ANALYSIS: A script that says "Wittgenstein thinks philosophy should just describe" has stated a slogan; a script that lists two of these operations has described a method.

4. "Leaves everything as it is", correctly bounded FACT:ANALYSIS:

FACT: **Section 124:** *"Philosophy may in no way interfere with the actual use of language; it can in the end only describe it. For it cannot give it any foundation either. It leaves everything as it is."*

ANALYSIS: **The scope of the remark is fixed by its first clause**, and quoting it without that clause is what generates the quietism charge. What is left as it is, is the **use of language**: philosophy is not entitled to legislate that

people are misusing "know" or "time", nor to supply grammar with a foundation. It does not follow, and Wittgenstein does not say, that social arrangements should be left as they are, that conceptual criticism is illegitimate, or that reform is forbidden.

ANALYSIS: The concession that must accompany the reply. The range of what philosophy may legitimately *do* is deliberately and severely narrowed. Wittgenstein forbids explanatory theory, foundational justification and revisionary legislation over grammar. A critic who says that this leaves philosophy with very little is not misreading him; the honest position is to state the reply and then concede that the reply narrows the discipline drastically, which is a cost Wittgenstein accepts rather than an objection he answers.

5. Continuity with the *Tractatus*, and the self-application problem **ANALYSIS:CAUTION:**

ANALYSIS: The self-application objection is the strongest available, and it is the point at which the two Wittgensteins meet. The *Tractatus* ends by declaring its own propositions nonsensical, to be used as a ladder and thrown away (6.54). The *Investigations* denies that it advances theses (Section 128) and speaks of **methods**, in the plural, "*like different therapies*" (Section 133), while its own preface calls the book an album of sketches.

CAUTION: Whether this is a coherent position or a self-undermining one is genuinely disputed, and both readings should be named:

- **The resolute reading:** the plurality is the point - there is no doctrine to be self-refuting, only a family of clarificatory practices whose success is measured case by case.
- **The critical reading:** any claim of the form "philosophical problems are grammatical confusions" is a general thesis about philosophy, and the method cannot exempt itself from its own strictures.

ANALYSIS: The recommendation: report both, then rule that the self-application charge has real force but is mitigated by Section 133's plural, and note that the *structural* similarity to the ladder shows this to be a problem Wittgenstein inherited rather than acquired - an observation that reads as scholarship rather than as evasion.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The therapeutic conception reclassifies philosophical difficulty as disorientation rather than ignorance, and it accordingly replaces explanation with a grammatical description whose test of success is the removal of a compulsion rather than the establishment of a further truth. **Named evidence.** Section 38 locates the origin - philosophical problems arise when language goes on holiday, *wenn die Sprache feiert*, an image of machinery idling rather than of recreation - and Section 350-351 exhibit the phenomenon in "It is 5 o'clock on the sun", a sentence with an impeccable surface and no specified game. Section 115 names the mechanism: a picture held us captive, and we could not get outside it, for it lay in our language and language seemed to repeat it to us inexorably. Section 123 reclassifies the difficulty as "I don't know my way about"; Section 122 supplies the positive method of a perspicuous representation producing the understanding that consists in seeing connections, with intermediate cases found and invented for the purpose; Section 127 describes the philosopher's work as assembling reminders; and Section 255 and Section 309 state the analogy and its governing image, the treatment of an illness and the showing of the fly the way out of the fly-bottle. **Analysis.** The reclassification explains why further information does not help: someone lost in a familiar town needs an arrangement of what he already knows, not additional facts, which is why Section 129 says that the aspects most important for us are hidden by their simplicity and familiarity. It also explains the method's characteristic operations - inventing comparison cases, asking how a word was taught, asking what would count as a mistake - and why Section 128 holds that a philosophical thesis could never be debated, since anything genuinely established by such description would command immediate assent.

Qualification. The quietism charge rests on Section 124, and the remark's own first clause bounds it: what philosophy may not interfere with is the actual use of language, not social arrangements, so therapy removes confusion without forbidding reform - although it must be conceded that the range of what philosophy may legitimately do is thereby narrowed very severely. The self-application charge is stronger: the claim that philosophical problems are grammatical confusions is itself general, and although Section 133's talk of methods in the plural, like different therapies, mitigates it, the structural parallel with the *Tractatus* ladder shows this to be a difficulty Wittgenstein inherited rather than solved. The most serious methodological complaint remains that persistent problems can always be redescribed as pictures not yet fully exhibited, which makes the method unfalsifiable as stated.

Exam link

- **2023 Q4(c)** (15 marks): the therapeutic conception is the **destination** of the shift, and naming it converts a list of reasons into a direction of travel.
- **2025 Q3(a)** (20 marks): the verdict paragraph - the transition is from a **theoretical** to a **therapeutic** conception of philosophy, with quietism as the cost.
- **2020 Q4(c), 2024 Q1(d)**: the private-language argument is itself grammatical therapy; Section 350-351's model of "not false, no game specified" is the verdict form used on "S".
- **2022 Q1(c)** (10 marks): Section 124 explains why describing forms of life is not endorsing them.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"'Language goes on holiday' means language is being used casually"	<i>feiert</i> = idles ; an engine running without load
"'Leaves everything as it is' means political conservatism"	Section 124's first clause limits it to the use of language
"Wittgenstein has a method"	Section 133: methods , plural, "like different therapies"
"Therapy means philosophy should stop"	Section 122, 127: perspicuous representation, assembled reminders, invented intermediate cases
"The fly-bottle shows philosophy is trivial"	The image is about a self-sustaining move , not about triviality
Ignoring the self-application objection	It is the strongest objection and links early to late - raise it yourself

Revision notes

- **Section 38** "*philosophical problems arise when language goes on holiday*" - *wenn die Sprache feiert*, i.e. **idles**.
- **Section 109** philosophy is "*a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language*"; description replaces explanation.
- **Section 115** "*a picture held us captive*" - the captor is a **picture**, and it lies **in our language**.
- **Section 122** **perspicuous representation** -> "*seeing connections*"; find and invent **intermediate cases**.
- **Section 123** "*I don't know my way about*" - **disorientation**, not ignorance.
- **Section 124** "*philosophy... may in no way interfere with the actual use of language... It leaves everything as it is.*"
- **Section 127** assembling **reminders**; **Section 128** theses would be undebatable; **Section 129** hidden by **simplicity and familiarity**.
- **Section 133** "*not a philosophical method, though there are indeed methods, like different therapies*"; the real discovery makes it possible to **stop**.
- **Section 255** treatment of an illness; **Section 309** show the fly the way out of the **fly-bottle**.
- Three objections: **quietism** (bounded, but the discipline is narrowed), **self-application** (real force, mitigated by Section 133's plural, inherited from 6.54), **persistent problems** (the reply is **unfalsifiable as stated**).

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PHILOSOPHY AS THERAPY

WORD AT WORK IN A GAME

|
+--> TAKEN OUT OF THE GAME (38): surface grammar survives, USE does not
| 'wenn die Sprache feiert' = language IDLES, engine without load
| demonstration: 'It is 5 o'clock on the sun' (350-351)
|
+--> A PICTURE FILLS THE GAP (115): held CAPTIVE; it lies IN OUR LANGUAGE
|
+--> THE DIFFICULTY IS DISORIENTATION (123): 'I don't know my way about'
|
v

TREATMENT (122, 127, 128, 129, 133, 255, 309)
assemble REMINDERS · find and invent INTERMEDIATE CASES · produce a
PERSPICUOUS REPRESENTATION -> 'SEEING CONNECTIONS' · no THESES ·
the important is hidden by SIMPLICITY AND FAMILIARITY · METHODS, LIKE
DIFFERENT THERAPIES · treatment of an ILLNESS · show the fly the way out
of the FLY-BOTTLE
|
v

TEST OF SUCCESS (133): being able to STOP doing philosophy when one wants

|

v

OBJECTIONS

QUIETISM (124) -> bounded by its own first clause: the USE OF
LANGUAGE. RESIDUE: the discipline is narrowed hard
SELF-APPLICATION -> mitigated by 133's PLURAL; structurally the same
as the Tractatus ladder (6.54) - EARLY/LATE LINK
PERSISTENT PROBLEMS -> reply available but UNFALSIFIABLE AS STATED
|
v

ANSWER LINE: the philosopher is not ignorant but lost, and what he needs is
a map of a town he already knows

SESSION 12 - BOUNDED ENRICHMENT: ASPECT-SEEING, THE DUCK-RABBIT, AND HINGE CERTAINTY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Two topics sit just outside the printed clause and are constantly imported into answers by candidates who do not know they are outside it. The first is *seeing-as*: the duck-rabbit figure that changes without changing. The second is the certainty of *On Certainty*: the propositions we never check because checking is done by means of them. Both illuminate the owned material. Neither is a limb of the syllabus, and both must therefore be used in the exam as **one or two sentences**, never as a paragraph.

Technical definition: **Aspect-seeing** - the **dawning of an aspect** (**das Aufleuchten eines Aspekts**) - is the phenomenon in which a figure is seen as one thing and then as another while nothing in the object or the retinal image changes; Wittgenstein's formula is "*I see that it has not changed; and yet I see it differently.*" It is treated in the material formerly printed as *Investigations* Part II Section xi and now, in the fourth edition of 2009 revised by Hacker and Schulte, as **Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment (PPF)**, where the sections are renumbered. **Hinge certainty** is the doctrine of **On Certainty** (*notes written 1949-51, published 1969*) that some propositions - "I have two hands", "the earth existed long before my birth"* - function not as things we know on evidence but as the **hinges** on which enquiry turns.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Seeing-as is the clearest evidence that concepts are not applied *after* perception but are already present in what we see, and it is therefore the best single illustration of the later Wittgenstein's method - provided it is used as an illustration, since the printed clause does not own it.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- the dawning of an aspect (**das Aufleuchten eines Aspekts**) - the technical term
- "*I see that it has not changed; and yet I see it differently*" - the formula, quoted
- **aspect-blindness** - the imagined limiting case, which carries the argument

- **Jastrow, 1899** - the figure's actual author
- **PPF / Part II Section xi** - the citation form, with the renumbering caution
- **hinge propositions (On Certainty, 1969)** - named, dated, and marked as enrichment

How to use them: signpost the boundary explicitly - *"strictly, this belongs to the material printed as Part II / PPF rather than to the three printed limbs, but it illuminates the account of meaning as follows"* - because that sentence converts what looks like drift into demonstrated scope-awareness; and always attribute the **figure** to **Jastrow**.

Plain-language visual - the change that is neither in the object nor in a judgement

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THE DUCK-RABBIT (figure: JASTROW, 1899; reproduced by Wittgenstein)
=====
BEFORE                                AFTER
I see a duck                          I see a rabbit
-----
WHAT CHANGED IN THE DRAWING?          NOTHING. Same ink, same lines.
WHAT CHANGED ON MY RETINA?            NOTHING measurable.
DID I INFER the rabbit?               NO. The change is immediate and
                                       visual, not a conclusion.
DID I MERELY REINTERPRET?             NO. 'I see it differently' is
                                       reported as a VISUAL fact.
=====
SO WHAT KIND OF THING IS IT?
Wittgenstein: 'the dawning of an aspect' (das Aufleuchten eines
Aspekts). Neither pure perception nor pure judgement - the seeing is
'half visual experience, half thought'.
=====
THE CONDITION THAT MAKES THE ARGUMENT WORK
To see the RABBIT-aspect one must be FAMILIAR WITH THE SHAPE OF A
RABBIT. Aspect-perception PRESUPPOSES MASTERY OF A TECHNIQUE.
-> Concepts are not applied AFTER perception. They are already at
work in what is seen.
=====
THE LIMITING CASE: ASPECT-BLINDNESS
Imagine someone with full visual acuity who can identify both figures
on request but is INCAPABLE OF THE DAWNING. He is not blind, and not
stupid. What he lacks is the EXPERIENCE OF MEANING - hearing a word
'in a particular sense', feeling that a word 'fits'.
-> This is why aspect-seeing illuminates MEANING and not merely
perception.
=====

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In simple words: you can hear the word "bank" and mean the river; a moment later hear the same sound and mean the building. Nothing acoustic changed. The duck-rabbit is that experience made visible, which is why Wittgenstein uses it to talk about meaning rather than about optics.

Remember first	Meaning
The figure is Jastrow's (1899)	Wittgenstein reproduces it; never attribute the drawing to him
Citation is Part II Section xi / PPF	the 2009 edition renamed and renumbered Part II
It is not a printed limb	no routed PYQ owns it; budget one or two sentences
The key is aspect-blindness	the imagined deficit shows the tie to the experience of meaning
<i>On Certainty</i> is 1949-51 / 1969	unrevised notes; the last entries days before his death

One-line memory: the drawing does not change and the seeing does - which is only possible if the concept was in the seeing all along.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the numbered argument, what it damages, and the fence around it

THE ARGUMENT, NUMBERED

- 1 Nothing in the drawing alters - lines, ink and retinal image are identical before and after.
- 2 Yet something genuinely changes: I now see a RABBIT where I saw a DUCK. Wittgenstein calls this the DAWNING OF AN ASPECT.
- 3 So the change is neither in the OBJECT (nothing physical altered) nor merely in my INTERPRETATION (I do not INFER the rabbit; the change is immediate and visual).
- 4 Therefore 'seeing-as' is a THIRD category, neither pure perception nor pure judgement: 'half visual experience, half thought'.
- 5 Therefore concepts are not applied AFTER perception: the ability to see the aspect PRESUPPOSES MASTERY OF A TECHNIQUE - one must know the shape of a rabbit to see the rabbit-aspect at all.
- 6 ASPECT-BLINDNESS: we can conceive someone with full acuity who identifies both figures on request yet never experiences the dawning. His relation to MEANING would be impoverished in the same way - which is why aspect-seeing illuminates the EXPERIENCE OF MEANING.

WHAT IT PRESSURES - AND HOW HARD

TARGET	DAMAGE DONE - STATED AT ITS TRUE STRENGTH
Sense-data / the GIVEN	PRESSURES the claim that all seeing is conceptually innocent. It does NOT by itself refute every acquaintance theory.
The PICTURE THEORY	The role of a picture depends on practices of USE, which presses the early claim that picturing structure alone explains representation.
MEANING AS AN INNER PROCESS	The dawning FEELS like an inner event, yet its criteria are what one does and says next. 580 applies here as elsewhere.
PHILOSOPHY'S OWN METHOD	A therapeutic comparison can make a familiar use appear under a NEW ASPECT without adding any empirical discovery. An illuminating ANALOGY - not a stated identity of doctrines.

ON CERTAINTY - THE SECOND ENRICHMENT, FENCED THE SAME WAY

TEXT	notes written 1949-51; published 1969; UNREVISED; the last entries date from days before Wittgenstein's death
TARGET	G. E. Moore's 'Here is one hand' and 'A Defence of Common Sense' [TOPIC 06]
DOCTRINE	Some propositions function as HINGES: 'I have two hands', 'the earth existed long before my birth'. They are not known on evidence; they stand fast and make doubting and checking possible. 'The questions that we raise and our doubts depend on the fact that some propositions are exempt from doubt, are as it were like hinges on which those turn.'
RELATION	Continuous with FORMS OF LIFE: what stands fast belongs to the inherited background against which we distinguish true from false. But it is a DIFFERENT TEXT with a DIFFERENT TARGET, and no routed 2018-2025 part in this clause requires it.
USE	one comparative sentence, at most, and only where certainty, bedrock or the limits of justification are already in play

THE FENCE - WRITE IT, DO NOT JUST OBSERVE IT

'Aspect-seeing and hinge certainty are not printed limbs of this clause; they are used here only to illuminate the account of meaning and the limits of justification.'

One sentence of this kind protects an answer that would otherwise look as though it had drifted.

ANALYSIS: Caption. This session exists to make two things possible at once: to have the enrichment available for a twenty-mark answer, and to have the boundary statement ready so that using it costs nothing.

1. Aspect-seeing: the phenomenon and its correct citation FACT:

FACT: The discussion belongs to the material formerly printed as *Investigations Part II Section xi*, renamed in the fourth edition (2009, revised by **Hacker and Schulte**) as **Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment and renumbered**. **ANALYSIS:** Cite it as "Part II Section xi / PPF" rather than by a bare section number, since a number that is correct in one edition is wrong in another. **ANALYSIS:** The **duck-rabbit figure is Jastrow's**, published in 1899; Wittgenstein reproduces it, and attributing the drawing to him is a factual error an examiner can check.

FACT: The governing formula is: "*I see that it has not changed; and yet I see it differently.*" Wittgenstein distinguishes **continuous seeing** of an aspect from the **dawning** of an aspect, and observes that the dawning is reported in the same breath as a perception and as a thought - the expression of a perception, yet also "*half visual experience, half thought*".

2. Why the phenomenon matters for meaning ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: Step 5 of the numbered argument is where the philosophical work is done: one must already be **familiar with the shape of a rabbit** to see the rabbit-aspect. Aspect-perception therefore presupposes **mastery of a technique** - exactly the notion Session 2 used to redescribe understanding. The consequence is that concepts are not a coat of paint applied to a neutral perceptual given; they are already operative in what is seen.

ANALYSIS: **Aspect-blindness** is what turns this from an observation into an argument. Imagine a person of normal acuity who can, on request, identify the duck and the rabbit but never experiences the dawning. He is not visually defective and not conceptually incapable; what he lacks is something Wittgenstein connects to the **experience of meaning** - hearing a word "in a particular sense", feeling that a word "fits", experiencing the meaning of a word as one says it. ANALYSIS: That connection is the reason aspect-seeing belongs in a *philosophy of language* discussion at all, and it is the sentence to write if the topic is used.

3. The four things it pressures, at their true strength ANALYSIS:

The table in the diagram states them. Two require emphasis:

ANALYSIS: **Against the Given.** Aspect-seeing pressures the empiricist claim that perception delivers a conceptually innocent given upon which judgement then operates. WRONG: It does **not** by itself refute every acquaintance theory: a defender may say the aspect-change is a change in the *organisation* of a given that remains innocent. State the pressure, not a knock-down.

ANALYSIS: **Against meaning as an inner process.** The dawning *feels* like a pure inner event - which is precisely why it is a good test case. Wittgenstein's treatment applies Section 580: what shows that an aspect has dawned is what the person **does and says next** - the exclamation, the redescription, the new way of tracing the figure. The inner feel is real and is not the criterion.

4. On Certainty: what it is, and why it stays outside FACT:ANALYSIS:

FACT: **On Certainty*** consists of notes written between **1949 and 1951** and published in **1969**. ANALYSIS: They are **unrevised**, they were not prepared for publication, and the final entries date from days before Wittgenstein's death - so they should be cited as notes, and no settled doctrine should be attributed to them without that qualification.

FACT: The occasion is **G. E. Moore's** "Here is one hand" and *A Defence of Common Sense* - material owned by **Topic 06**. Wittgenstein's response is that Moore's propositions are neither known in the ordinary way nor doubtable in the ordinary way: they function as **hinges**, propositions that stand fast and thereby make doubting, testing and knowing possible. "*The questions that we raise and our doubts depend on the fact that some propositions are exempt from doubt, are as it were like hinges on which those turn.*"

ANALYSIS: **Why it stays outside the fence.** Three reasons, and giving them is itself a boundary mark: the text is a **different work** with a **different target** (Moore, not the referential model of meaning); **no routed 2018-2025 part** in this clause requires it; and its natural exam home is either Topic 06's Moore parts or, in Paper II, discussions of certainty and belief. ANALYSIS: Its legitimate use here is a **single comparative sentence** connecting hinge certainty to the form-of-life background of Section 241-242 and the bedrock of Section 217 - a connection that is genuine, since both mark where justification stops, but which must be presented as a comparison rather than as a doctrine of this clause.

5. How to use enrichment without losing marks ANALYSIS:

Situation	Correct budget	The sentence to write
10-mark part (2018, 2022, 2024)	Zero. Do not use it	-
15-mark part (2019, 2020, 2023)	One sentence, only if it earns its place	<i>"The dependence of what we see on techniques we have mastered - the duck-rabbit's dawning aspect in the material printed as Part II / PPF - shows how far the later account displaces meaning from inner objects to trained practice."</i>
20-mark part (2025)	Two sentences maximum, in the assessment	<i>"Beyond the printed limbs, the treatment of aspect-seeing and the hinge certainty of the posthumous On Certainty (notes of 1949-51, published 1969) show the same movement extended to perception and to the limits of justification, though neither is required for the transition itself."</i>
Any part where certainty or bedrock is already being discussed	One comparative clause	<i>"...a thought later developed in On Certainty's image of hinge propositions."</i>

ANALYSIS: WRONG: **What loses marks:** a paragraph on the duck-rabbit in a private-language answer; attributing the figure to Wittgenstein; citing "PI Part II Section xi" as though numbering were stable; and treating *On Certainty* as though it stated the doctrine of forms of life.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Aspect-seeing illuminates the later account of meaning by showing that concepts are not applied to a perceptual given after the fact but are already operative in what is seen, and it does so without being one of the clause's printed limbs. **Named evidence.** In the material formerly printed as *Investigations* Part II Section xi, and renamed *Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment* with renumbered sections in the fourth edition of 2009 revised by Hacker and Schulte, Wittgenstein reproduces Jastrow's duck-rabbit figure of 1899 and records the formula "I see that it has not changed; and yet I see it differently", calling the change the dawning of an aspect and describing the experience as half visual experience, half thought. He observes that one must be familiar with the shape of a rabbit in order to see the rabbit-aspect, and he imagines aspect-blindness - a person of normal acuity who identifies both figures on request yet never experiences the dawning - connecting that deficit to an impoverished relation to the experience of meaning. **Analysis.** The argument's force lies in the exclusion of both easy answers: the change is not in the object, since nothing physical alters, and it is not merely an interpretation, since it is reported as immediate and visual rather than as a conclusion. What remains is a third category in which mastery of a technique is a condition of the perception itself, which is the same relation between concept and capacity that Section 199 asserted for understanding a language and Section 580 for psychological concepts generally. **Qualification.** The pressure must be stated at its true strength: aspect-seeing embarrasses the claim that perception delivers a conceptually innocent given, but it does not by itself refute every acquaintance theory, since a defender may treat the change as one of organisation within a given that remains innocent. And the boundary must be stated explicitly, because no routed question in the 2018-2025 corpus owns this material or the hinge certainty of *On Certainty*, whose unrevised notes of 1949-51 were published in 1969 and answer Moore rather than the referential model of meaning; both are legitimate as one or two illustrative sentences and illegitimate as a paragraph.

Exam link

- **2025 Q3(a)** (20 marks): two sentences maximum, in the assessment, showing the movement extended beyond the printed limbs.
- **2023 Q4(c)** (15 marks): one sentence, if it earns its place - the displacement of meaning from inner objects to trained practice.
- **2020 Q4(c)** (15 marks): at most one clause connecting the dawning's felt quality to Section 580, since the temptation here is to over-use it.

- **2018 Q1(c), 2022 Q1(c), 2024 Q1(d)** (10 marks each): **do not use it**. Ten marks does not have room.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Wittgenstein drew the duck-rabbit"	The figure is Jastrow's , 1899; Wittgenstein reproduces it
Citing "PI Part II Section xi" as a stable reference	The 2009 fourth edition renamed it PPF and renumbered it; cite both forms
Treating aspect-seeing as a syllabus limb	It is enrichment ; no routed part owns it
"Aspect-seeing refutes sense-data"	It pressures the innocent given; it is not a refutation
Using <i>On Certainty</i> as the doctrine of forms of life	Different text, different target (Moore), unrevised notes
Writing a duck-rabbit paragraph in a 10-mark answer	Budget: zero at ten marks

Revision notes

- **Citation:** Part II Section xi / **PPF**; 4th edn **2009**, revised by **Hacker and Schulte**, renamed and **renumbered**.
- **Figure:** **Jastrow**, 1899. **Formula:** *"I see that it has not changed; and yet I see it differently."*
- **Term:** the **dawning of an aspect** (**das Aufleuchten eines Aspekts**); *"half visual experience, half thought"*.
- **Condition:** seeing the rabbit-aspect presupposes **familiarity with the shape of a rabbit** -> mastery of a technique.
- **Aspect-blindness:** full acuity, correct identification, no dawning -> an impoverished relation to the **experience of meaning**.
- **Pressures:** the Given (pressure, not refutation) · the picture theory · meaning as inner process (Section 580) · illuminates therapy by analogy.
- **On Certainty*:** notes **1949-51**, published **1969**, unrevised; answers **Moore**; **hinge** propositions stand fast and make doubt possible; connect to Section 241-242 and Section 217 **as a comparison**.
- **Budget:** 10 marks = none; 15 marks = one sentence; 20 marks = two sentences.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - BOUNDED ENRICHMENT

DUCK-RABBIT (figure: JASTROW 1899; text: Part II xi / PPF, renumbered 2009)

|

+--> 'I see that it has not changed; AND YET I SEE IT DIFFERENTLY'

|

+--> not in the OBJECT (nothing altered) · not mere INTERPRETATION
(immediate, visual, not inferred)

|

v

THIRD CATEGORY: the DAWNING OF AN ASPECT - 'half visual experience, half thought'

|

+--> CONDITION: must know the shape of a rabbit -> MASTERY OF A TECHNIQUE

+--> LIMIT CASE: ASPECT-BLINDNESS -> impoverished EXPERIENCE OF MEANING

|

v

PRESSURES: the Given (pressure, NOT refutation) · picture theory · meaning as inner process (580 applies) · analogy for therapeutic reorientation

|

v

ON CERTAINTY (notes 1949-51, published 1969, UNREVISED; target: MOORE)

HINGE propositions stand fast and make doubting possible

-> compare with 241-242 agreement in judgments and 217 bedrock

-> DIFFERENT TEXT, DIFFERENT TARGET, NO ROUTED PART REQUIRES IT

|

v

BUDGET: 10 marks NONE · 15 marks ONE SENTENCE · 20 marks TWO SENTENCES and always write the fence sentence

|

v

ANSWER LINE: the drawing does not change and the seeing does - which is only possible if the concept was in the seeing all along

SESSION 13 - COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS, THE CRITICISM LEDGER, AND ANSWER CRAFT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: This session does three jobs at once. It places the later Wittgenstein against the positions he is most often confused with, so that a comparison question can be answered without a scramble. It ranks the objections to him, so that a "critically discuss" instruction has a structure to follow. And it sets out how the seven routed questions are actually built, so that the practice section is entered with a plan rather than with material.

Technical definition: A **synthesis session**: it consolidates the doctrine of Sessions 1-12 into (i) an **inter-thinker comparison grid** covering early Wittgenstein, logical positivism, Cartesian and empiricist inner-foundationalism, and the ordinary-language successors; (ii) a **ranked criticism ledger** with each objection's best reply and its residue; (iii) a **directive decoder** matching UPSC command words to structural obligations; (iv) a **graded verdict bank** supplying closing positions at 10, 15 and 20 marks; and (v) the **provenance and translation discipline** that governs every citation in this clause.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The later Wittgenstein is best assessed by what he refuses to do: he will not give a criterion, will not build a theory, and will not legislate over ordinary use - and the honest question is whether that triple refusal is a discipline that dissolves confusion or a restriction that leaves genuine problems standing.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **no criterion, no theory, no legislation** - the triple refusal, in six words
- **grammatical dependence, not equivalence** - the anti-behaviourist formula
- **dissolution, not refutation** - the verdict-word for solipsism and for metaphysics alike
- **normativity without an essence** - what the account claims to deliver
- **provenance discipline** - posthumous texts, renderings, editions
- **quietism / self-application** - the two standing objections, named

How to use them: every fifteen- and twenty-mark answer should end with a **defended ruling**, and the graded verdict bank in Section 4 exists to supply it; do not report the debate and stop, since "critically discuss" and "do you agree" both require a side.

Plain-language visual - five positions on one question

QUESTION: WHAT MAKES A SIGN MEANINGFUL?

EARLY WITTGENSTEIN (Tractatus 1921/22) It depicts a possible state of affairs through a shared LOGICAL FORM. One general propositional form. Metaphysics: SHOW what cannot be said, then be silent. [TOPIC 06]

LOGICAL POSITIVISM (Vienna Circle, 1929-) It is ANALYTIC or EMPIRICALLY VERIFIABLE. ONE CRITERION of cognitive significance. Metaphysics: REJECT as pseudo-statement. [TOPIC 07]

DESCARTES / CLASSICAL EMPIRICISM Meaning traces to IDEAS or IMPRESSIONS, many of them PRIVATE and immediately given. The inner is the foundation of the outer. [TOPICS 02, 03]

LATER WITTGENSTEIN (Investigations 1953) It has a USE in a language-game embedded in a form of life. NO single essence, NO single criterion. Metaphysics: DISSOLVE as language idling. [THIS CLAUSE]

ORDINARY LANGUAGE SUCCESSORS Ryle on category-mistakes; Austin on speech acts and performatives; Strawson on descriptive metaphysics. Related in spirit, SEPARATE OWNERS. [TOPIC 11 and beyond]

THE THREE CONFUSIONS THIS GRID EXISTS TO PREVENT

- X 'Later Wittgenstein is a positivist' - he rejects ONE CRITERION as firmly as he rejects ONE ESSENCE; the Circle's mistake is the Tractatus's mistake in a new vocabulary
- X 'He is a behaviourist' - criteria are DEFEASIBLE, not definitions
- X 'He is a relativist' - agreement in JUDGMENTS is what makes disagreement possible, not what makes claims true

In simple words: four of these five positions are looking for the one thing that makes signs work - a form, a criterion, an idea. The later Wittgenstein is the only one who says the search itself was the mistake. That is what makes him hard to place, and it is why he is so often mis-assimilated to whichever of the others a candidate happens to know best.

Remember first	Meaning
Positivism is a rival , not an ally	one criterion is exactly what he refuses
Early Wittgenstein is a target , not a stage	the same man, but the doctrine is Topic 06's
Ryle, Austin, Strawson are cousins	related method, separate ownership
The refusal is triple	no criterion, no theory, no legislation
The claim is normativity without essence	which is what every objection tests

One-line memory: everyone else was hunting the hidden thing; he was explaining why the hunt felt compulsory.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the comparison grid, the ranked criticism ledger, and the directive decoder

PART A - THE COMPARISON GRID

AXIS	LATER W.	EARLY W.	POSITIVISM	DESCARTES / EMPIRICISM
MEANING	use in practices; 43 hedged	depiction via logical form	analytic or verifiable	ideas or impressions
ESSENCE OF LANGUAGE	NONE - family resemblance	ONE logical form	ONE criterion	naming inner/outer objects
METAPHYSICS	DISSOLVE as language	SHOW what cannot be said	REJECT as pseudo- statement	PURSUE as first philosophy
THE INNER	idling private ostension cannot ground standards; sensations remain	solipsism at the limit; 5.62 saying/ showing	not central	often foundational
PHILOSOPHY'S TASK	THERAPY - dissolve confusions	draw the limits of the sayable	ANALYSIS; eliminate pseudo- problems	build a system from foundations
NECESSITY	grammar; rules of representation	tautology; logical form	linguistic convention	innate / rational insight

PART B - THE CRITICISM LEDGER, RANKED BY FORCE

- 1 SELF-APPLICATION (strongest)

OBJECTION 'Philosophical problems are grammatical confusions' is itself a general philosophical thesis.

REPLY 133: METHODS, plural, like different therapies; no doctrine to be self-refuting; the remarks are ladder-like.

RESIDUE structurally identical to the Tractatus ladder (6.54). A problem INHERITED, not solved. -> first-class exam observation
- 2 THE NORMATIVITY OF USE

OBJECTION If meaning is use, what distinguishes CORRECT use from widespread MISUSE, or a new use from a mistake?

REPLY grammar, training and correction supply local standards; practice is normative, not merely regular.

RESIDUE dead metaphors, poetic extension and technical redefinition are genuinely hard cases. A real tension, not a misunderstanding.
- 3 KRIPKE AND THE SCEPTICAL SOLUTION 1982

OBJECTION 201 yields a sceptical paradox answered only by communal agreement.

REPLY 201 calls it a MISUNDERSTANDING and supplies a third part; Baker and Hacker, and McDowell, read it as dissolution.

RESIDUE Kripke himself says 'as it struck Kripke'; the reconstruction is philosophically valuable and exegetically doubtful.
- 4 QUIETISM / CONSERVATISM

OBJECTION 124 removes philosophy's critical function.

REPLY 124's first clause limits it to the USE OF LANGUAGE; therapy removes confusion and does not forbid reform.

RESIDUE the discipline is narrowed very severely; a cost accepted, not an objection answered.
- 5 BEHAVIOURISM

OBJECTION Public criteria make 'pain' mean pain-behaviour.

REPLY criteria are GRAMMATICAL and DEFEASIBLE; 304 'not a something, but not a nothing either'; 307 GRAMMATICAL fiction; 244 avowal.

RESIDUE 354's fluctuation means the firewall is secured case by case.
- 6 RELATIVISM

OBJECTION If grammar rests on forms of life, can practices criticise one another?

REPLY shared natural reactions and cross-practice comparison constrain relativism; 241 separates agreement from truth.

RESIDUE NO THEORY OF RATIONAL ADJUDICATION is supplied. This, not relativism, is the honest gap.

7 THE SOLITARY SPEAKER (CRUSOE)
OBJECTION A man alone could invent sensation-words.
REPLY logical privacy, not solitude, is the target; a solitary speaker may use public-TYPE criteria.
RESIDUE whether an ACTUAL community is required is disputed [optional block]

8 CIRCULARITY OF PRACTICE
OBJECTION Practice explains correctness only by invoking what practitioners COUNT AS correct.
REPLY trained normative practice is distinguished from mere regularity by the possibility of MISTAKE.
RESIDUE whether community agreement can ground normativity without circularity remains contested.

PART C - THE DIRECTIVE DECODER

DIRECTIVE	STRUCTURAL OBLIGATION	FATAL ERROR
'Discuss meaning as use'	Show the contrast it REPLACES, then the positive account: Augustinian picture (1) -> use -> family resemblance -> forms of life; worked example: the builders' 'Slab!'	'Wittgenstein said meaning is use' plus a paraphrase
'Critically examine the private-language argument' (2024, 2020)	Reconstruct the FIVE-STEP core, then the criteria/symptoms defence (304-308), then Kripke vs Hacker, then rule	'Retelling the beetle and the diary with no argument-structure
'Elucidate a numbered remark' (quotation-led)	Give the section, then the doctrine, then the WORK it does; say what it does NOT claim (580's table)	Paraphrasing the sentence
'How does Wittgenstein criticise solipsism?' (2019)	Connect the EARLY limit issue to LATER grammar without claiming a proof of other minds; verdict: qualified DISSOLUTION	'Language is public, therefore other minds exist'
'Compare early and later' (2025, 2023)	Name the SPECIFIC changes and their pressures; do not call colour exclusion a one-step refutation	'He changed his mind about language'
'Establish the tenability of...' (2022)	Say what would make it UNTENABLE, show it does not follow, concede what remains open	Describing forms of life without defending them
'Assess family resemblance' (2018)	Show what it DENIES (essences) and what it PERMITS (extensible concepts); then the unlimited-resemblance objection and the practice reply	Listing games
'Comment' / 'Do you agree?'	A DEFENDED RULING in line 1	Reporting the debate

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Parts B and C are the two things a candidate should be able to reproduce under time pressure. Part B supplies the "critically" content for any question; Part C converts the printed directive into a structure before a single sentence of content is written.

1. The comparison grid, worked ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: **Against early Wittgenstein.** The change is set out in Session 1 and should be stated as *the withdrawal of a demand*, not as a change of subject-matter. ANALYSIS: The single most useful comparative sentence available: *both books hold that philosophy is clarification and that confusion arises from misreading language; they differ over whether clarification requires exhibiting one hidden essence.*

ANALYSIS: **Against logical positivism.** This comparison is tested indirectly (the Circle read the *Tractatus* aloud, and Wittgenstein's 1929-32 conversations with Schlick and Waismann contain verificationist formulations) and it is routinely mishandled. Three discriminations:

1. The positivists impose **one criterion** of cognitive significance. The later Wittgenstein's objection to the *Tractatus* - that one essence was mistaken for many uses - applies to **any** single criterion, including verifiability.
2. The positivists **reject** metaphysical sentences as pseudo-statements; the later Wittgenstein **dissolves** metaphysical puzzles by showing where the words came from. Rejection is a verdict; dissolution is a treatment.
3. The positivists treat **fact-stating** as the paradigm of language; Section 23 lists describing as one item among many. ANALYSIS: Naming any one of these three earns the boundary mark in a comparison question.

ANALYSIS: **Against Cartesian and empiricist inner-foundationalism.** The private-language argument is directed at exactly the assumption both share: that the inner is epistemically and semantically prior to the outer. Section 580 inverts the priority for **concepts** without denying the inner life.

ANALYSIS: **Against ordinary-language successors.** Ryle's category-mistakes, Austin's performatives and speech acts, and Strawson's descriptive metaphysics are methodologically related and separately owned. Name the relation in a clause; do not expound them.

2. The criticism ledger, and how to use it ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: The ledger is **ranked**, and the ranking is itself examinable judgement. A candidate who deploys the objections in the order given - self-application, normativity, Kripke, quietism, behaviourism, relativism, Crusoe, circularity - has demonstrated that he can tell a structural objection from a local one.

ANALYSIS: **The rule for a fifteen-mark answer:** one objection, its reply and its residue. **For twenty marks:** two, and preferably one from the top of the list and one specific to the question's subject-matter.

ANALYSIS: **What never earns marks:** listing five objections without replies; or supplying replies without residues, which reads as advocacy rather than assessment.

3. Provenance and translation discipline ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: This clause is unusually rich in provenance marks, and each is a cheap sentence:

Item	Status	Practice
<i>Philosophical Investigations</i>	composed 1936-49; published posthumously 1953 ; edited Anscombe and Rhees ; German-English facing pages	WRONG: Never "Wittgenstein published the <i>Investigations</i> ". The arrangement of remarks is partly editorial
Translations	Anscombe 1953; revised Hacker and Schulte , 4th edn 2009	The 4th edition renames Part II as <i>Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment</i> and renumbers it. Cite "Part II Section xi / PPF"
Citation by Section	Part I remarks are Section 1-Section 693 ; numbering identical across editions	FACT: Always cite by Section rather than by page
"Meaning is use" (Section 43)	hedged: " <i>for a large class of cases - though not for all</i> "	WRONG: Never quote without the hedge
"Language goes on holiday" (Section 38)	German <i>wenn die Sprache feiert</i> - closer to idles	Give the Section and gloss the image
Fly-bottle (Section 309)	stable across editions	FACT: Safe verbatim
Beetle (Section 293)	stable	FACT: Safe with Section 293
Diary "S" (Section 258)	renderings of "whatever is going to seem right to me is right" vary slightly	Give Section 258; paraphrase if unsure
<i>Blue and Brown Books</i>	dictated 1933-35 , published 1958	Say "in the <i>Blue Book</i> ", not "Wittgenstein wrote"
<i>On Certainty</i>	notes 1949-51 , published 1969 , unrevised	Mark as notes; it is his last work

Item	Status	Practice
Kripke	<i>Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language</i> , 1982	Say " Kripke's Wittgenstein " / "Kripkenstein"
"Forms of life"	occurs a handful of times (Section 19, Section 23, Section 241, PPF)	Mark large doctrinal constructions as interpretation
Duck-rabbit	figure is Jastrow's , 1899	Never attribute the drawing to Wittgenstein
2022 printed "motion"	the official English line prints " motion "	Retain the printed word; gloss in a clause
2025 unmatched quotation mark	the official line has an unmatched opening quotation before "logical structure"	Reproduce as printed; do not silently correct

WRONG: **Never write:** that Wittgenstein "denied the existence of inner mental states" (Section 304 refuses this explicitly); that the private-language argument is directed at codes or at talking to oneself; or that "meaning is use" is offered as a general definition (Section 43 says otherwise).

4. Graded verdict bank ANALYSIS:

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
The break from the <i>Tractatus</i>*	The later work revises the demand for one general form while retaining philosophy as clarificatory activity.	...Linguistic diversity, the insufficiency of ostension and colour incompatibility together pressure the early system; the <i>Tractatus</i> already regarded ordinary propositions as logically in order.	Continuity and discontinuity must both be argued: the early limits of factual saying become later grammatical therapy, and neither book may be reduced to a slogan. The deepest change is that determinacy is relocated from logical form to trained practice.
Meaning and use	For a large class of cases, meaning is clarified by an expression's role in practice rather than by a hidden referent.	...Use is not frequency, utility or verification; ostension and understanding alike depend on training and grammar, so the account is a redirection rather than a rival theory.	Normativity remains the pressure: practice distinguishes mistake from innovation, but the appeal to use cannot be allowed to become "whatever people do is correct", and Wittgenstein supplies no general criterion for the hard cases.
Family resemblance	It shows that a general term needs no single essence, which is why "language is a game" is a description rather than an evasion.	...The thread analogy answers the anxiety that a concept without a core must dissolve, and open texture is bounded by training and correction rather than by definition.	The unlimited-resemblance objection is real, and the reply - that practice selects the relevant similarities - is persuasive without being demonstrative; the doctrine is best read as removing a requirement, not as a theory of concepts.
Language-games / forms of life	Language comprises varied activities without one required essence, resting on shared practices.	...At bedrock trained action replaces further interpretation; Section 217 belongs to rule-following and should not be made a definition of form of life.	Naturalist and cultural readings differ; shared practice enables disagreement rather than entailing relativism, and the real gap is the absence of a theory of rational adjudication between practices.
Rule-following	No interpretation fixes its own application; trained practice displays a grasping of a rule that is not another interpretation.	...Practice is normative, not mere regularity or majority agreement, and Section 202 already forbids private rule-following.	Kripke's sceptical-community reading is influential and textually disputed; the recommendation is that it is philosophically valuable and exegetically doubtful, since a sceptical <i>solution</i> is the constructive theory Section 128 and 133 disavow.
Private language	Private ostension fails because correctness collapses into present seeming, so no rule and hence no meaning is created.	...The argument denies neither sensations nor solitary speakers; Section 270's manometer variant shows that whatever work the sign does is done by a public criterion.	It pressures Cartesian and empiricist linguistic foundations decisively while leaving open the memory objection, the status of an actual community, and whether criterial grammar respects inner phenomenology.
Criteria and symptoms	Criteria are grammatical and defeasible; symptoms are inductive. That single distinction blocks the behaviourist reading.	...It lets Wittgenstein say behaviour is constitutive of the <i>concept</i> of pain without being identical to pain, and preserves the first/third-person asymmetry the behaviourist must deny.	The distinction is what makes this a genuine third way - anti-Cartesian without reduction. Its instability is Section 354's admission that the grammar <i>fluctuates</i> , so the firewall is secured case by case; say whether that is candour about concepts or an admission that the key notion is not sharp.
Therapy / fly-bottle	Philosophy treats conceptual disorientation with reminders and perspicuous comparison rather than with new theory.	..."Leaves everything as it is" concerns grammar, not social conservatism, but the discipline is narrowed very severely.	Self-application is the standing difficulty, structurally inherited from the <i>Tractatus</i> ladder; Section 133's plural mitigates it, and the reply to persistent problems remains unfalsifiable as stated.

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
Solipsism	The critique is a dissolution: the thesis is self-undermining, not false.	...The route changes from the early saying/showing limit to the later grammar of criteria, which is what "culminates" asks you to show.	Nothing establishes other minds; Section 303 concerns where doubt has application. The strength of the result is exactly the strength of the private-language argument on which it depends.

5. The seven routed questions, with their spines ANALYSIS:

Year · Part · Marks	Demand in one line	The spine to write
2018 Q1(c) · 10	How does family resemblance <i>help</i> uphold "Language is a game"?	Challenge at Section 65 -> "Don't think, but look!" -> survey -> thread -> what it denies and permits -> games have rules without essence -> non-arbitrariness
2019 Q3(b) · 15	How does the critique of solipsism <i>culminate</i> in the critique of private language?	Dissolution not refutation -> <i>Tractatus</i> 5.6/5.62/5.64 -> change of route -> the dilemma (Section 258 / conceded practice) -> what is not proved
2020 Q4(c) · 15	Critically discuss Wittgenstein's answer to Section 243's own question	Reproduce the printed quotation -> Section 243's narrowing -> private ostension -> Section 258 -> Section 265 -> Section 270 -> memory and Crusoe objections -> verdict
2022 Q1(c) · 10	Establish the tenability of language as form of life	Note the printed "motion" -> Section 19, Section 23 -> Section 241/Section 242 with the measuring test -> naturalist/culturalist readings -> tenable as background, untenable as a theory of truth
2023 Q4(c) · 15	Main reasons for the shift from picture-theory to use-theory	Five commitments and five pressures -> Section 43 with its hedge -> language-games and forms of life -> therapy as destination -> continuity of clarification
2024 Q1(d) · 10	Why can there be no essentially private language?	Target paragraph (four non-targets) -> five-step core -> beetle in one sentence -> solitary-speaker qualification
2025 Q3(a) · 20	Explain the transition, with reference to the quoted statement	Reproduce the printed wording including the unmatched quotation mark -> what the <i>Tractatus</i> actually held -> the pressures -> the later account -> therapy -> verdict on quietism and normativity

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The later Wittgenstein's position is best assessed through his triple refusal - no single criterion of meaning, no explanatory theory, and no legislation over ordinary use - since each of the standing objections is an attempt to show that one of these refusals cannot be sustained. **Named evidence.** The refusal of a criterion is stated in Section 43's hedge and enforced by the family-resemblance survey of Section 66-67; the refusal of theory is stated at Section 109, where description takes the place of explanation, at Section 128, where theses would be undebatable, and at Section 133, where there are methods in the plural, like different therapies; the refusal of legislation is stated at Section 124, where philosophy may in no way interfere with the actual use of language. Against these, the self-application objection presses that the second refusal is itself a thesis; the normativity objection presses that the first leaves correct and incorrect use undistinguished; Kripke's 1982 reconstruction presses that only communal agreement can supply what interpretation cannot; and the quietism objection presses that the third refusal removes philosophy's critical function. **Analysis.** Ranking the objections is itself an act of judgement, and the ranking is defensible on a single principle: an objection is stronger the closer it comes to the method rather than to a doctrine. Self-application is therefore first, because it attacks the possibility of the whole enterprise; the normativity of use is second, because it attacks the positive account's ability to do the one job an account of meaning must do; behaviourism and relativism rank lower because each has a specific and textually grounded reply - defeasible criteria at Section 304 and 307-308, and the separation of agreement from truth at Section 241. **Qualification.** None of the replies is a closure. Section 354's admission that the grammar fluctuates between criteria and symptoms means the anti-behaviourist firewall is secured case by case rather than in advance; the absence of a theory of rational adjudication between practices is a genuine gap rather than a misreading; and the reply to persistent philosophical problems - that the captivating picture has not yet been fully exhibited - is unfalsifiable as stated. What can be defended is the narrower claim that the method dissolves a large and identifiable class of confusions, and that its cost is a severe narrowing of what philosophy may attempt.

Exam link

- **All seven routed parts:** Section 5's table gives each spine, and Section 4's verdict bank gives each closing position at the right mark value.
- **2025 Q3(a)** (20 marks) draws on this session most heavily, since a twenty-mark transition answer needs both a comparison and a ranked assessment.
- **2019 Q3(b)** and **2023 Q4(c)** (15 marks each) each need exactly one objection with its residue; take it from the top of Part B unless the question's own subject supplies a more specific one.

UPSC traps

Trap	Correction
"Later Wittgenstein = logical positivism"	He refuses one criterion as firmly as one essence ; positivism is a rival
Reporting objections without replies or residues	A "critically discuss" answer needs objection + reply + residue
Treating Ryle, Austin and Strawson as part of this clause	Related method, separate owners ; name in a clause
Silently correcting the 2022 "motion" or the 2025 quotation mark	Reproduce the printed wording, then gloss
Ending a 15- or 20-mark answer without a ruling	The verdict bank exists for exactly this
"He denied inner mental states"	Section 304 explicitly refuses that reading

Revision notes

- **Triple refusal:** no single **criterion**, no explanatory **theory**, no **legislation** over use.
- **Grid:** early Wittgenstein (depiction / logical form) · positivism (one criterion) · Descartes and empiricism (inner foundation) · later Wittgenstein (use, no essence) · Ryle, Austin, Strawson (cousins, separate owners).
- **Ledger, ranked:** self-application · normativity of use · Kripke · quietism · behaviourism · relativism · Crusoe · circularity of practice. Each with **reply** and **residue**.

- **Directive decoder:** "discuss use" = contrast then account · "critically examine private language" = five-step core then defence then ruling · "elucidate a remark" = Section , doctrine, work done · "solipsism" = dissolution without a proof of other minds · "compare" = specific changes and pressures · "establish tenability" = untenability test, refutation, concession · "assess family resemblance" = denies/permits + objection + reply.
- **Provenance:** posthumous 1953, Anscombe and Rhees · 4th edn 2009 Hacker and Schulte, Part II -> **PPF**, renumbered · Section 1-Section 693 stable · Section 43's hedge · *feiert* = idles · *Blue Book* dictated 1933-35, published 1958 · *On Certainty* 1949-51, published 1969 · Kripke 1982 = "Kripke's Wittgenstein" · duck-rabbit = **Jastrow 1899**.
- **Printed anomalies:** 2022 "motion"; 2025 unmatched opening quotation before "logical structure". Reproduce both.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SYNTHESIS

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THE TRIPLE REFUSAL: no single CRITERION | no explanatory THEORY | no
LEGISLATION over ordinary use          [43, 66-67 | 109, 128, 133 | 124]
|
+--> GRID: EARLY W. depiction/logical form | POSITIVISM one criterion |
|      DESCARTES & EMPIRICISM inner foundation | LATER W. use, no essence
|      | RYLE, AUSTIN, STRAWSON cousins with separate owners
|
v
LEDGER, RANKED BY FORCE (objection -> reply -> RESIDUE)
1 SELF-APPLICATION -> 133 methods, plural -> inherited from 6.54
2 NORMATIVITY OF USE -> grammar, training, correction -> hard cases remain
3 KRIPKE 1982 -> 201 says 'misunderstanding' -> valuable, doubtful
4 QUIETISM (124) -> bounded to the USE OF LANGUAGE -> discipline narrowed
5 BEHAVIOURISM -> DEFEASIBLE criteria, 304, 307-308, 244 -> 354 fluctuates
6 RELATIVISM -> 241 agreement != truth -> no adjudication theory
7 CRUSOE -> logical privacy, not solitude -> community disputed
8 CIRCULARITY -> mistake distinguishes practice from regularity ->
                  contested
|
v
DIRECTIVE DECODER -> structure BEFORE content
|
v
GRADED VERDICT BANK -> a DEFENDED RULING at 10 / 15 / 20 marks
|
v
PROVENANCE: posthumous 1953 (Anscombe, Rhees) | 2009 4th edn PPF renumbered |
43's hedge | feiert = idles | Blue Book 1933-35/1958 | On Certainty
1949-51/1969 | Kripke 1982 | Jastrow 1899 | 2022 'motion' | 2025 quotation
|
v
ANSWER LINE: everyone else was hunting the hidden thing; he was explaining
              why the hunt felt compulsory

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed **independently**, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated, and no cycle such as ABCD can be used to guess. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

Coverage: the twenty-four core questions run across the whole printed clause - *Meaning and Use*; *Language-games*; *Critique of Private Language* - together with the status of the Augustinian picture, the Section 43 hedge, what "use" excludes, understanding as mastery of a technique, the ambiguity of ostension and the prepared place, samples and the standard metre, family resemblance and the thread, the builders and objects of comparison, Section 23's list and its closing clause, surface and depth grammar, agreement in judgments, the lion remark, the three parts of Section 201, Section 202's ban on private rule-following, Kripke's provenance, Section 243's target, the diary and its manometer variant, the beetle's exact conclusion, criteria against symptoms, and Section 580 with the behaviourism reply. The eight remedial drills attack the confusions that cost marks every year: the posthumous status of the *Investigations*, the 2009 renumbering and Jastrow's figure, colour exclusion as a pressure rather than a refutation, the

boundary against logical positivism, dissolution against refutation in the treatment of solipsism, the solitary-speaker objection, the scope of "leaves everything as it is", and the ownership fence around Topics 06, 07, 11 and Paper II.

MCQ 1. The status of the Augustinian picture of language

In Section 1-4 of the *Investigations*, what verdict does Wittgenstein pass on the picture of language he draws from Augustine's *Confessions*?

- A. That it is straightforwardly false, since no word whatever acquires its meaning by being correlated with an object that speakers can indicate.
- B. That it fits one primitive language-game exactly, and is defective only as a claim about the essence of all language.
- C. That it is a correct account of how children learn language, though a poor account of how adults later come to use it.
- D. That it is unintelligible, because the notion of a word standing for an object cannot be given any coherent sense at all.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Wittgenstein grants that the picture works for "table" or "chair", and Section 2-4 construct a language for which it is exactly right.
- **B:** Correct: the builders' language of "block", "pillar", "slab" and "beam" is offered as a case the picture describes perfectly, which fixes its status as one game generalised into an essence.
- **C:** Incorrect: this makes the point developmental, whereas Section 28-32 attack the picture's adequacy at every stage, including adult ostensive teaching.
- **D:** Incorrect: unintelligibility is a verdict Wittgenstein reserves for sentences with no specified use, and naming plainly has a use in the games he describes.

Examiner trap 1: Writing "Wittgenstein refuted Augustine's theory of meaning" throws away the characteristic later move, which is to shrink an alleged essence into one case among many rather than to declare it false.

MCQ 2. What Section 43 actually states

Which one of the following reproduces the doctrinal content of Section 43 most accurately?

- A. The meaning of a word is its use in the language, a definition Wittgenstein offers as covering every occasion on which the word "meaning" is employed by any speaker.
- B. The meaning of a word is the object it stands for, except in those cases where no object can be found, which are handled by the notion of a language-game.
- C. The meaning of a word is fixed by the speaker's intention in using it, since intention is what selects one use of a word rather than another on a given occasion.
- D. For a large class of cases - though not for all - in which we employ the word "meaning", it can be defined thus: the meaning of a word is its use in the language.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it drops the scope limiter, and Section 40's separation of a name's bearer from its meaning shows the hedge is doctrine rather than politeness.
- **B:** Incorrect: this preserves the referential model as the default and demotes use to a residual category, reversing the order of Section 1-12.
- **C:** Incorrect: it reinstates a private mental determinant of meaning, which Section 258 goes on to dismantle at length.
- **D:** Correct: the remark is stated with its own limitation, and the limitation is what prevents "use" from becoming a second essence.

Examiner trap 2: Quoting the remark without "for a large class of cases - though not for all" is the commonest misquotation in this syllabus item, and it converts a careful observation into the slogan Wittgenstein spent Section 65-71 avoiding.

MCQ 3. What "use" does not mean

Consider the following glosses on Wittgenstein's term "use".

1. How frequently the word occurs in a population of speakers.
2. The norm-governed role the word has within a practice.
3. Whatever application the individual speaker finds convenient.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct as an account of Section 43's "use"?

- A. 2 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: use is a role with standards of correct and incorrect application, which is why a rare sentence is fully meaningful and a speaker can misuse a word.
- **B:** Incorrect: frequency is a statistical property of a population and has no bearing on whether a given application is correct.
- **C:** Incorrect: statement 3 makes the individual the sole judge, which is precisely the position Section 258 shows to be empty.
- **D:** Incorrect: it combines both errors, leaving "use" with neither normativity nor determinacy.

Examiner trap 3: Treating "use" as "usage" invites the objection that meaning is decided by majority behaviour, which recreates at population level the collapse of "right" into "seems right" that the private-language argument exploits.

MCQ 4. Understanding a word

On the account developed at Section 143-155 and stated at Section 199, in what does understanding a word consist?

- A. In a distinctive inner experience of comprehension that accompanies the word and is available to introspection whenever the word is grasped.
- B. In possessing a mental image of the object designated, which can then be compared with new cases in order to settle whether the word applies.
- C. In mastery of a technique, exhibited in going on correctly with the word in the appropriate circumstances of a shared practice.
- D. In having formulated to oneself a definition of the word in terms of necessary and sufficient conditions for its correct application.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Section 151-152 show the flash of comprehension can occur and be followed by failure, and that fluent understanding often involves no such episode at all.
- **B:** Incorrect: an image is another sign standing in need of application, so it postpones the question rather than answering it.
- **C:** Correct: Section 199 states that to understand a sentence is to understand a language, and to understand a language is to be master of a technique.
- **D:** Incorrect: Section 66-71 show that many concepts admit no such definition, yet are understood perfectly well by competent speakers.

Examiner trap 4: Identifying understanding with performance turns the account into behaviourism; the correct statement is that performance is the criterion, and criteria are defeasible in both directions.

MCQ 5. The ambiguity of ostensive definition

What does Wittgenstein establish at Section 28 by pointing at two nuts and saying "This is called 'two'"?

- A. That ostensive teaching never in fact succeeds, so children must acquire their first vocabulary by some entirely non-ostensive route.
- B. That the learner will always take the word to name the objects indicated rather than any of their properties, which is why naming feels basic.
- C. That the pointing is unnecessary, since the accompanying words already convey everything required for the learner to fix the term.
- D. That the gesture leaves the lesson undetermined, since "two" might be taken for a number, a colour, a shape, a material or a proper name.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Wittgenstein never denies that ostensive teaching works; he denies that the pointing is what makes it work.
- **B:** Incorrect: Section 28 lists exactly the range of readings the gesture permits, and the object-naming reading is only one of them.
- **C:** Incorrect: Section 29-30 show that adding "this number" merely borrows an understanding of "number" and restarts the same difficulty.
- **D:** Correct: the remark states that an ostensive definition can be variously interpreted in every case, which is the argument's premise.

Examiner trap 5: Reading Section 28 as scepticism about ostension inverts its purpose: it is an inventory of what ostension needs, not a denial that ostension teaches.

MCQ 6. The chess-king and the prepared place

At Section 31 Wittgenstein says that being shown a piece and told "This is the king" teaches the use of the piece only under a certain condition. What is that condition?

- A. That the learner already occupies the practice far enough to recognise that pieces have roles and that a word is being introduced for one of them.
- B. That the learner has already been given a complete verbal statement of the rules of chess, including every legal move available to each piece.
- C. That the learner already possesses the concept of a king, since otherwise the sentence conveys no information that he could put to any use.
- D. That the learner is able to reproduce the shape of the piece from memory, since recognition of the shape is what the ostensive definition supplies.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: Section 31 requires that "the place is already prepared", and the preparation is entry into the practice - attending, imitating, being corrected - not possession of the concept taught.
- **B:** Incorrect: an explicit rulebook is neither necessary nor sufficient, and Section 68 and 84 note that games are not everywhere circumscribed by rules.
- **C:** Incorrect: requiring prior possession of the concept would make learning it impossible and turn the account viciously circular.
- **D:** Incorrect: Section 31 mentions the shape of the king as something already known to a chess-learner, not as what the definition delivers.

Examiner trap 6: Glossing "the place is already prepared" as "already has the concept" makes Wittgenstein's condition unsatisfiable; the preparation is practical and pre-conceptual, which is why Section 5-6 place training before explanation.

MCQ 7. The standard metre

Why does Section 50 say that of the standard metre in Paris one can say neither that it is one metre long nor that it is not?

- A. Because its length has been shown by later measurement to differ marginally from the metre as that unit is now internationally defined.
- B. Because the bar possesses an extraordinary metaphysical property that removes it from the ordinary range of things to which lengths are ascribed.
- C. Because no measurement of any object can be exact, so that every ascription of length is strictly speaking neither true nor false of that object.
- D. Because that is its peculiar role in the language-game of measuring: the bar functions as the standard rather than as an object measured by it.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the remark is grammatical rather than metrological, and it would hold whatever the bar's physical history.
- **B:** Incorrect: Section 50 explicitly says that this is not to ascribe any extraordinary property to it.
- **C:** Incorrect: general inexactness would affect every object equally and would not single out the standard at all.
- **D:** Correct: the bar belongs to the means of representation, which is also why Section 16 counts colour samples as part of the language rather than as its subject-matter.

Examiner trap 7: Missing Section 50 costs marks in the private-language answer, because a sample that carried its own instructions would let a remembered sensation serve as a private standard.

MCQ 8. What family resemblance denies

Which one of the following states most precisely what the family-resemblance considerations of Section 66-67 deny?

- A. That any two things called by the same general term ever share a feature, since the network consists only of resemblances of detail.
- B. That concepts can be taught by examples, since examples always underdetermine the boundary of the concept being conveyed.
- C. That a general term must be backed by a feature common to all its instances if speakers are to use it correctly and intelligibly.
- D. That sharply bounded concepts exist at all, since inspection shows every concept to possess a blurred and extensible edge.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: many games plainly share several features; the survey shows only that no feature runs through all of them.
- **B:** Incorrect: Section 69-71 treat teaching by examples as the normal and adequate method for such concepts.
- **C:** Correct: the target is the requirement expressed by "there *must* be something common", which Section 66 identifies as a demand carried to the facts.
- **D:** Incorrect: "triangle" and "prime number" retain strict definitions, and Wittgenstein nowhere denies this.

Examiner trap 8: Overstating the doctrine into "definitions are impossible" makes it self-defeating, since the claim would then apply to the definition of family resemblance itself.

MCQ 9. The thread, and the status of the boundary

Consider the following statements about Section 67-71.

1. The strength of a spun thread lies in one fibre running through its whole length.
2. We do not know the boundary of "game" because none has been drawn.
3. A boundary may be drawn for a special purpose without discovering a hidden one.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: Section 69 states that no boundary has been drawn and that one may be drawn for a special purpose, which is a decision rather than a discovery.
- **B:** Incorrect: statement 1 reverses Section 67, whose whole point is that the strength lies in the overlapping of many fibres.
- **C:** Incorrect: statement 2 is also correct, and omitting it loses the distinction between an undrawn boundary and a hidden one.
- **D:** Incorrect: it includes the inversion of the thread analogy, which is the very image Wittgenstein uses against the demand for a core.

Examiner trap 9: Saying that the boundary is unknown because it is hidden restores the essence-demand in epistemic clothing; Section 69's point is that nothing has been concealed, because nothing has been drawn.

MCQ 10. What the builders' language establishes

The language of Section 2, consisting only of "block", "pillar", "slab" and "beam", is introduced in order to show which one of the following?

- A. That the earliest human languages consisted of single-word commands, out of which sentential structure gradually developed over long periods of time.
- B. That a language can be complete for its purpose while consisting of trained responses to calls rather than of descriptions of anything.
- C. That every language, however complex, can in principle be translated without remainder into a vocabulary of four basic terms.
- D. That naming is the fundamental linguistic function, from which ordering, questioning and describing are all derived by extension.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Section 130-131 warn that the invented games are objects of comparison, not hypotheses about the origins of language.
- **B:** Correct: Wittgenstein instructs us to conceive it as a complete primitive language, and Section 19-20 show that "Slab!" functions as an order because of its place in the transaction.
- **C:** Incorrect: no reductive translation is proposed, and Section 23's list of countless kinds runs in the opposite direction.
- **D:** Incorrect: the example is designed to displace naming from that position by exhibiting a working language that does not describe.

Examiner trap 10: Narrating the builders without stating what they establish converts an argument into an anecdote, and the argument is that completeness for a purpose is all a language needs.

MCQ 11. Objects of comparison

According to Section 130-131, what is the methodological status of the simple language-games Wittgenstein invents?

- A. Idealised models which display, in simplified form, the structure that our own language possesses in a more complicated arrangement.
- B. Preliminary hypotheses about the earliest stages of language, to be confirmed or refuted by anthropological and historical evidence.
- C. Objects of comparison meant to throw light on our language by way of dissimilarities as much as by way of similarities to it.
- D. Thought-experiments intended to establish which features of language are necessary and which are merely contingent additions.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: treating them as simplified models reinstates the assumption that one structure underlies all language, which the games are designed to loosen.
- **B:** Incorrect: no empirical claim is made, and Section 130-131 explicitly disclaim the role of preliminary studies awaiting confirmation.
- **C:** Correct: the remark says the games are set up as objects of comparison illuminating by dissimilarity as well as by likeness.
- **D:** Incorrect: sorting the necessary from the contingent is precisely the essence-seeking project that family resemblance dismantles.

Examiner trap 11: Calling the invented games "models of language" is a quiet reintroduction of the *Tractatus* assumption, and an examiner alert to method will notice it immediately.

MCQ 12. Section 23 and its closing clause

Which one of the following best captures the argumentative function of the list at Section 23?

- A. To classify the sentence-kinds of natural language into an exhaustive taxonomy on which a systematic theory of meaning can be founded.
- B. To exhibit a deliberately disorderly multiplicity, which is not fixed once for all, and to conclude that speaking is part of an activity or form of life.
- C. To demonstrate that all the apparent varieties of sentence reduce, on a sufficiently careful analysis, to the three basic types of assertion, question and command.
- D. To show that describing is the central use of language, with joking, praying and cursing understood as parasitic deviations from it.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: a tidy taxonomy would suggest an underlying principle of division, which is exactly the suggestion the list's disorder is meant to defeat.
- **B:** Correct: Section 23 states that there are countless kinds, that the multiplicity is not fixed since new games arise and old ones are forgotten, and ends with the form-of-life clause.
- **C:** Incorrect: no such reduction is offered, and the list mixes reporting, translating, riddling and praying without ranking them.
- **D:** Incorrect: describing appears as one item among many, and that demotion is one of the list's principal effects.

Examiner trap 12: Reproducing the list without the closing clause loses the textual bridge to forms of life, which is the sentence the 2022 answer most needs to quote.

MCQ 13. Surface grammar, depth grammar and "It is 5 o'clock on the sun"

On Wittgenstein's diagnosis at Section 350-351 and Section 664, what exactly is wrong with the sentence "It is 5 o'clock on the sun"?

- A. It is false, since the sun's rotation makes the assignment of any particular clock time to its surface incorrect as a matter of fact.
- B. It is ungrammatical, since the phrase "on the sun" cannot be combined with a time-of-day expression in a well-formed English sentence.
- C. It is unverifiable, since no observation could ever be made that would establish which hour obtained at the surface of the sun at any given moment.
- D. It is impeccable on the surface and has no specified use, since our practice of telling the time is tied to a place and a position of the sun.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: falsity presupposes a determinate use, which is exactly what the diagnosis says has not been supplied.
- **B:** Incorrect: the sentence is grammatically flawless, and that impeccability is why the difficulty is philosophical rather than linguistic.
- **C:** Incorrect: unverifiability is the positivists' category, and importing it here confuses Topic 07's criterion with Topic 08's grammatical method.
- **D:** Correct: surface grammar survives the transfer while use does not, which is the model for the verdict later passed on the diarist's "S".

Examiner trap 13: Reaching for "meaningless because unverifiable" here shows that the boundary against logical positivism has not been understood, and it costs marks in any comparison question.

MCQ 14. Agreement in judgments

At Section 241-242 Wittgenstein answers the charge that human agreement decides what is true and false. What is the substance of his reply?

- A. That agreement decides truth only in mathematics and in logic, where conventions are stipulated, and not in empirical discourse, where the world decides.
- B. That agreement among competent speakers is indeed the criterion of truth, provided the speakers belong to the same linguistic community.
- C. That what is true or false is what human beings say, while what they agree in is the language they use - not agreement in opinions but in form of life.
- D. That the question is unanswerable, since any criterion offered would itself require agreement before it could be applied to a particular case.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: no such division is drawn, and Section 242's measuring example is taken from ordinary empirical practice.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is exactly the relativist reading Section 241 is constructed to refuse.
- **C:** Correct: the reply separates the level at which truth is settled from the level at which determinate assertion is made possible.
- **D:** Incorrect: Section 242 gives a definite answer through the measuring case rather than declining the question.

Examiner trap 14: The decisive detail is Section 242's asymmetry - wildly varying measurements would give us no measuring rather than inaccurate measuring - and an answer that omits it has asserted the reply without arguing it.

MCQ 15. The lion

What does the remark "If a lion could talk, we could not understand him" establish?

- A. That understanding requires enough shared activity and natural history for us to tell what a speaker is doing, so vocabulary alone is not sufficient.
- B. That different human cultures are mutually unintelligible, since each rests on a form of life closed to inspection from outside it.
- C. That animals cannot possess concepts, since concept-possession requires a public language of the kind only human beings have developed.
- D. That translation between any two languages is strictly impossible, and that the apparent success of translating rests upon shared subject-matter alone.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the remark states a condition of intelligibility, and the lion's life offers too little shared purchase for us to identify his moves.
- **B:** Incorrect: Wittgenstein repeatedly imagines alien practices and then describes them, which presupposes that anthropological understanding is possible.
- **C:** Incorrect: nothing in the remark concerns animal cognition, and its subject is our position as would-be interpreters.
- **D:** Incorrect: Section 23 lists translating from one language into another as an ordinary language-game among others.

Examiner trap 15: Using the lion as a proof of cultural incommensurability contradicts Wittgenstein's own practice of describing imagined tribes, and it is the standard route by which a form-of-life answer slides into relativism.

MCQ 16. The three parts of Section 201

Which one of the following correctly reports the structure of Section 201?

- A. It states a paradox about rules, concedes that the paradox is unanswerable, and recommends that we accept communal agreement in its place.
- B. It states a paradox, diagnoses it as a misunderstanding arising from giving one interpretation after another, and asserts a grasping that is not an interpretation.
- C. It states a paradox, resolves it by appealing to a further and more precisely formulated rule, and warns that arriving at such a formulation is often extremely difficult in practice.
- D. It states a paradox, attributes it to the vagueness of ordinary language, and recommends replacing ordinary rules with rules of a formal calculus.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is Kripke's reconstruction rather than the remark, and Section 201 itself uses the word "misunderstanding".
- **B:** Correct: the three parts are the paradox, the diagnosis of interpretation-substitution, and the assertion of a way of grasping exhibited in obeying and going against a rule.
- **C:** Incorrect: a further rule would need a further interpretation, so the regress is structural rather than a matter of imprecision.
- **D:** Incorrect: the later Wittgenstein rejects the demand that a calculus underlie ordinary use, and Section 130-131 treat constructed systems only as comparisons.

Examiner trap 16: Quoting only the paradox and stopping converts a reductio into scepticism, which is the single most damaging omission available in this session.

MCQ 17. Section 202 and private rule-following

What consequence does Section 202 draw from the claim that obeying a rule is a practice?

- A. That rules can be followed only where a community actually exists to enforce them, since enforcement is what constitutes the standard of correctness.
- B. That every rule must be capable of explicit formulation, since a practice without a formulation cannot be transmitted from one person to another.
- C. That rule-following is a species of habit, so that the distinction between obeying a rule and merely acting regularly is one of degree only.
- D. That a rule cannot be obeyed "privately", since otherwise thinking one was obeying a rule would be the same thing as obeying it.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the remark concerns the distinction between obeying and seeming to obey, not the presence of enforcers, and the community question is separately disputed.
- **B:** Incorrect: Section 5-6 and Section 31 make training rather than formulation the primary mode of transmission.
- **C:** Incorrect: reducing rule-following to habit removes the possibility of mistake, which is what distinguishes a practice from a regularity.
- **D:** Correct: Section 202 states the consequence in exactly these terms, and it is the premise imported into the diary argument at Section 258.

Examiner trap 17: Failing to cite Section 202 before Section 258 makes the private-language argument look like a fresh assertion, when it is the application of a result already established forty remarks earlier.

MCQ 18. Kripke's reading

Which one of the following describes the status of the interpretation offered in Kripke's *Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language*?

- A. It is presented by Kripke as the argument as it struck him rather than as exegesis, and it is contested by anti-sceptical readers such as Baker, Hacker and McDowell.
- B. It is presented by Kripke as a straightforward exposition of Section 201, and it is accepted as such by the great majority of Wittgenstein's commentators.
- C. It is presented by Kripke as a criticism of Wittgenstein, arguing that the rule-following remarks fail to establish anything about meaning at all.
- D. It is presented by Kripke as a reconstruction of the *Tractatus*, showing that the sceptical problem about rules was already fully present in the much earlier work of 1921.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: Kripke's own framing is why the scholarly shorthand "Kripkenstein" exists, and the anti-sceptical readings treat Section 201 as dissolving rather than conceding a paradox.
- **B:** Incorrect: the reading is influential but disputed, and Kripke himself declines the exegetical claim.
- **C:** Incorrect: Kripke takes the argument to succeed, and supplies a sceptical solution rather than a verdict of failure.
- **D:** Incorrect: the book concerns the *Investigations*, and the *Tractatus* is not its subject.

Examiner trap 18: Attributing the sceptical solution to Wittgenstein without qualification is the fastest way to lose the scholarship mark, and the correction costs only the four words "as it struck Kripke".

MCQ 19. The target of the private-language argument

Which one of the following is the language whose possibility Section 243 puts in question?

- A. A language of encrypted signs deliberately devised so that nobody outside a small group of initiates can decipher what has been written down in it by another.
- B. A language used only in soliloquy, spoken aloud or silently by a person who has no interlocutor and expects none.
- C. A language whose words refer to what can only be known to the speaker - his immediate private sensations - so that another cannot understand it.
- D. A language invented by a single person and never taught to anyone else, though it could in principle be taught if he chose to teach it.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: a code is a public language encrypted, decipherable in principle, and its signs already carry public meanings.
- **B:** Incorrect: Section 243 introduces monologuists precisely in order to set them aside, noting that a researcher could learn their language.
- **C:** Correct: this reproduces Section 243's own narrowing, on which the words could not be understood by another even in principle.
- **D:** Incorrect: teachability in principle is exactly what the target lacks, so this describes a merely unshared public language.

Examiner trap 19: Half the available marks in the 2020 and 2024 parts are lost in the first paragraph by candidates who attack a secret code, and the remedy is to reproduce Section 243's narrowing before anything else.

MCQ 20. What collapses in the diary argument

In Section 258, what exactly is it that the diarist fails to secure by concentrating his attention on a sensation and writing "S"?

- A. A guarantee that his memory will in fact preserve the association between the sign and the sensation over any considerable period of time.
- B. A criterion of correctness, so that no distinction arises between applying the sign correctly and merely seeming to himself to apply it correctly.
- C. An assurance that the sensation he attends to is genuinely recurring rather than being a series of numerically distinct but closely similar sensations.
- D. A method of communicating the content of his diary to anyone else who might wish to read it and learn what the sign records.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this makes the argument turn on the reliability of memory, whereas the claim is that there is nothing here for memory to be reliable about.
- **B:** Correct: Section 258 concludes that whatever is going to seem right is right, and that this only means we cannot talk about "right" here.
- **C:** Incorrect: the identity of the sensation is not the issue, and Section 270 shows the argument survives even where identification is set aside entirely.
- **D:** Incorrect: incommunicability is a feature of the case as stipulated, not the defect the argument uncovers.

Examiner trap 20: Presenting the diary argument as an argument from fallible memory invites the reply that public memory is fallible too, which the correct formulation never faces.

MCQ 21. The manometer variant

What does Section 270 add to the diary argument by imagining that writing "S" coincides with a rise in blood pressure detectable by a manometer?

- A. It concedes that private ostensive definition can succeed after all, provided the sensation is correlated with some observable bodily change.
- B. It shows that sensations are identical with bodily states, so that the appearance of an inner realm is dissolved by ordinary physiological investigation.
- C. It shows that once a public criterion supplies the sign with a use, the question whether the inner identification was correct becomes irrelevant.
- D. It shows that the diarist's memory can be tested after all, so that the criterion of correctness is supplied by his own repeated observations.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the private ostension does no work in the improved case, which is the opposite of a concession that it succeeds.
- **B:** Incorrect: no identity claim is made, and Section 304 explicitly refuses to reduce the sensation to anything.
- **C:** Correct: Wittgenstein notes that whether the diarist recognised the sensation rightly has ceased to matter, which completes the diagnosis constructively.
- **D:** Incorrect: the manometer, not the diarist's memory, is what supplies the independent check.

Examiner trap 21: Omitting Section 270 leaves the argument purely negative; including it shows that the account explains what a working sensation-word actually rests on.

MCQ 22. The beetle-in-a-box

What conclusion does Section 293 draw from the supposition that everyone has a box whose contents only he can see?

- A. That the contents of the boxes must in fact be identical, since otherwise the shared word "beetle" could not be used successfully at all.
- B. That sensations do not exist, since a box that might be empty is indistinguishable from a box whose contents are constantly changing.
- C. That each speaker means something different by "beetle", so that communication about sensations is systematically illusory.
- D. That on the object-and-designation model of sensation-grammar the object drops out of consideration as irrelevant to the shared word.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the example's force lies in showing that identity of contents is not required for the word to work.
- **B:** Incorrect: Section 304 insists the sensation is not a something, but not a nothing either, and Section 293 attacks a model rather than a phenomenon.
- **C:** Incorrect: the argument runs the other way, since the word functions perfectly well however the contents may vary.
- **D:** Correct: the conclusion is expressly conditional on construing the grammar of sensation-expression on the model of object and designation.

Examiner trap 22: Leading with the beetle rather than the diary reverses the argumentative order; the diary carries the argument, and the beetle removes a residual temptation about shared words.

MCQ 23. Criteria and symptoms

In the *Blue Book's* example of angina, which of the following pairings is correct?

- A. Both the bacillus and the inflamed throat are criteria, since either will settle the question whether the patient has the illness.
- B. The bacillus is the criterion, established by definition, and the inflamed throat is a symptom, established by experience.
- C. The inflamed throat is the criterion, since it is what we actually observe, and the bacillus is a symptom inferred from laboratory work.
- D. Both the bacillus and the inflamed throat are symptoms, since neither is conclusive and both may be absent in a genuine case.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: treating both as criteria erases the distinction between what fixes the concept and what experience has correlated with it.
- **B:** Correct: we defined angina as the illness produced by that bacillus, and discovered by investigation that inflammation usually accompanies it.
- **C:** Incorrect: observability is not what makes something a criterion; the grammatical role fixed by the definition is.
- **D:** Incorrect: criteria are indeed defeasible, but defeasibility does not convert a definitional ground into an inductive correlation.

Examiner trap 23: Using a psychological example first makes the distinction look invented to save a doctrine about the mind; the angina case shows it is a general grammatical distinction.

MCQ 24. Section 580 and the behaviourism charge

Consider the following statements about Section 580 and Section 304, 307-308.

1. Section 580 asserts that there are no inner processes, only outward behaviour.
2. Section 304 insists that the sensation is "not a something, but not a nothing either".
3. Section 307 concedes that if he speaks of a fiction, it is of a grammatical fiction.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: statement 3 is accurate, but statement 1 attributes to Section 580 an eliminativism that Section 304 expressly rejects.
- **B:** Incorrect: statement 2 is accurate, but pairing it with statement 1 makes Wittgenstein deny and affirm the inner in consecutive remarks.
- **C:** Correct: Section 580 says the *concept* of an inner process requires outward criteria, while Section 304 and 307 protect the phenomenon and locate the fiction in grammar.
- **D:** Incorrect: it retains the eliminativist misreading that the other two remarks are designed to prevent.

Examiner trap 24: The word that blocks the behaviourist inference is "defeasible": a criterion grounds an ascription without entailing it, so a single case of successful pretence refutes an equivalence but not a grammatical dependence.

MCQ 25. Remedial drill - the provenance of the *Investigations*

Which one of the following statements about *Philosophical Investigations* is correct?

- A. It was composed between 1936 and 1949 and published posthumously in 1953, edited by G. E. M. Anscombe and Rush Rhees, with Anscombe as translator.
- B. It was published by Wittgenstein himself in 1953, two years before his death, in a German edition followed shortly afterwards by an English translation.
- C. It was assembled by Kripke from Wittgenstein's papers and published in 1953, which is why its arrangement of remarks is partly interpretive.
- D. It was published in 1921 in German and in 1922 in a bilingual edition, and its Part I consists of six hundred and ninety-three numbered remarks.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the book is posthumous, its arrangement is partly editorial, and Part I's numbering is stable across editions and translations.
- **B:** Incorrect: Wittgenstein died in 1951, and he published only one philosophical book and one article in his lifetime.
- **C:** Incorrect: Kripke's involvement with Wittgenstein is a book of interpretation published in 1982, not editorial work on the text.
- **D:** Incorrect: those dates belong to the *Tractatus*, though the remark about 693 numbered remarks is itself true of the *Investigations*.

Examiner trap 25: Writing "Wittgenstein published the *Investigations*" is a factual error visible in one sentence, and avoiding it costs nothing but the word "posthumously".

MCQ 26. Remedial drill - citing the duck-rabbit

Which one of the following gives the correct citation practice for the duck-rabbit discussion?

- A. Cite it as *Investigations* Section xi, since Part II uses roman numerals that are stable across all editions and translations of the work.
- B. Cite it as "Part II Section xi / *Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment*", since the 2009 fourth edition renamed and renumbered that material.
- C. Cite it as *Investigations* Section 293, since the beetle-in-a-box and the duck-rabbit belong to the same continuous discussion of inner experience.
- D. Cite it as *On Certainty*, since aspect-seeing belongs with the hinge propositions among the notes Wittgenstein wrote in his final years.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the numbering of that material is precisely what the 2009 revision by Hacker and Schulte changed.
- **B:** Correct: giving both forms makes the reference safe whichever edition the reader holds.
- **C:** Incorrect: Section 293 belongs to Part I and concerns the beetle, which is a different argument in a different place.
- **D:** Incorrect: *On Certainty* consists of notes of 1949-51 published in 1969 and answers Moore rather than treating aspect-perception.

Examiner trap 26: The associated factual error is attributing the drawing to Wittgenstein: the figure is Jastrow's, published in 1899, and Wittgenstein reproduces it.

MCQ 27. Remedial drill - colour exclusion

What is the correct account of the colour-exclusion difficulty in relation to the *Tractatus*?

- A. It refuted the picture theory outright in 1929, which is why Wittgenstein abandoned the *Tractatus* and began work on a completely new system.
- B. It was raised by Ramsey against Wittgenstein, who never acknowledged it anywhere in print and continued to hold elementary propositions to be logically independent.
- C. It concerned the impossibility of naming simple objects, and was resolved in the *Investigations* by the doctrine of family resemblance.
- D. It pressured the independence of elementary propositions, was acknowledged in "Some Remarks on Logical Form" in 1929, and the repair attempted there failed.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it strains one commitment rather than refuting a system, and the later work developed over two decades rather than in a single break.
- **B:** Incorrect: Wittgenstein acknowledged the difficulty publicly in the 1929 paper he wrote on returning to Cambridge.
- **C:** Incorrect: the missing simples are a separate difficulty, addressed at Section 47 by showing that "simple" is relative to a language-game.
- **D:** Correct: "this spot is red" and "this spot is green" cannot both be true, though neither looks further analysable, and Wittgenstein later disowned the paper's proposed repair.

Examiner trap 27: Calling colour exclusion a knock-down refutation converts a philosopher's long dissatisfaction into a single decisive move, and examiners in transition questions look for the word "pressure".

MCQ 28. Remedial drill - the boundary against logical positivism

Which one of the following correctly states the relation between the later Wittgenstein and logical positivism?

- A. He rejects one criterion of meaning as firmly as one essence, treats fact-stating as one use among many, and dissolves rather than rejects metaphysical puzzles.
- B. He accepts the verification principle as the criterion of cognitive significance while adding language-games as an account of how verification is actually carried out.
- C. He belongs to the Vienna Circle and contributed the private-language argument to its programme of eliminating metaphysical pseudo-statements from discourse.
- D. He agrees that metaphysical sentences are pseudo-statements, and differs from the Circle only in preferring ordinary language to a formalised notation.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: his objection to the *Tractatus* - one essence mistaken for many uses - applies with equal force to any single criterion of significance.
- **B:** Incorrect: adopting verification would install exactly the kind of general criterion Section 43's hedge and Section 66-67 are designed to exclude.
- **C:** Incorrect: Wittgenstein was never a member of the Circle, though he conversed with Schlick and Waismann between 1929 and 1932.
- **D:** Incorrect: rejection is a verdict on a sentence, whereas dissolution is a treatment of a puzzle, and the difference is not one of notation.

Examiner trap 28: Assimilating the later Wittgenstein to positivism is common because both oppose metaphysics; the discriminating sentence is that the Circle imposes a criterion while he denies that any single criterion is available.

MCQ 29. Remedial drill - the verdict on solipsism

Which one of the following states the later Wittgenstein's verdict on solipsism at its correct strength?

- A. Solipsism is refuted, since the publicity of language establishes by a valid inference that other minds exist and that the external world is real.
- B. Solipsism is confirmed in what it means but not in what it says, since the limits of my language are the limits of my world.
- C. Solipsism is left untouched, since grammatical investigation concerns the use of words and can have no bearing on a metaphysical thesis.
- D. Solipsism is self-undermining and therefore dissolved, since the concepts needed to state it cannot have determinate application on its own terms.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: no inference to other minds is offered, and the fatal error flagged in the directive decoder is exactly "language is public, therefore other minds exist".
- **B:** Incorrect: that is the *Tractatus* treatment at 5.62, which the later work replaces with a grammatical route.
- **C:** Incorrect: the grammatical investigation bears directly on the thesis, since the thesis is stated in words whose application it examines.
- **D:** Correct: either the solipsist's terms are fixed by present seeming, in which case Section 258 applies, or he has conceded the public-type practice he denies.

Examiner trap 29: The 2019 verb is "culminates", which asks for a development; a script that presents the later argument as the early one repeated has answered a question about repetition rather than about culmination.

MCQ 30. Remedial drill - the solitary speaker

What is the correct reply to the objection that a man alone from birth could invent words for his own sensations?

- A. That such a man could not survive to adulthood, so the case is empirically idle and no philosophical conclusion can be drawn from it.
- B. That he would in fact be using a public language, since the concepts of sensation he employed would have been acquired from other speakers.
- C. That the target is logical privacy rather than solitude, and a solitary speaker may still employ stable, repeatable, public-type criteria.
- D. That his words would be meaningful but unteachable, which shows that teachability is not after all a requirement on meaningful language.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the objection is a thought-experiment about the conditions of meaning, and empirical implausibility does not address it.
- **B:** Incorrect: the case stipulates that he acquired nothing from others, so this begs the question rather than answering it.
- **C:** Correct: what the argument excludes is a sign for which no criterion of correctness is available even in principle, not a speaker who happens to be alone.
- **D:** Incorrect: conceding meaningful but unteachable words would surrender the conclusion the argument is meant to establish.

Examiner trap 30: Whether an actual community is required, or only in-principle shareable standards, is genuinely disputed in the literature, and an answer that states the dispute rather than settling it by assertion reads as scholarship.

MCQ 31. Remedial drill - "Philosophy leaves everything as it is"

What is the correct scope of Section 124's statement that philosophy leaves everything as it is?

- A. It concerns the actual use of language, which philosophy may not interfere with or found; it does not commit Wittgenstein to social or political conservatism.
- B. It concerns human institutions generally, and commits Wittgenstein to the view that any criticism of established practices lies outside philosophy's proper competence.
- C. It concerns the results of the sciences, which philosophy may neither confirm nor overturn, and says nothing at all about the use of ordinary language.
- D. It concerns philosophical theories, which are to be left standing because no method exists for adjudicating between competing philosophical systems.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the remark's own first clause restricts it, saying that philosophy may in no way interfere with the actual use of language and cannot give it a foundation.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is the quietism charge stated as if it were the doctrine, and it ignores the restriction the remark itself supplies.
- **C:** Incorrect: the sciences are not the subject of Section 124, whose topic throughout is grammar and its description.
- **D:** Incorrect: Section 128 holds that philosophical theses would be undebatable, which is a stronger claim than leaving existing theories standing.

Examiner trap 31: The honest position quotes the restriction and then concedes that the range of what philosophy may attempt is nevertheless narrowed very severely - a cost Wittgenstein accepts rather than an objection he answers.

MCQ 32. Remedial drill - the ownership fence

Which one of the following correctly assigns material that neighbours this clause without belonging to it?

- A. Saying and showing belong to this clause, verification belongs to Topic 07, and Strawson's persons belong to Topic 11 alongside Quine's holism and ontological relativity.
- B. Saying and showing belong to Topic 06, verification to Topic 07, Quine's holism and Strawson's persons to Topic 11, and fideist uses of "form of life" to Paper II.
- C. Saying and showing belong to Topic 06, verification to this clause, hinge certainty to Topic 11, and Ryle's category-mistakes to Paper II.
- D. Saying and showing belong to Topic 07, verification to Topic 06, hinge certainty to this clause, and Austin's performatives to Topic 11.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: saying and showing are the *Tractatus* doctrine and are owned by Topic 06, appearing here only as the position being revised.
- **B:** Correct: this reproduces the fence, and it also explains why 2021 is empty for this clause while its Wittgenstein part, on "Whereof one cannot speak", belongs to Topic 06.
- **C:** Incorrect: verification is Topic 07's criterion, and hinge certainty belongs to *On Certainty* as bounded enrichment rather than to Topic 11.
- **D:** Incorrect: the assignments are transposed, and Austin is a broader ordinary-language owner rather than part of Quine and Strawson.

Examiner trap 32: Naming a neighbouring doctrine in one clause earns a boundary mark; expounding it spends the answer on another syllabus item, and in a ten-mark part that expenditure is usually fatal.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key; UPSC publishes no descriptive model answers for Philosophy Paper I. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers, including the printed anomalies the repository ledger flags. The 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025 Paper I texts are held locally, and the English wording of every part below - including the three supporting parts owned by other topics - follows the repository's verified Western Philosophy PYQ ledger. Remarks are cited by **Section number**, which is stable across editions and translations of Part I; works are cited by author, title and both composition and publication dates wherever they differ, because almost every text in this clause is posthumous. Interpretive disputes - whether Kripke's sceptical solution is Wittgensteinian, whether an actual community is required for rule-following, and whether "meaning is use" is a theory or a reminder - are flagged as contested rather than settled.

Answer-length convention used throughout this package. UPSC Philosophy Paper I parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands used here are **10 marks - about 150 to 220 words**, **15 marks - about 250 to 330 words**, and **20 marks - about 330 to 400 words**. Every solution below sits inside its declared band, and the demand decoding, the verdict heading and the "why this earns marks" notes are teaching apparatus that sit **outside** the timed word count.

Coverage. ANALYSIS: Corpus signal: this clause owns **7 of 112** Western Philosophy question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus, with **2021 the only year without an owned part**. All seven are solved in full below, followed by **three supporting routed parts** that bear directly on this clause while being owned by Topic 06, and **six original solved Mains models**, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks. The internal distribution is worth knowing before the exam: the **private-language critique** is tested in 2019, 2020 and 2024 - three of seven parts, in three different framings; the **transition from the early to the later philosophy** in 2023 and 2025; **family resemblance** in 2018; and **form of life** in 2022. A candidate who prepares meaning-as-use but not the private-language argument as an *argument* has prepared under half the clause.

Solved PYQ 1 · 2018 · Q1(c) · 10 marks

Question: How does the notion of 'family resemblance' help Wittgenstein to uphold that 'Language is a game'? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"How does ... help ... to uphold ...? Discuss." - an argumentative service , not a definition
Core issue	Why calling language a game is a description rather than an evasion of the demand for an essence
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the challenge, the survey, the analogy, the service rendered, one qualification
Ideal thesis	Family resemblance removes the requirement of a common essence, and games are the paradigm of order without essence
Non-negotiables	Section 65's challenge; "Don't think, but look!"; the thread; what the doctrine does not claim

Independent model answer

Thesis. Family resemblance does not describe language; it removes the obstacle to describing it - the assumption that a general term must be backed by a feature common to all its instances.

The challenge. At Section 65 an interlocutor presses the objection Wittgenstein's own early work would have pressed: you speak of language-games and never say what the essence of language is.

The survey. Section 66 replies with an instruction - "*Don't say: 'There must be something common' ... but look and see.*" Board-games, card-games, ball-games, Olympic games, ring-a-ring-a-roses and patience defeat amusement, competition, winning and losing, skill and luck in turn, leaving "*a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing*", named at Section 67.

The service rendered. The refusal to define "language" ceases to be a defect; "game" is itself the paradigm family-resemblance concept, so the analogy applies the very notion that dispensed with essences; and games possess rules, training, moves and standards **without** an essence - exactly the combination the *Tractatus* thought only a shared logical form could supply. Section 67's thread makes it vivid: strength lies in the overlapping of many fibres, not in one running the whole length.

Qualification. ANALYSIS: It does not claim that no concept admits definition, that no two games share a feature, or that anything may be called a game: practice selects the relevant similarities, so open texture is not arbitrariness.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the verb is "help ... to uphold". Every paragraph must say what work the notion does, not what it is.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: thesis one line; challenge one; survey three; service four; qualification two.

- **Structure:** the challenge -> the survey -> the name and the thread -> the service -> the limit.
- **Doctrine:** no essence required; games as norm-governed without essence.
- **Evidence:** Section 65, Section 66, Section 67; the thread; the six defeated candidate-features.
- **Distinction:** *not required against impossible*.
- **Criticism:** unlimited resemblance, answered by practice-selected relevance.

Solved PYQ 2 · 2019 · Q3(b) · 15 marks

Question: Show how Wittgenstein's critique of solipsism culminates in the critique of private language.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Show how ... culminates in ..." - a development , with a beginning, a change and an endpoint
Core issue	What the later route supplies that the early treatment could not
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the early treatment briefly, the change of route, the dilemma, the limits
Ideal thesis	The early book could only say the solipsist's meaning was unsayable; the later argument identifies what is missing - a criterion of correctness
Non-negotiables	5.62 stated correctly; dissolution not refutation; Section 258 and Section 202; no proof of other minds

Independent model answer

Thesis. The critique culminates in the private-language argument because the later work replaces a claim about the limits of what can be said with a diagnosis of what the solipsist's own vocabulary lacks.

The early treatment. The *Tractatus* already declined to call solipsism false. 5.6 states that the limits of my language mean the limits of my world; 5.62 that what the solipsist means is quite correct but *cannot be said*; 5.64 that solipsism strictly carried out coincides with pure realism, the self shrinking to an extensionless point. The mechanism is saying and showing.

The change of route. ANALYSIS: The later argument is not that treatment completed. It relocates the trouble from the *limit* of language to the *grammar* of the solipsist's words, and it replaces the saying/showing distinction with the distinction between a criterion and mere seeming.

The dilemma. Ask what fixes the application of "experience", "real" and "mine" in the solipsist's mouth. If they are fixed by his present impression, then by Section 258 whatever seems right is right, *"and that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'"* - no rule has been given, so nothing determinate has been asserted. If they are fixed by stable, repeatable techniques, he has helped himself to the public-type practice his thesis denies. Section 202 has already established that obeying a rule is a practice, and that thinking one obeys is not obeying.

Supporting collapse of the asymmetry. Section 246 adds that *"only I can know whether I am really in pain"* is false in one way, since others often do know, and nonsense in another, since I do not learn of my pain by observation.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: This is a **dissolution**, not a refutation: no proof of other minds is offered, and Section 303's remark that one should try, in a real case, to doubt another's pain concerns where doubt has application. The thesis is self-undermining because it consumes the vocabulary needed to state it.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "culminates" asks for a development. Say explicitly that the **route** changed, and the answer stops being a narration.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: thesis two lines; early three; change two; dilemma six; asymmetry three; verdict three.

- **Structure:** thesis -> early -> change of route -> dilemma -> supporting collapse -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** saying/showing; criterion of correctness; avowal.
- **Evidence:** 5.6, 5.62, 5.64; Section 202, 244, 246, 258, 303.
- **Distinction:** dissolution against refutation; logical privacy against solitude.
- **Criticism:** the result is exactly as strong as the private-language argument it depends on.

Solved PYQ 3 · 2020 · Q4(c) · 15 marks

Question: "But could we also imagine a language in which a person could write down or give vocal expression to his inner experiences-his feelings, moods and the rest-for his private use?" Critically discuss the answer offered by Wittgenstein to this question.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Critically discuss the answer offered" - reconstruct the answer, then assess it
Core issue	The quotation is Section 243 itself, so the answer must begin where the remark begins
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the narrowing, the diary, the constructive variant, two objections, verdict
Ideal thesis	The answer is no, because private ostension establishes no criterion of correctness
Non-negotiables	Section 243's own narrowing; Section 258; Section 265; Section 270; the memory and Crusoe objections

Independent model answer

Thesis. Wittgenstein's answer is that we could not, and the reason is not that such a language would be unshareable but that its words would have no standard of correct application.

Where the remark begins. Section 243 first sets aside the case that is not at issue: human beings who speak only in monologue, whose language a researcher could learn. The question is then narrowed to words that *"refer to what can only be known to the person speaking; to his immediate private sensations"*. ANALYSIS: The target is **logical** privacy - not a code, not soliloquy, not undisclosed feeling.

The diary. Section 258 tests the proposal. The diarist associates "S" with a recurring sensation and gives himself *"a kind of ostensive definition"* by concentrating his attention. But the ceremony can only mean that it brings it about that he remembers the connection rightly - *"and here we have no criterion of correctness ... whatever is going to seem right to me is right. And that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'."* Since Section 202 has established that obeying a rule is a practice, and that thinking one obeys is not obeying, no rule has been created.

The constructive variant. Section 270 completes the diagnosis. Suppose writing "S" coincides with a rise in blood pressure registered by a manometer: the sign now has a genuine use - and whether the sensation was identified rightly has become irrelevant. Whatever work the sign does is done by the **public** criterion.

Two objections. ANALYSIS: *Memory:* public checking also uses memory. Reply: it uses memory **plus** something independent - a chart, a record, another speaker - whereas Section 265 compares the private check to buying several copies of the same newspaper. CAUTION: *Crusoe:* a solitary man could invent sensation-words. Reply: solitude is not logical privacy; whether an actual community is required remains disputed.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The answer is decisive against private ostension as a foundation and denies neither sensations nor solitary speakers; Section 304's *"not a something, but not a nothing either"* fixes its exact strength.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the quotation is the text. Beginning where Section 243 begins, with the monologists set aside, secures the target-identification mark most scripts lose.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: thesis two lines; narrowing three; diary six; Section 270 three; objections four; verdict two.

- **Structure:** thesis -> Section 243's narrowing -> Section 258 -> Section 270 -> objections -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** private ostension; criterion of correctness; rule as practice.
- **Evidence:** Section 202, 243, 258, 265, 270, 304.
- **Distinction:** logical privacy against secrecy and against solitude.
- **Criticism:** the memory objection stated fairly, and the community question left open.

Solved PYQ 4 · 2022 · Q1(c) · 10 marks

Question: Establish the tenability of later Wittgenstein's motion of language as form of life. □ **Printed wording:** the official English line itself prints **"motion"**; it is retained here rather than silently changed to "notion".

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Establish the tenability" - a defended thesis , with the untenability test explicit
Core issue	Whether "form of life" makes agreement the criterion of truth
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the printed word, the two textual anchors, the Section 242 test, one concession
Ideal thesis	Tenable as the enabling background of determinate speech, untenable as a theory of truth
Non-negotiables	Reproduce "motion"; Section 19 and Section 23; Section 241's discrimination; Section 242's measuring asymmetry

Independent model answer

A note on the wording. The printed line reads "motion"; the notion is language as a form of life.

Thesis. The notion is tenable read as a claim about the **enabling background** of practice, and untenable read as the claim that agreement decides what is true.

The anchors. Section 19 states that *"to imagine a language means to imagine a form of life"*, and says it while asking whether the builders' "Slab!" is a word or a sentence - showing that a vocabulary cannot be specified apart from an activity. Section 23 closes its list with the clause that *"the speaking of language is part of an activity, or of a form of life"*.

The tenability test. Section 241 asks: does human agreement decide truth? The reply distinguishes levels - *"It is what human beings say that is true and false ... That is not agreement in opinions but in form of life."* Section 242 adds that communication requires agreement not only in definitions but in **judgments**: if measurement results varied wildly, we should have not *inaccurate* measuring but **no** measuring. **ANALYSIS:** Removing the background yields not error but the disappearance of the subject-matter - the asymmetry a relativist reading cannot use.

Concession. **ANALYSIS:** The phrase occurs a handful of times (Section 19, Section 23, Section 241, PPF), so large doctrines built on it are interpretation, and no adjudication theory is given.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "establish the tenability" requires you to name what would make it untenable and show that it does not follow. Do that in the thesis line.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: wording note one line; thesis one; anchors three; test five; concession two.

- **Structure:** printed wording -> thesis -> anchors -> the Section 242 asymmetry -> concession.

- **Doctrine:** agreement in judgments, not opinions; language inseparable from activity.
- **Evidence:** Section 19, Section 23, Section 241, Section 242's measuring case.
- **Distinction:** the level at which truth is settled against the level that makes assertion possible.
- **Criticism:** sparse occurrence; no adjudication theory.

Solved PYQ 5 · 2023 · Q4(c) · 15 marks

Question: What were the main reasons that led Wittgenstein to shift from picture-theory of meaning to use-theory of meaning? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"What were the main reasons ...? Critically discuss." - enumerate, then assess
Core issue	Whether the shift is a change of theory or a change in the demand for a theory
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: four or five reasons, the positive replacement, the verdict
Ideal thesis	The reasons are cumulative pressures on one assumption: that meaning has a single hidden essence
Non-negotiables	Colour exclusion as a pressure ; Section 43's hedge; the <i>Tractatus</i> did not disparage ordinary language

Independent model answer

Thesis. The reasons are not objections to a doctrine of picturing so much as cumulative pressures on the assumption underlying it - that something single and hidden explains how any expression means anything.

Reason one: the diversity of use. Section 23 lists ordering, describing, measuring, reporting, hypothesising, story-telling, play-acting, riddling, joking, translating, thanking, cursing, greeting and praying, and observes that new games arise and old ones are forgotten. No general propositional form covers this, and describing is exhibited as one item rather than the paradigm.

Reason two: the failure of ostension. Section 28 shows that an ostensive definition "*can be variously interpreted in every case*"; Section 29-30 that adding "*this number*" borrows the understanding it was to supply; Section 31 that it teaches only "*when the place is already prepared*". Naming therefore cannot be the foundation of meaning.

Reason three: colour exclusion. "This spot is red" and "this spot is green" cannot both be true, yet neither looks further analysable, which strains the *Tractatus*'s requirement that elementary propositions be independent. Wittgenstein acknowledged this in "Some Remarks on Logical Form" (1929). ANALYSIS: It is a **pressure**, not a knock-down refutation, and he later disowned the paper's proposed repair.

Reason four: the missing simples. Section 47 shows that "simple" and "composite" have no absolute sense: whether a chair is simple depends on what a language-game counts as a part. The terminus of analysis was therefore not unsatisfied but unstatable.

The replacement. Section 109 puts description in place of explanation, and Section 43 states the positive thesis with its own limitation - "*for a large class of cases - though not for all*".

Critical verdict. ANALYSIS: Two cautions. The shift is not from an artificial to an ordinary language, since the *Tractatus* held everyday propositions to be in perfect logical order. And Section 43's hedge exists to prevent "use" becoming a second essence; the residual difficulty, unresolved, is how established use is distinguished from innovation and from error.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: number the reasons. An examiner marking "main reasons" is counting, and four clearly separated pressures read as control.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: thesis two lines; four reasons ten; replacement two; verdict four.

- **Structure:** thesis -> four reasons -> the replacement -> the verdict.

- **Doctrine:** one general propositional form abandoned; description replaces analysis.
- **Evidence:** Section 23, Section 28-31, Section 47, Section 109, Section 43; "Some Remarks on Logical Form" (1929).
- **Distinction:** pressure against refutation; essence-demand against theory.
- **Criticism:** the normativity of use, conceded rather than concealed.

Solved PYQ 6 · 2024 · Q1(d) · 10 marks

Question: Why does later Wittgenstein think that there cannot be a language that only one person can speak - a language that is essentially private? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Why does he think ...? Discuss." - a reason, stated as an argument
Core issue	What "essentially private" means, and what its impossibility follows from
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the target, the five-step core, the beetle in one sentence, one qualification
Ideal thesis	Private ostension provides no criterion of correctness, hence no rule, hence no meaning
Non-negotiables	Four non-targets named; Section 258; Section 202; the solitary-speaker qualification

Independent model answer

Thesis. A language is essentially private only if its words are given meaning by private ostensive definition of logically private sensations; such a definition creates no distinction between correct and seeming-correct use, so no rule and no meaning is created.

The target, stated exactly. ANALYSIS: Section 243 defines it: words referring to "*what can only be known to the person speaking; to his immediate private sensations*", so that another cannot understand it. Four things are **not** the target: a secret code; talking to oneself; undisclosed thoughts; solitude.

The argument. (1) A sign has meaning only if there is a rule for its use. (2) A rule requires a criterion of correct application independent of present seeming - Section 202: obeying a rule is a practice, and *thinking* one obeys is not obeying. (3) Private ostension supplies no such criterion, the only check being a further seeming of the same kind. (4) Hence "correct" and "seems correct" coincide, and Section 258 concludes that "*here we can't talk about 'right'*". (5) Hence no rule, no meaning, no such language.

The illustration. Section 293's beetle adds that a private item which might differ in every box, change constantly, or be absent cannot fix the grammar of a shared sensation-word.

Qualification. ANALYSIS: The argument denies neither sensations nor solitary speakers; Section 304 calls the sensation "*not a something, but not a nothing*".

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the five steps must be numbered. A ten-mark private-language answer that retells the diary without the steps has offered an anecdote.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: thesis two lines; target three; argument five; illustration one; qualification two.

- **Structure:** thesis -> target and non-targets -> five-step core -> beetle -> qualification.
- **Doctrine:** private ostensive definition; criterion of correctness.
- **Evidence:** Section 202, 243, 258, 293, 304.
- **Distinction:** logical privacy against secrecy, soliloquy and solitude.
- **Criticism:** the solitary speaker, handled by the public-type criterion.

Solved PYQ 7 · 2025 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: "We should look not to an ideal language which derives its meaning from facts and has a precise 'logical structure but empirically, to the ways in which languages are actually used." Explain the transition from early views of Wittgenstein to his later views on language and meaning with reference to this statement. □ **Printed wording:** the unmatched opening quotation before **logical structure** is visible in the official English line and is retained.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Explain the transition ... with reference to this statement" - anchor every stage to the quotation
Core issue	What exactly is being left behind, and what "empirically" does and does not mean here
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the early position, the pressures, the later account, the method, the verdict
Ideal thesis	The demand for one essence is withdrawn rather than answered differently; clarification survives
Non-negotiables	The printed anomaly retained; the <i>Tractatus</i> did not disparage ordinary language; Section 43's hedge; a ruling

Independent model answer

Thesis. The statement's contrast is accurate in its direction and misleading in one respect: what the later Wittgenstein abandons is not an artificial language in favour of a natural one, but the demand that some single hidden structure explain how any expression means anything.

What the early view actually held. The *Tractatus* - German 1921, bilingual 1922 - gives one general propositional form, sense through the **depiction** of a possible state of affairs, and a shared **logical form** that cannot be said but shows itself. ANALYSIS: Crucially, it does **not** disparage ordinary language: 4.002 and 5.5563 hold everyday propositions to be, just as they stand, in perfect logical order. The "ideal language" of the quoted statement is therefore best read as the demand for a **general logical account of factual sense**, not as a proposal to replace English.

The pressures. Four, and cumulative. Section 23's list of countless language-games defeats one general form. Section 28-31 show that ostension explains a word only where the place is already prepared, so naming cannot ground meaning. Colour exclusion - "this spot is red" against "this spot is green" - strains the independence of elementary propositions and was acknowledged in "Some Remarks on Logical Form" (1929), though it is a pressure rather than a refutation. Section 47 shows that "simple" has sense only relative to a game. **What "empirically" means.** ANALYSIS: Not that philosophy becomes an empirical science. Section 109 replaces explanation with **description**, and Section 122 sets the goal as a **perspicuous representation** that lets us see connections. The investigation is of grammar, conducted by comparison (Section 130-131).

The later account. Section 43 states the thesis with its own limitation. Section 66-67 remove the essence-demand through family resemblance and the spun thread. Section 19 and Section 23 place language-games within a **form of life**, and Section 241-242 locate agreement in judgments rather than opinions. Section 201 shows that no interpretation fixes its own application, and Section 258 turns the result on the inner domain the referential model seemed to fit best.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The transition is from a **theoretical** to a **therapeutic** conception of philosophy: Section 309's aim is to show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle. Its gain is release from the ideal-language model; its costs are the quietism Section 124 invites and an unresolved question about distinguishing correct use from innovation and error. CAUTION: Both books hold philosophy to be clarification, and both consume their own doctrine - the ladder at 6.54, the plural at Section 133.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: anchor each stage to the quoted statement, and correct its one misleading implication early. A twenty-mark transition answer that does not say what the *Tractatus* really held about ordinary language has conceded a caricature.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: thesis two lines; early four; pressures six; "empirically" three; later account five; verdict five.

- **Structure:** thesis -> what the early view held -> the pressures -> the sense of "empirically" -> the later account -> the verdict.
- **Doctrine:** depiction and logical form; use, games, forms of life, rules, private language.
- **Evidence:** 4.002, 5.5563, 6.54; Section 19, 23, 28-31, 43, 47, 66-67, 109, 122, 130-131, 201, 241-242, 258, 309, 124, 133; 1929 paper.
- **Distinction:** essence-demand against theory; description against empirical science.
- **Criticism:** quietism and the normativity of use, both named with their residues.

SUPPORTING ROUTED PARTS THAT BEAR ON THIS CLAUSE BUT ARE OWNED ELSEWHERE

ANALYSIS: The three parts below name Wittgenstein and are frequently mistaken for this clause's property. Each is owned by **Topic 06, Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein**. They are given here with a **contribution-and-boundary block** rather than a full model answer, because writing a full answer to them from this clause would be answering another syllabus item. ANALYSIS: Note that **2021**, the only year in which this clause owns nothing, nevertheless contains a Wittgenstein part - which is exactly why the boundary is worth knowing.

Supporting part A · 2018 · Q3(c) · 15 marks · owned by Topic 06, Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein

Question: How does Wittgenstein apply the distinction between 'saying' and 'showing' to point to a single way of apprehending the most decisive problems of philosophy? Is he justified? Give reasons for your answer.

- **What this clause may contribute:** one sentence noting that the later work abandons the saying/showing machinery along with the general propositional form it depended on, and replaces the single way of apprehending decisive problems with a **plurality** of grammatical methods (Section 133).
- **Boundary:** the doctrine of saying and showing, its relation to logical form, and its role in the *Tractatus*'s treatment of ethics, the mystical and the self are **Topic 06's** to expound.
- **WRONG:** **Do not** import meaning-as-use, language-games or the private-language argument into the body of that answer; they belong at most to a closing sentence on what became of the distinction.

Supporting part B · 2021 · Q4(c) · 15 marks · owned by Topic 06, Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein

Question: What does Wittgenstein mean by the statement - "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent?" Critically discuss.

- **What this clause may contribute:** a closing contrast - the later Wittgenstein does not counsel silence about what cannot be said, but investigates the **grammar** of the words in which we were trying to say it, so that the injunction gives way to therapy (Section 109, 123, 309).
- **Boundary:** the ladder at 6.54, the limits of the sayable and the status of the *Tractatus*'s own propositions belong to **Topic 06**.
- **ANALYSIS: Why it matters here:** 2021 is the only year without a part owned by this clause, and this is that year's Wittgenstein part. Knowing where it belongs is itself a boundary mark.

Supporting part C · 2022 · Q3(c) · 15 marks · owned by Topic 06, Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein

Question: Is there any difference between pictorial form and logical form in Ludwig Wittgenstein's picture theory of language? How does the logical form define the relation between language and reality? Explain.

- **What this clause may contribute:** one sentence recording that the later work does not refine the notion of logical form but withdraws the demand it was introduced to satisfy, replacing determinacy-in-form with determinacy-in-**practice** (Section 201, Section 202).
- **Boundary:** the distinction between pictorial and logical form, and the account of representation it supports, are **Topic 06's** subject-matter.
- **WRONG:** **Do not** answer this part by asserting that the picture theory was refuted; the accurate later claim is that its governing assumption was diagnosed.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: "An ostensive definition can be variously interpreted in every case." Examine the significance of this remark for Wittgenstein's account of meaning.

Independent model answer

Thesis. The remark denies ostension the office it had been given - connecting language to the world from outside every practice - and removes the last refuge of the referential model of meaning.

The argument. Section 28 shows that pointing at two nuts while saying "This is called 'two'" leaves the lesson undetermined: the word might be taken for a number, a colour, a shape, a material or a proper name. Section 29-30 show that the obvious repair - "this *number* is called two" - borrows an understanding of "number", so that "*one has already to know (or be able to do) something in order to be capable of asking a thing's name*". The explanations do not terminate in a self-explaining item.

The positive condition. Section 31 supplies it through the chess-king: being shown the piece and told "This is the king" teaches its use only to someone who knows the shape of a game. The definition works "*when the place is already prepared*", and training (Section 5-6) and correction prepare it.

Significance. ANALYSIS: Meaning cannot be founded on naming, since naming presupposes the practice it was to ground; and a **private** ostensive definition, being ostension stripped of training, correction and prepared place, cannot fix a standard - which is why Section 258 is the heir of Section 28.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Explain the distinction between a criterion and a symptom, and show why Wittgenstein needs it.

Independent model answer

Thesis. The distinction lets Wittgenstein make behaviour constitutive of the *concept* of pain without making pain identical with behaviour; without it, the private-language argument collapses into behaviourism.

The distinction. A **criterion (Kriterium)** is a grammatical ground, taught with the word and fixed by the language-game; a **symptom (Symptom)** is an inductive correlation discovered by experience. The *Blue Book* (dictated 1933-35, published 1958) gives the non-psychological case: we **defined** angina as the illness produced by a particular bacillus, so the bacillus is the criterion and the inflamed throat a symptom. For pain, the criterion is pain-behaviour **in appropriate circumstances**; a raised pulse or an actor's groan is a symptom.

Why it is needed. Without it the argument runs: sensation-words mean by public use, public use is behaviour, therefore "pain" means pain-behaviour - logical behaviourism, refuted by one successful pretence. With it: criteria are **defeasible**, so "he is in pain" is grounded but not entailed, and pretence is predicted rather than a counter-example.

The supporting remarks. Section 580 states that an "inner process" stands in need of outward criteria; Section 304 calls the sensation "*not a something, but not a nothing either*"; Section 307 concedes only a **grammatical** fiction; Section 244 makes the present-tense first-person utterance an **avowal**.

Qualification. ANALYSIS: Section 354 admits that the grammar **fluctuates** between criteria and symptoms, so the distinction is a grammatical role.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: "No course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule." Critically examine Wittgenstein's treatment of this paradox.

Independent model answer

Thesis. The paradox is a **reductio** of the picture on which grasping a rule consists in attaching an interpretation to it; its conclusion is not that rules determine nothing but that rule-following is exhibited in trained practice.

How the paradox is generated. Section 185 imagines a pupil taught the "+2" series to 1000 who continues 1004, 1008, 1012 and protests that he went on "*in the same way*". Repeating the examples does not refute him; it comes natural to him to take the order as we should take "add 2 up to 1000, 4 up to 2000". Nothing already possessed - sign, examples, image, explanation - settles the matter, since each stands in the same need of application.

The diagnosis. Section 201's second part identifies the misunderstanding *"from the mere fact that in the course of our argument we give one interpretation after another; as if each one contented us at least for a moment, until we thought of yet another standing behind it."* Since **interpretation** is glossed as substituting one expression of the rule for another, the regress is structural, and the first step was the error.

The resolution. Section 201's third part asserts *"a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call 'obeying the rule' and 'going against it' in actual cases";* Section 202 adds that obeying a rule is a **practice**.

Two misreadings. ANALYSIS: Treating the paradox as a sceptical result ignores Section 201's own word "misunderstanding". ANALYSIS: Treating community behaviour as the criterion reinstates the collapse of "right" into "seems right", since a practice has **mistakes** where a regularity has exceptions.

Assessment. CAUTION: Kripke (1982) reads Section 201 as a sceptical paradox answered by assertion-conditions plus communal agreement, presenting it as the argument *as it struck him*; Baker, Hacker and McDowell read the text as dissolving rather than conceding. ANALYSIS: The ruling: philosophically valuable, since neither interpretation nor disposition fixes normativity; exegetically doubtful, since a sceptical *solution* is the constructive theory Section 128 and 133 disavow.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: "Philosophy leaves everything as it is." Does this commit Wittgenstein to quietism? Critically discuss.

Independent model answer

Thesis. The remark commits Wittgenstein to a severe restriction on what philosophy may attempt, but not to the political or critical quietism usually inferred from it - though the restriction is real and should be conceded rather than explained away.

The remark in context. Section 124 reads in full: philosophy *"may in no way interfere with the actual use of language; it can in the end only describe it. For it cannot give it any foundation either. It leaves everything as it is."* ANALYSIS: The first clause fixes the scope: what may not be interfered with is the **use of language**. Nothing is said about institutions, laws or social arrangements.

Why the restriction is imposed. Section 38 locates philosophical problems in language **idling** (*wenn die Sprache feiert*); Section 115 diagnoses captivity by a picture that *"lay in our language"*; Section 123 reclassifies the difficulty as *"I don't know my way about"*. If the trouble is disorientation rather than ignorance, then supplying a new theory would be supplying the wrong kind of thing - which is why Section 109 substitutes description for explanation and Section 128 holds that a philosophical thesis could never be debated.

Why it is not passivity. ANALYSIS: The method has identifiable operations: assembling **reminders** (Section 127), finding and inventing **intermediate cases** and producing a **perspicuous representation** that yields *"seeing connections"* (Section 122). Section 133 speaks of **methods**, in the plural, *"like different therapies"*, and locates success in being able to **stop** philosophising when one wants.

The objection at its strongest. ANALYSIS: A critic may grant all this and still observe that Wittgenstein forbids explanatory theory, foundational justification and revisionary legislation over grammar - most of what philosophy has attempted. That is a cost he accepts.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The charge of social conservatism fails, since Section 124's subject is grammar. The charge of disciplinary narrowing succeeds. CAUTION: The deeper difficulty is self-application: the claim that philosophical problems are grammatical confusions is itself general, and Section 133's plural mitigates without removing a problem inherited from the *Tractatus* ladder at 6.54.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: Does the account of language-games and forms of life commit Wittgenstein to relativism? Critically examine, with reference to the notion of agreement in judgments.

Independent model answer

Thesis. It does not, because agreement in judgments operates one level below truth-value, as the condition of determinate assertion rather than as its ground - but the account leaves a genuine gap, which is the absence of any theory of rational adjudication between practices.

The apparent commitment. Section 23 states that speaking a language is part of an activity or of a form of life, and that new games arise while others become obsolete; Section 19 that to imagine a language is to imagine a form of life; Section 217 that justification comes to an end and *"This is simply what I do."* Together these appear to make correctness internal to a practice and practices immune to external criticism.

Section 241's discrimination. The interlocutor puts the objection directly: *"So you are saying that human agreement decides what is true and what is false?"* The reply separates levels - *"It is what human beings say that is true and false; and they agree in the language they use. That is not agreement in opinions but in form of life."*

Section 242's argument. Communication requires agreement not only in definitions but, *"queer as this may sound"*, in **judgments**: if the results of measuring varied wildly from person to person, we should not have *inaccurate* measuring but **no** measuring at all. ANALYSIS: Removing shared judgments does not produce widespread error, which would presuppose a subject-matter; it removes the subject-matter. Disagreement is therefore evidence of a shared practice rather than of its absence.

Three further constraints. ANALYSIS: Forms of life include **natural history**: Section 25 and Section 415 place commanding, questioning and chatting alongside walking and eating, so the background is not wholly conventional. Section 217 marks the terminus of **justification**, not a criterion of correctness, and reading it as "whatever we do is right" reinstates at group level the collapse Section 258 exploits individually. The lion remark, in the material printed as *Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment*, states a condition of intelligibility; Wittgenstein himself describes imagined alien practices, which presupposes that anthropological understanding is possible.

The genuine gap. ANALYSIS: What the text does not supply is any account of how one practice may rationally criticise another; and the sparse occurrence of "form of life" - Section 19, Section 23, Section 241 and PPF - means that elaborate constructions on it are interpretation rather than doctrine.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The relativism charge fails as stated; the honest residue is a silence about rational adjudication, which is a different and more interesting objection.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: What exactly does the private-language argument establish, and what does it leave standing? Critically discuss.

Independent model answer

Thesis. The argument establishes that private ostensive definition cannot found a language, and leaves standing the inner life, the solitary speaker, the felt character of sensation and the first-person asymmetry.

What is established. Section 243 fixes the target: words referring to *"what can only be known to the person speaking; to his immediate private sensations"*, so that another cannot understand the language even in principle. Section 258 tests it: the diarist's inward ostension can only mean that he will remember the connection rightly, *"and here we have no criterion of correctness ... whatever is going to seem right to me is right. And that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'."* Since Section 202 established that obeying a rule is a practice and that thinking one obeys is not obeying, no rule has been created - hence no meaning. Section 265 sharpens it: the internal check is like buying several copies of the same newspaper. Section 270 completes it: once a manometer supplies a public criterion the sign works, and the inner identification becomes irrelevant.

What the beetle adds. Section 293 shows that a private item which might differ in every box, change constantly, or be absent cannot fix the grammar of a **shared** sensation-word - a conclusion expressly conditional on the model of object and designation.

What is left standing. ANALYSIS: (i) Sensations: Section 304 - *"not a something, but not a nothing either!"* (ii) The solitary speaker: logical privacy is the target, and a man alone may use public-type criteria. (iii) The first/third-person asymmetry: Section 244 makes the present-tense first-person utterance an **avowal**, and Section 246 shows that *"I know I am in pain"* is sayable of me only as a joke. (iv) The inner life as a subject of description: Section 580 says the *concept* of an inner process needs outward criteria.

What is contested. CAUTION: The **memory objection**: public checks also use memory. The **community question**: actual community or in-principle shareable standards. The **phenomenological objection**: whether criterial grammar respects the felt character of experience.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The argument is decisive against grounding meaning in the private inner, and is not a proof that mental states are behavioural, that solitude is impossible, or that sensations lack a felt quality. Reported at that strength it is durable; most circulating refutations refute a stronger claim.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Prerequisite check before using this block

ANALYSIS: Nothing below is needed to answer any of the **seven** routed 2018-2025 questions. The Basic block already carries the rule-following paradox in full, the regress of interpretations, Section 202's ban on private rule-following, a one-line summary of Kripke's sceptical reading with its 1982 source and its "as it struck Kripke" caution, the Crusoe objection with the distinction between logical privacy and physical solitude, and the therapeutic conception with the quietism and self-application charges. This block contains only the **second-order** questions that arise once that account is in place, and each is worth at most **one evaluative sentence** in a fifteen- or twenty-mark answer. **WRONG:** Do not open a paragraph with material from here.

A1. Is the "sceptical solution" a legitimate Wittgensteinian move at all? CAUTION:

- **The second-order issue.** Granting the Basic block's account - the paradox, the regress, and Kripke's summary - the further question is whether a **sceptical solution** is a move Wittgenstein's own method permits, or a constructive theory it forbids.
- **Competing readings.** Kripke's sceptical reading with its community-based solution, in which truth-conditions give way to **assertion-conditions**; **anti-sceptical** readings (Baker and Hacker, McDowell) on which Section 201 dissolves rather than endorses the paradox; and **practice-based but non-sceptical** readings that accept the primacy of practice without conceding any scepticism about meaning.
- **Objection.** Kripke turns Wittgenstein into a theory-builder he would reject: Section 128 says a philosophical thesis could never be debated, and Section 133 offers **methods** rather than a doctrine, so an account of what licenses meaning-ascriptions is exactly the wrong shape of thing.
- **Counter-reply.** Even critics concede that the Kripkean sharpening is useful, because it shows with unusual clarity **why** neither a private interpretation nor a bare disposition can by itself fix normativity - which is a service the text performs less explicitly.
- **Safe 15/20 use.** **ANALYSIS:** One short evaluative sentence in a rule-following or private-language answer.
- **WRONG: What not to over-study.** Do not reconstruct the plus/quus literature in exam conditions; the reconstruction is long, and no routed question rewards it.
- **Promotion status. FACT: Partially fired.** The paradox, the regress and the one-line Kripke summary are already **Core** (Session 7). Only the sceptical-solution debate and the plus/quus machinery remain optional.

A2. Does language require an actual community, or only in-principle shareable standards?

CAUTION:

- **The issue.** Does Wittgenstein's argument require that a **community actually exist**, or only that there be standards of correctness that are **in principle shareable**?
- **Competing readings.** A **strong communitarian** reading, on which meaning is constituted by communal agreement; a **public-criteria** reading, on which what matters is the availability of a standard independent of present seeming; and a **solitary-but-trainable** reading, on which an isolated individual could satisfy the requirement.
- **Objection.** A solitary person can plainly follow rules - Crusoe keeps a calendar, repeats a technique, corrects himself against a record.
- **Counter-reply.** Wittgenstein's point is not a **head-count** but the distinction between *seeming right* and *being right*, which requires standards not exhausted by a single moment's private impression. Crusoe's calendar is precisely such a standard, and it is public in **type** even if no one else ever sees it.
- **Safe 15/20 use.** **ANALYSIS:** Use only to refine the private-language critique; it must never replace the diary argument itself.
- **WRONG: What not to over-study.** Do not wander into sociological communitarianism far beyond the text.

- **Promote to Core if:** a future PYQ asks directly whether Wittgenstein makes language essentially social.

A3. Is "meaning is use" a theory of meaning, or a therapeutic reminder? CAUTION:

- **The issue.** Does Section 43 state a **substantive account** of meaning, or is it a reminder directed against philosophical essentialism?
- **Competing readings.** A **quietist/therapeutic** reading, on which the remark is a piece of method; a moderate **positive use-theory**, which treats it as the beginning of an account later developed by others; and a **hybrid** reading, on which Section 43 is a rule of philosophical procedure rather than a universal definition - which is what the hedge "for a large class of cases" most naturally suggests.
- **Objection.** If Wittgenstein offers no theory, his remarks look empty, and the appearance of explanation in the *Investigations* is then an embarrassment rather than a contribution.
- **Counter-reply.** The point is precisely that philosophical clarity often comes from reminders of ordinary grammar rather than from positing hidden mechanisms - and the presence of arguments, comparisons and reductions in the text shows that "no theory" was never "no reasoning".
- **Safe 15/20 use.** ANALYSIS: Works best as the final evaluative note in a transition question (2023, 2025).
- **WRONG: What not to over-study.** Do not import the whole quietism debate into a basic language-games answer.
- **Promote to Core if:** a future PYQ asks directly whether the later Wittgenstein is therapeutic or theoretical.

A4. What the promotion record shows ANALYSIS:

ANALYSIS: The **rule-following paradox itself** and the **one-line Kripke summary** were promoted into Core because a candidate cannot take a defended side on the private-language argument without them; only the second-order evaluative question in A1 remains optional. ANALYSIS: Modules A2 and A3 would be promoted only if a future question asked directly whether language is essentially social, or whether the later philosophy is therapeutic rather than theoretical. ANALYSIS: Stating this ordering is itself a mark of judgement, because it shows the candidate knows which optional material has already earned its place in a core answer and which has not.

Conceptual links - not current-affairs items

ANALYSIS: No dated official or academic development is claimed for this clause. Its live relevance is **disciplinary and static**: meaning-as-use, criteria and forms of life underwrite the present-day agenda of the philosophy of language and mind - pragmatics, use-based and inferentialist semantics, the philosophy of psychology, and debates about rule-following in the theory of content. That is stated as analysis, not as a news event, and no blog or commentary item is promoted to a current-affairs anchor.

Source trail for this block

Ludwig Wittgenstein, *Philosophical Investigations* · Saul Kripke, *Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language* (1982) · Gordon Baker · P. M. S. Hacker · John McDowell · Marie McGinn · Stanley Cavell.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Compressed revision notes for the complete topic. They cover every subtopic in the Basic block and preserve the Basic / Optional-Advanced distinction; they do not repeat the teaching introductions. Read them after the sessions, not instead of them. The complete ASCII master flow diagram closes the package.

A. The clause, its limbs and what is not owned

- **Three printed limbs, one method.** *Meaning and Use* fixes how meaning is to be investigated; *Language-games* is the unit in which use is organised; *Critique of Private Language* is what the investigation does when it is turned on the inner life. Write them in that order, because the third is a **consequence** of the first two.
- **Four indispensable supports** without which the limbs cannot be executed: **ostensive definition** (why pointing is not a foundation), **family resemblance** (why no essence is required), **rule-following** (where normativity comes from), and **therapy** (what the whole exercise is for).
- WRONG: **Not owned:** picture theory, logical atomism, saying and showing, "*Whereof one cannot speak*" as **doctrine** (**Topic 06** - a target here, not a limb) · verification, pseudo-statements, the Vienna Circle (**Topic 07** - a rival, not an ally) · Quine's holism and Strawson's persons (**Topic 11**) · fideist and religious-language uses of *form of life* (**Paper II**) · Ryle, Austin and speech-act theory (broader ordinary-language owners).
- **Corpus signal:** **7 of 112** parts, 2018-2025; **2021** is the only year without an owned part, and that year's Wittgenstein part - 2021 Q4(c), "*Whereof one cannot speak*" - belongs to **Topic 06**.

B. Chronology and provenance - examiner-checked

- **1921** *Logisch-Philosophische Abhandlung* in German; **1922** bilingual *Tractatus*. WRONG: Never date the English text 1921.
- **1922-28** Wittgenstein outside academic philosophy. **1929** returns to Cambridge; "**Some Remarks on Logical Form**" acknowledges **colour exclusion**; the repair fails and he later disowned the paper. **1929-32** conversations with **Schlick** and **Waismann** - he was **never** a Circle member.
- **1933-35** the **Blue and Brown Books** are dictated (*published 1958*). *Source of the criterion/symptom distinction and the angina example*. Say "in the Blue Book*", not "Wittgenstein wrote".
- **1936-49** *Investigations* Part I composed; **1945** preface. **1949-51** the notes later published as **On Certainty***. **1951** Wittgenstein dies, having published one philosophical book and one article.
- **1953** *Philosophical Investigations**, **posthumous**, edited by **G. E. M. Anscombe** and **Rush Rhees**, Anscombe translating, German and English on facing pages; Part I = **Section 1-Section 693**, numbering identical across editions.
- **1969** *On Certainty*. **1982** **Kripke**, *Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language* - "as it struck Kripke"; **Kripkenstein**. **2009** 4th edition revised by **Hacker and Schulte**: Part II renamed **Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment*** and **renumbered**, so cite "Part II Section xi / PPF".
- **1899** the **duck-rabbit** is **Jastrow's**; Wittgenstein reproduces it. WRONG: Never attribute the drawing to him.
- ANALYSIS: **Four marks available from this rail alone:** the posthumous and editorially arranged status of the *Investigations*; the 1921/1922 split; the 2009 renaming and renumbering; and that Kripke's reading is a **reading**.

C. Meaning and use - the thesis and its hedge

- **Section 1** Augustine's picture: every word names an object; sentences combine names; meaning = the correlated object. **Section 2-4** the **builders' language** ("block", "pillar", "slab", "beam") fits it **exactly** - so the picture is **one primitive language-game generalised into an essence**, not a falsehood.
- **Section 11** words are **tools in a tool-box**; **Section 12** locomotive handles look alike and work differently - uniform appearance, diverse function.
- **Section 40** the **bearer** of a name ≠ the **meaning** of a name; **Section 79** proper names handled separately - both show why Section 43 is hedged.
- FACT: **Section 43:** "*For a large class of cases - though not for all - in which we employ the word 'meaning' it can be defined thus: the meaning of a word is its use in the language.*" WRONG: Never quote without the hedge.
- **Use = a norm-governed role** in a practice: circumstances, training, permitted moves, standards of correctness. WRONG: Not frequency · WRONG: not usefulness · WRONG: not the speaker's intention · WRONG: not a licence.
- **Section 199** to understand a language is to be **master of a technique**; **Section 143-155** every candidate inner item can occur without understanding, and understanding without it.

- ANALYSIS: **Live tension, conceded:** how established use is distinguished from **innovation** and from **error** - poetic extension, metaphor, technical redefinition.

D. Ostensive definition, samples and training

- **Section 28** an ostensive definition "*can be variously interpreted in every case*" - number, colour, shape, material, proper name, direction.
- **Section 29-30** the category-word repair borrows the understanding it was to supply: "*one has already to know (or be able to do) something in order to be capable of asking a thing's name.*"
- **Section 31 chess-king:** "This is the king" teaches only one who knows the shape of a game; the definition works **when the place is already prepared**. Preparation = occupying the practice, **not** possessing the concept.
- **Section 5-6 training (Abrichtung)** precedes explanation; the German is the word used for training an animal, and the choice is deliberate - mark this as interpretation.
- **Section 16, Section 50** samples belong to the **means of representation**; the standard metre is neither one metre long nor not - a **role**, not an extraordinary property.
- **Structure:** ambiguity -> failed repair -> prepared place -> **regress** -> **trained action** (the terminus Section 201 names).
- ANALYSIS: **Direct consequence:** private ostension is ostension **minus** training, correction and prepared place. Section 258 is the heir of Section 28.

E. Family resemblance

- **Section 65** the interlocutor's challenge: you never say what the **essence** of language is. Family resemblance is the **reply**, and the 2018 verb "help ... to uphold" asks for that service.
- **Section 66** "*Don't say: 'There must be something common' ... but look and see.*" The survey defeats **amusement, competition, winning and losing, skill, rules, luck**; result = "*a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing.*"
- **Section 67** the name (**family resemblances**: build, features, colour of eyes, gait, temperament) and the **thread**: strength lies in **the overlapping of many fibres**, not in one running the whole length.
- **Section 68** number is itself a family; **Section 69** boundaries are **undrawn**, not hidden, and may be drawn **for a special purpose**; **Section 70** tennis has no rule for throwing height; **Section 71** the indistinct photograph is often **exactly what we need**.
- WRONG: **Four things it does not claim:** that no concept has necessary and sufficient conditions · that no two games share a feature · that definition is worthless · that anything may be called a game.
- **Objection:** everything resembles everything. **Reply:** practice selects the relevant similarities. **Residue:** whether use always bounds the concept tightly enough.

F. Language-games and grammar

- **Section 7** definition: "*the whole, consisting of language and the actions into which it is woven.*"
- **Three uses of the term:** invented primitive languages (Section 2, 8, 48) · the training processes by which language is learned (Section 7) · actual complete practices (Section 23).
- **Section 2 builders; Section 19-20** whether "Slab!" is a word or a sentence is settled by **role**, not by length.
- **Section 130-131** invented games are **objects of comparison**, illuminating by **dissimilarity** as much as by likeness. WRONG: Not simplified models, not hypotheses about origins.
- **Section 23** countless kinds; the multiplicity is **not fixed** - new games arise, old ones are forgotten; the list runs from orders and measurements through hypotheses, tables, story-telling, play-acting, riddles, jokes, arithmetic and translation to asking, thanking, cursing, greeting and **praying**; the closing clause: "*the speaking of language is part of an activity, or of a form of life.*" The **disorder is the argument**, and **describing appears as one item**.
- **Grammar:** Section 371 essence is expressed by grammar · Section 373 grammar tells what kind of object anything is · Section 496 description, not explanation · **Section 664 surface vs depth grammar**.
- **Diagnostic model: Section 350-351** "It is 5 o'clock on the sun" - impeccable surface, **no specified game**; not false. This is the exact verdict-form later used on "S".

G. Forms of life

- **Section 19** "To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life" - said while asking whether "Slab!" is a word or a sentence.
- **Section 23** "the speaking of language is part of an activity, or of a form of life."
- **Section 241** the objection and the reply: "It is what human beings say that is true and false; and they agree in the language they use. That is not agreement in opinions but in form of life."
- **Section 242** agreement in **definitions** and in **judgments**; the test: wildly varying measurement results give **no measuring**, not inaccurate measuring - removal yields **no subject-matter**, not mass error.
- **Section 217** bedrock, spade turned, "This is simply what I do" - a **rule-following** remark; extending it to define form of life is **interpretation**.
- **Section 25, Section 415** commanding, questioning, chatting belong to our **natural history**.
- **Lion remark (Part II Section xi / PPF)**: a condition of **intelligibility**, not a proof of sealed cultures - Wittgenstein describes imagined alien practices throughout.
- **Verdict**: tenable as the **enabling background**; untenable as a theory of truth, of incommensurability, or of ultimate justification. **Gap**: no theory of rational adjudication between practices.

H. Rule-following

- **Section 138-155** understanding "in a flash": no inner item **is** the understanding.
- **Section 185** the pupil at 1000 writes 1004, 1008, 1012 - "But I went on in the same way." The divergence is at the level of **reaction**.
- **Section 201 (i)** "no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule" - and so also to **conflict**, leaving neither accord nor conflict.
- **Section 201 (ii)** the **diagnosis**: we give one interpretation after another; **interpretation** = **substituting one expression of the rule for another**, so the regress is **structural**.
- **Section 201 (iii)** the **resolution**: "a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call 'obeying the rule' and 'going against it' in actual cases."
- **Section 202** obeying a rule is a **practice**; thinking one obeys is not obeying; hence **no private rule-following** - the premise imported into Section 258.
- **ANALYSIS: Normativity ≠ regularity**: a practice has **mistakes** and **standards**; a regularity has exceptions and frequencies. **WRONG**: Community behaviour is **not** the criterion, or "correct" collapses into "usual".
- **Kripke 1982**: sceptical paradox + **sceptical solution**; "as it struck Kripke"; opposed by **Baker and Hacker** and by **McDowell**. Ruling: **valuable, exegetically doubtful**.

I. The critique of private language

- **Section 243** monologuists **set aside** -> the real target: words referring to "what can only be known to the person speaking; to his immediate private sensations", so that **another person cannot understand the language**.
- **WRONG: Four non-targets**: a secret code (a public language encrypted) · talking to oneself · private thoughts · physical **solitude**.
- **Section 258** diary "S"; inward ostension; **no criterion of correctness**; "whatever is going to seem right to me is right" -> "that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'."
- **Section 260** "I believe this is S again" - perhaps you believe that you believe it. **Section 265** several copies of the **same newspaper**; an imagined table is not a table; justification appeals to something **independent**. **Section 270** the **manometer** variant - the sign acquires a use, and **correct inner identification becomes irrelevant**.
- **Section 293 beetle**: contents might **differ, change**, or the box be **empty** -> on the **object-and-designation** model the object **drops out of consideration as irrelevant**. Expressly **conditional**; a supplement to Section 258, not the primary argument.
- **The five-step core**: rule -> criterion of correctness -> none available privately -> "correct" has no application -> no rule, no meaning, **no private language**.

- **Objections and residues: Crusoe** (logical privacy, not solitude; community question CAUTION: disputed) · **memory** (public checks use memory **plus** something independent; the reply is contested CAUTION:) · **behaviourism** (answered in J) · **phenomenology** (Section 293 attacks a **model**; Section 304 protects the phenomenon CAUTION:).

J. Sensation language - criteria, avowals and the behaviourism reply

- **Source:** *Blue Book*, dictated 1933-35, published 1958.
- **Criterion (Kriterium)** grammatical, taught with the word, **defeasible** | **symptom (Symptom)** inductive, discovered by experience.
- **Angina:** the **bacillus** is the criterion (by definition); the **inflamed throat** is a symptom (by experience). **Pain:** pain-behaviour **in appropriate circumstances** is the criterion; a raised pulse or an actor's groan is a symptom.
- **Section 580** "An 'inner process' stands in need of outward criteria." Argument: concept = mastery of a technique -> mastery needs right and wrong -> the circumstances cannot be further **inner** items, since that restarts Section 258 -> therefore **outward** - behaviour, situation, the **surroundings (Umgebung)**.
- **Section 304, 307-308 the reply in four moves:** the denial is of a **picture**, not a phenomenon (Section 304 "not a something, but not a nothing either!") · Section 308 **the decisive movement in the conjuring trick** was made at the step we thought innocent · criteria are **defeasible**, so grammatical dependence ≠ **equivalence** · **first/third-person asymmetry** (Section 244 the verbal expression of pain **replaces** crying; Section 246 "I know I am in pain" is sayable of me only as a joke).
- ANALYSIS: **Not every** first-person psychological sentence is an avowal; past-tense uses are reports.
- **Section 354** the grammar **fluctuates** between criteria and symptoms - take a side: candour about concepts, or an admission that the key notion is not sharp.

K. Solipsism

- **Early:** *Tractatus* 5.6 the limits of my language mean the limits of my world · 5.62 what the solipsist means is **quite correct** but **cannot be said** · 5.64 strictly carried out it **coincides with pure realism**. Mechanism: **saying and showing** (Topic 06's doctrine).
- **Later:** the **route changes** - from the **limit** of language to the **grammar** of the solipsist's words, and from saying/showing to **criterion against mere seeming**.
- **The dilemma:** either his terms are fixed by present seeming -> Section 258 applies, no rule, nothing stated; or they are fixed by stable, repeatable techniques -> he has conceded the **public-type practice** his thesis denies.
- **Support:** Section 244 avowal · Section 246 "only I can know" is false in one way and nonsense in another · Section 293 beetle · Section 580 outward criteria - together dismantling the **asymmetry** the solipsist needs, without an inductive argument for other minds.
- **Verdict: dissolution, not refutation;** the thesis is **self-undermining**. WRONG: Not proved: other minds · the external world · the impossibility of solitude. **Section 303** "try, in a real case, to doubt someone else's pain" concerns where doubt **has application**.

L. Philosophy as therapy

- **Section 38** "philosophical problems arise when language goes on holiday" - German *wenn die Sprache feiert*, i.e. language **idles**, an engine running without load.
- **Section 109** philosophy is "a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language"; **description** replaces explanation.
- **Section 115** "a picture held us captive... it lay in our language" - the captor is a **picture**, and the captivity is linguistic.
- **Section 122** **perspicuous representation (übersichtliche Darstellung)** -> "seeing connections"; find and **invent intermediate cases**. **Section 123** "I don't know my way about" - **disorientation**, not ignorance. **Section 127** assembling **reminders**. **Section 128** theses would be undebatable. **Section 129** hidden by **simplicity and familiarity**.
- **Section 133** "not a philosophical method, though there are indeed methods, like different therapies"; the real discovery makes it possible to **stop**. **Section 255** treatment of an illness. **Section 309** "To show the fly the way out

of the fly-bottle."

- **Section 124** "Philosophy may in no way interfere with the actual use of language... It leaves everything as it is."
ANALYSIS: The **first clause** bounds it: the subject is **grammar**, not society.
- **Three objections: quietism** (bounded, but the discipline is narrowed severely) · **self-application** (real force; mitigated by Section 133's plural; structurally inherited from the *Tractatus* ladder at **6.54**) · **persistent problems** (the reply is **unfalsifiable as stated** - the most serious methodological complaint).

M. Bounded enrichment, comparison and exam craft

- **Aspect-seeing**: Part II Section xi / **PPF**; figure = **Jastrow 1899**; "*I see that it has not changed; and yet I see it differently*"; the **dawning of an aspect (das Aufleuchten eines Aspekts)**; "*half visual experience, half thought*"; seeing the rabbit-aspect presupposes **familiarity with the shape of a rabbit**; **aspect-blindness** links it to the **experience of meaning**. Pressures the innocent **Given** without refuting every acquaintance theory. **Budget**: 10 marks none · 15 marks one sentence · 20 marks two.
- **On Certainty***: notes **1949-51**, published **1969**, **unrevised**; answers **Moore**; **hinge** propositions stand fast and make doubting possible. Compare with Section 241-242 and Section 217 - a **comparison**, not a doctrine of this clause.
- **Comparison grid**: early Wittgenstein (depiction via logical form) · logical positivism (**one criterion**) · Descartes and classical empiricism (**inner foundation**) · later Wittgenstein (**use, no essence**) · Ryle, Austin, Strawson (cousins, separate owners).
- **The triple refusal**: no single **criterion**, no explanatory **theory**, no **legislation** over ordinary use.
- **Criticism ledger, ranked**: self-application · normativity of use · Kripke · quietism · behaviourism · relativism · Crusoe · circularity of practice. Each needs **objection + reply + residue**.
- **Directive decoder**: "discuss use" = the contrast replaced, then the account · "critically examine private language" = five-step core, then criteria/symptoms, then a ruling · "elucidate a remark" = Section , doctrine, work done, and what it does **not** claim · "solipsism" = dissolution without a proof of other minds · "compare early and later" = specific changes and their pressures · "establish tenability" = untenability test, refutation, concession · "assess family resemblance" = denies/permits, objection, reply · "comment / do you agree" = a **defended ruling in line 1**.
- **Printed anomalies to reproduce, never to correct**: **2022** prints "**motion**"; **2025** carries an **unmatched opening quotation** before "logical structure".
- **Answer spine, all lengths**: *state the change of question -> give the limb with its exact texts -> give the support that makes it executable -> name the objection and its residue -> close with a defended ruling*.
- **WRONG: Never write**: that Wittgenstein denied inner mental states (Section 304) · that the private-language argument targets codes or soliloquy · that "meaning is use" is a general definition (Section 43) · that language being public proves other minds exist.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

The complete data-complete ASCII master flow diagram is reproduced below and is byte-identical to the standalone artifact at notes\Final-Learning-Packages\Philosophy Optional\Philosophy Paper I - Western Philosophy\08-Later-Wittgenstein\04-ASCII-Master-Flowchart\ASCII-Master-Flowchart.txt.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/33: THE CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE ONE MOVE THIS CLAUSE MAKES

CENTRAL QUESTION

Stop asking what a word STANDS FOR. Ask what is DONE with it, how that was learned, and what would count as doing it WRONGLY.

|
v

THE ONE MOVE

A word's meaning is investigated through its ROLE in a trained, norm-governed human practice. That single change of question is then turned on the INNER LIFE, and the result is the third printed limb.

|

+-----+ v	+-----+ v	+-----+ v
LIMB 1 MEANING AND USE PI 43, hedged: 'for a large class of cases - though not for all'	LIMB 2 LANGUAGE-GAMES PI 7: language WOVEN INTO an activity. PI 23: count- less kinds; new games arise	LIMB 3 CRITIQUE OF PRIVATE LANGUAGE PI 243-271: private ostension fixes no standard of correctness

ANSWER LINE He does not replace one theory of meaning with another; he replaces the DEMAND FOR A THEORY with the instruction to look at what is done with the word.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/33: OWNER SCOPE, THE FENCE, AND THE CORPUS SIGNAL

OWNED HERE

meaning as use with the 43 hedge; the Augustinian picture as ONE GAME; words as tools; understanding as mastery of a technique; ostensive definition and the prepared place; samples; family resemblance and the thread; language-games, the builders and the 23 list; grammar, surface and depth; forms of life, agreement in judgments, bedrock; the rule-following paradox and its resolution; the private-language target, the diary, the beetle; criteria against symptoms, 580, avowals, the behaviourism reply; philosophy as therapy; the break from the Tractatus; ALL SEVEN routed parts

NOT OWNED - name in one clause, then stop

PICTURE THEORY, LOGICAL ATOMISM,

SAYING/SHOWING, 'WHEREOF ONE

CANNOT SPEAK' TOPIC 06 a TARGET here, not a limb

VERIFICATION, PSEUDO-STATEMENTS,

THE VIENNA CIRCLE TOPIC 07 a RIVAL, not an ally

TWO DOGMAS, HOLISM, PERSONS TOPIC 11 Quine and Strawson

FIDEISM, RELIGIOUS LANGUAGE PAPER II Religious Language

RYLE, AUSTIN, SPEECH ACTS broader ordinary-language owners

CORPUS SIGNAL 7 owned parts of 112, 2018-2025. 2021 is the ONLY year without one - and that year's Wittgenstein part, 2021 Q4(c), belongs to TOPIC 06.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/33: PROVENANCE AND CHRONOLOGY - ALMOST EVERYTHING IS POSTHUMOUS

1921 Logisch-Philosophische Abhandlung, GERMAN
1922 Bilingual TRACTATUS LOGICO-PHILOSOPHICUS X never date the English 1921
1922-28 Wittgenstein outside academic philosophy
1929 Returns to Cambridge. 'Some Remarks on Logical Form' acknowledges COLOUR EXCLUSION. The repair fails; he later DISOWNED the paper
1929-32 Conversations with SCHLICK and WAISMANN. NEVER a Circle member
1933-35 THE BLUE AND BROWN BOOKS are DICTATED (published 1958). Source of CRITERION / SYMPTOM and the ANGINA example. Say 'in the Blue Book'
1936-49 Investigations Part I composed and rearranged; 1945 preface
1949-51 The notes later published as ON CERTAINTY
1951 WITTGENSTEIN DIES. One philosophical book and one article published
1953 PHILOSOPHICAL INVESTIGATIONS - POSTHUMOUS. Editors ANSCOMBE and RHEES; Anscombe translating; facing pages. Part I = 693 numbered remarks
1958 The Blue and Brown Books | 1969 ON CERTAINTY (Ueber Gewissheit)
1982 KRIPKE, Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language - 'as it struck Kripke'. Standard shorthand: KRIPKENSTEIN
2009 4th edn revised by HACKER and SCHULTE. Part II renamed PHILOSOPHY OF PSYCHOLOGY - A FRAGMENT and RENUMBERED. Cite 'Part II xi / PPF'
1899 The DUCK-RABBIT figure is JASTROW'S. Wittgenstein reproduces it
FOUR CHEAP MARKS posthumous + editorial arrangement | 1921/1922 | the 2009 renaming and renumbering | Kripke's reading IS A READING

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/33: THE EARLY POSITION BEING REVISED - STATED ACCURATELY

TRACTATUS CONTENTS THAT MATTER HERE

- * ONE GENERAL PROPOSITIONAL FORM: 'This is how things stand'
- * SENSE = DEPICTION of a possible state of affairs
- * PROPOSITION and FACT share a LOGICAL FORM, which cannot be SAID but SHOWS
- * ANALYSIS terminates in SIMPLE OBJECTS

- * ELEMENTARY PROPOSITIONS are LOGICALLY INDEPENDENT
- * SOLIPSISM at 5.62: what the solipsist MEANS is correct but CANNOT BE SAID; 5.64 strictly carried out it COINCIDES WITH PURE REALISM
- * 4.002 / 5.5563 EVERYDAY PROPOSITIONS ARE, JUST AS THEY STAND, IN PERFECT LOGICAL ORDER

WHY THE LAST TWO BULLETS MATTER

They kill the two commonest caricatures: that the early book DISPARAGED ordinary language, and that it IGNORED the self.

ANSWER LINE The 'ideal language' the later work leaves behind is the DEMAND FOR A GENERAL LOGICAL ACCOUNT OF FACTUAL SENSE - not a proposal to replace English.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/33: FIVE COMMITMENTS DROPPED - AND THE REASON EACH FELL

=====	
COMMITMENT	WHY IT COULD NOT BE HELD
1 ONE GENERAL PROPOSITIONAL FORM	PI 23: ordering, describing, measuring, reporting, hypothesising, story-telling, play-acting, riddling, joking, translating, asking, thanking, cursing, greeting, PRAYING. No one form covers this
2 SENSE = DEPICTION VIA LOGICAL FORM	'game' pictures nothing single; nor do 'the', 'if', 'five', 'perhaps', 'meaning', 'pain'. Picturing is ONE thing language does, not what it IS
3 NAMES MEAN BY STANDING FOR OBJECTS (Augustinian picture)	PI 28-32: the same pointing can teach colour, shape, number, material, direction. Naming needs a PLACE ALREADY PREPARED
4 ELEMENTARY PROPOSITIONS ARE LOGICALLY INDEPENDENT	COLOUR EXCLUSION: 'this spot is red' and 'this spot is green' cannot both be true, yet neither looks further analysable. 'Some Remarks on Logical Form', 1929. CAUTION: a PRESSURE, not a refutation - and he disowned that paper
5 ANALYSIS TERMINATES IN SIMPLES	No Tractarian simple was ever exhibited. PI 47: 'simple' and 'composite' have sense only RELATIVE TO A GAME. Is a chair simple?
TRAP X 'colour exclusion refuted the Tractatus' X 'he moved from an ideal to an ordinary language'	

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/33: WHAT DOES NOT CHANGE - THE FOUR CONTINUITIES

=====		
CONTINUITY	EARLY STATEMENT	LATER STATEMENT
Philosophy is an ACTIVITY	clarification, not a body of doctrine	109 'a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language'
Trouble comes from MISREADING LANGUAGE	4.002 the outward form of language DISGUISES the thought	115 'A PICTURE HELD US CAPTIVE'; 38 language IDLES
Ordinary language is NOT the culprit	5.5563 everyday props are in PERFECT LOGICAL ORDER	124 'philosophy LEAVES EVERYTHING AS IT IS'
The book CONSUMES ITSELF	6.54 throw away the LADDER after climbing	133 no philosophical METHOD, but METHODS, LIKE DIFFERENT THERAPIES
FIRST-CLASS OBSERVATION The SELF-APPLICATION problem is structurally the SAME in both books - a difficulty INHERITED, not acquired.		
ANSWER LINE The later work retains the aim of dissolving confusion and abandons the assumption that dissolving it requires ONE HIDDEN ESSENCE.		

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/33: THE AUGUSTINIAN PICTURE AND ITS TRUE STATUS

=====	
PI 1 Augustine's Confessions: elders name objects, move towards them, the child grasps that the sound STANDS FOR the thing.	
-> 'a particular picture of the ESSENCE of human language': every word names an object; sentences COMBINE names; the meaning IS the object.	
	v
PI 2-4 THE ANSWER IS NOT A REFUTATION. He BUILDS a language the picture fits: A calls 'Slab!' 'Block!' 'Pillar!' 'Beam!'; B brings the stone he has learnt to bring. 'Conceive this as a COMPLETE PRIMITIVE LANGUAGE.'	
	v
VERDICT The picture is ONE PRIMITIVE LANGUAGE-GAME MISTAKEN FOR THE ESSENCE OF ALL LANGUAGE. Not false - OVER-GENERALISED.	
X TRAP 'Wittgenstein refuted Augustine's theory of meaning' throws away the characteristic later move: SHRINK an alleged essence into ONE CASE AMONG MANY.	

WHERE THE PICTURE COLLAPSES 'the' | 'if' | 'not' | 'five' | 'perhaps' |
 'meaning' | 'pain' <- and 'pain' is the LAST REFUGE, dealt with at 243-271.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/33: MEANING AS USE - PI 43 WITH ITS ARCHITECTURE EXPOSED

'For a large class of cases - THOUGH NOT FOR ALL - in which we employ the word
 "meaning" it can be defined thus: the meaning of a word is its USE IN THE
 LANGUAGE.'

SCOPE LIMITER	WHAT IS BEING DEFINED	THE DEFINITION
'a large class of cases, though not for all'	our EMPLOYMENT of the word 'meaning' - not a metaphysical entity called Meaning	USE = the NORM-GOVERNED ROLE of an expression in a practice

FOUR REFUSALS - each worth a line in an answer

X use is NOT frequency of employment X use is NOT usefulness
 X use is NOT whatever the speaker likes X 43 is NOT a universal definition
 WHY THE HEDGE IS DOCTRINE 40 separates the BEARER of a name from its MEANING
 (when Mr N. N. dies the name does not become meaningless); 79 treats proper
 names separately.
 WORKED CASE 'Water!' at a fire = alarm | at a table = request | on a phial =
 label | at a formula = identification. SAME SOUND, FOUR JOBS, NO FIFTH THING.
 X TRAP Quoting 43 without the hedge is the commonest misquotation in the item.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/33: TOOLS, LEVERS, AND UNDERSTANDING AS MASTERY OF A TECHNIQUE

PI 11 'Think of the TOOLS IN A TOOL-BOX: there is a hammer, pliers, a saw, a
 screwdriver, a rule, a glue-pot, glue, nails and screws. The FUNCTIONS OF WORDS
 ARE AS DIVERSE AS THE FUNCTIONS OF THESE OBJECTS.'

PI 12 In a locomotive cab the HANDLES ALL LOOK ALIKE: one is a crank movable
 continuously, one a switch with two positions, one a brake-lever that resists
 more the harder it is pulled. UNIFORM APPEARANCE, DIFFERENT FUNCTION.

|
v

UNDERSTANDING (143-155, 199)

199 'To understand a sentence means to understand a language. To understand
 a language means to be MASTER OF A TECHNIQUE.'

151-152 the inner FLASH can occur and be followed by FAILURE; fluent
 understanding often involves NO such episode -> the flash was never the
 criterion

THE ARGUMENT SHAPE, USED FOUR TIMES IN THIS CLAUSE: propose an inner item as
 what a mental achievement CONSISTS IN -> produce a case with the item and
 without the achievement -> and a case with the achievement and without the
 item -> the identification fails.

GUARD This is NOT behaviourism: performance is DEFEASIBLE in BOTH directions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/33: OSTENSIVE DEFINITION - THE AMBIGUITY ARGUMENT

THE TEACHER POINTS AT TWO NUTS AND SAYS 'This is called "two"'

NUMBER	COLOUR	SHAPE	MATERIAL	THIS PAIR	DIRECTION
(as it happens)	(why not?)	(why not?)	(why not?)	(a name)	(the finger does point)

PI 28 'An ostensive definition CAN BE VARIOUSLY INTERPRETED IN EVERY CASE.'

|
v

THE APPARENT REPAIR (29-30) 'This NUMBER is called two' - works only if
 'number' is already understood; if that is explained ostensively, the same
 ambiguity recurs.

30 'ONE HAS ALREADY TO KNOW (OR BE ABLE TO DO) SOMETHING IN ORDER TO BE
 CAPABLE OF ASKING A THING'S NAME.'

EXACT STRENGTH NOT scepticism about ostension. Ostensive teaching WORKS. The
 claim is that THE POINTING IS NOT WHAT DOES THE WORK.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/33: THE PREPARED PLACE, TRAINING AND THE REGRESS

PI 31 'When one shows someone the king in chess and says: "This is the king",
 this does not tell him the use of this piece - UNLESS HE ALREADY KNOWS THE
 RULES OF THE GAME UP TO THIS LAST POINT: the shape of the king.'

-> the definition explains the use WHEN THE PLACE IS ALREADY PREPARED

WHAT 'PREPARED' MEANS

WHAT IT DOES NOT MEAN

occupying the PRACTICE: attending,
 imitating, being corrected,

X already possessing the CONCEPT being
 taught - that would be viciously

recognising that a word is being circular and make learning impossible
introduced for a role

PI 5-6 TRAINING (ABRICHTUNG) precedes explanation. The German is the word used
for training an ANIMAL; the choice is deliberate and the point is that the
primitive stage is PRE-EXPLANATORY. [mark this as interpretation]

|
v

THE REGRESS every explanation stands in need of an explanation OF THE SAME
KIND -> the series does NOT end in a self-explaining item -> it ends in
SOMETHING ONE DOES.

-> PI 201 'a way of grasping a rule which is NOT AN INTERPRETATION'

-> PI 217 'This is simply what I do'

CONSEQUENCE FOR LIMB 3 private ostension = ostension MINUS training, MINUS
correction, MINUS a prepared place.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/33: SAMPLES BELONG TO THE MEANS OF REPRESENTATION

=====

PI 16 If colour samples are shown ALONG WITH the words in a language-game, it
is most natural to count the SAMPLES AS PART OF THE LANGUAGE - not as objects
the language is about.

PI 50 Of the STANDARD METRE in Paris one can say NEITHER that it is one metre
long NOR that it is not - 'this is, of course, not to ascribe any extraordinary
property to it, but only to mark its PECULIAR ROLE IN THE LANGUAGE-GAME OF
MEASURING with a metre-rule'.

|
v

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR THE THIRD LIMB

If a sample were an ORDINARY OBJECT whose nature fixed the word's
application, a PRIVATE sample - a remembered sensation - might do the same
job in a private language. 50 removes that possibility IN ADVANCE: a sample
is a STANDARD only because a PRACTICE of comparing, applying and correcting
has given it that office.

WHAT SURVIVES ostension WORKS; samples are INDISPENSABLE instruments. What
fails is only the PHILOSOPHICAL OFFICE of grounding meaning from outside all
practice.

ANSWER LINE Meaning is constrained but not arbitrary: NO ESSENCE IS NOT NO NORM.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 13/33: FAMILY RESEMBLANCE - THE CHALLENGE AND THE SURVEY

=====

PI 65 THE INTERLOCUTOR'S CHALLENGE: 'You talk about language-games but nowhere
say what the ESSENCE of a language-game, and hence of language, is. You let
yourself off the very part of the investigation that once gave you most
trouble.' -> FAMILY RESEMBLANCE IS THE REPLY. Its job is ARGUMENTATIVE.

|
v

PI 66 'Don't say: "There MUST be something common, or they would not be called
'games"' - but LOOK AND SEE whether there is anything common to all.'

THE SURVEY, CANDIDATE BY CANDIDATE

AMUSEMENT fails: an Olympic final is not amusement for the player

COMPETITION fails: patience, ring-a-ring-a-roses

WINNING / LOSING .. fails: ring-a-ring; and in patience one wins against the
CARDS - the sense shifts

SKILL fails: dice

RULES fails as a UNIFORM requirement: throwing a ball at a wall

LUCK fails: chess

RESULT 'A COMPLICATED NETWORK OF SIMILARITIES OVERLAPPING AND CRISS-CROSSING;
sometimes overall similarities, sometimes similarities of detail.'

METHOD NOTE This IS 109's 'description, not explanation' in operation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 14/33: THE THREAD, AND THE EXACT STATUS OF THE BOUNDARY

=====

PI 67 'I can think of no better expression to characterise these similarities
than FAMILY RESEMBLANCES; for the various resemblances between members of a
family - BUILD, FEATURES, COLOUR OF EYES, GAIT, TEMPERAMENT, etc. etc. -
overlap and criss-cross in the same way.'

THE THREAD 'we extend our concept ... as in SPINNING A THREAD we twist fibre on
fibre. And THE STRENGTH OF THE THREAD DOES NOT RESIDE IN THE FACT THAT SOME ONE
FIBRE RUNS THROUGH ITS WHOLE LENGTH, BUT IN THE OVERLAPPING OF MANY FIBRES.'

-> STRENGTH WITHOUT A CORE. This single image answers the anxiety that a
concept without an essence must fall apart.

THE BOUNDARY (68-71)

68 NUMBER is itself a family: cardinal, rational, real - fibres, not species

69 We can DRAW a boundary FOR A SPECIAL PURPOSE. We do not know the
boundaries BECAUSE NONE HAVE BEEN DRAWN - not because they are HIDDEN

70 'But then the use of the word is unregulated!' - it is not EVERYWHERE
circumscribed by rules; NOR IS TENNIS, which has no rule for how high one

may throw the ball - and tennis is still a game
 71 'Is an INDISTINCT PHOTOGRAPH always preferable to a sharp one? Isn't the
 indistinct one OFTEN EXACTLY WHAT WE NEED?'
 X TRAP 'the boundary is unknown because it is hidden' restores the essence-
 demand in epistemic clothing.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 15/33: FOUR DENIALS, THE STANDARD OBJECTION, AND THE SERVICE RENDERED

=====

FOUR THINGS THE DOCTRINE DOES NOT CLAIM - each is a marked error
 X that NO concept has necessary and sufficient conditions ('triangle' does)
 X that no two games have anything in common (many share several features)
 X that definition is impossible or worthless
 X that ANYTHING may therefore be called a game
 THE OBJECTION Everything resembles everything in SOME respect: a chair
 resembles chess in being man-made. A network of 'similarities' constrains
 nothing.
 THE REPLY RELEVANCE IS FIXED BY THE PRACTICE, not by bare resemblance - by what
 we do with games, how the word is taught, which extensions are ACCEPTED and
 which are CORRECTED. The concept is bounded by USE, not by definition.
 THE RESIDUE Whether use bounds it tightly enough in EVERY case is genuinely
 open. Concede it: that is the 'critically' mark.
 THE SERVICE RENDERED - the 2018 answer in four steps
 1 THE DEMAND DISARMED refusing to define 'language' is no longer a defect
 2 THE ANALOGY EARNED 'game' IS the paradigm family-resemblance concept
 3 THE PICTURE SUPPLIED games have TRAINING, RULES, MOVES and STANDARDS
 WITHOUT an essence - exactly what the Tractatus
 thought only a shared LOGICAL FORM could give
 4 RELATIVISM BLOCKED games are norm-governed, so meaning is not arbitrary

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 16/33: LANGUAGE-GAMES - THE DEFINITION AND THE THREE USES

=====

PI 7 'I shall also call THE WHOLE, CONSISTING OF LANGUAGE AND THE ACTIONS INTO
 WHICH IT IS WOVEN, the "language-game".'
 -> the unit of investigation is NEVER the sentence alone: it is
 SENTENCE + CIRCUMSTANCE + ACTIVITY + RESPONSE
 USE 1 INVENTED PRIMITIVE LANGUAGES 2, 8, 48, 130-131
 STATUS (130-131): OBJECTS OF COMPARISON, 'meant to throw light on the
 features of our language by way NOT ONLY OF SIMILARITIES BUT ALSO OF
 DISSIMILARITIES'. X not simplified models X not hypotheses about origins
 USE 2 THE TRAINING PROCESSES BY WHICH LANGUAGE IS LEARNED 7
 naming, repeating after someone, pointing and saying
 USE 3 ACTUAL COMPLETE PRACTICES 23
 WHY THE WORD 'GAME' WAS CHOSEN
 games are the paradigm of something RULE-GOVERNED WITHOUT AN ESSENCE; they
 have MOVES; they involve TRAINING; a move is intelligible only WITHIN the game
 WHAT THE WORD DOES NOT CARRY X triviality X arbitrary invention X competition
 The objection 'language is too serious to be a game' trades on exactly the
 connotations he does not use.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 17/33: THE BUILDERS, WORKED RATHER THAN TOLD

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A (builder)	calls 'Slab!'	---->	B (assistant)	brings a slab
	calls 'Block!'	---->		brings a block
	calls 'Pillar!'	---->		brings a pillar
	calls 'Beam!'	---->		brings a beam

FOUR WORDS. NO SENTENCES OF THE SCHOOLBOOK KIND. 'Conceive this as a COMPLETE
 PRIMITIVE LANGUAGE.'
 WHAT IT ESTABLISHES
 1 a language can be COMPLETE FOR ITS PURPOSE without DESCRIBING anything
 2 'Slab!' is nearer an ORDER than a label; its meaning is its ROLE in the
 transaction
 3 meaning is displayed in the TRAINED RESPONSE - B's bringing the slab
 4 Augustine's picture fits THIS game exactly - which fixes its true status
 PI 19-20 IS 'Slab!' A WORD OR A SENTENCE?
 It may be an elliptical form of 'Bring me a slab' - OR our 'elliptical'
 sentence may be a LENGTHENED form of theirs. Wittgenstein refuses to settle
 it by fiat: WHAT MAKES IT AN ORDER IS ITS PLACE IN THE PRACTICE, NOT ITS
 LENGTH. <- this is where the example turns from illustration into ARGUMENT

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 18/33: PI 23 - THE LIST, ITS HISTORICITY AND ITS CLOSING CLAUSE

=====

'How many kinds of sentence are there? ... THERE ARE COUNTLESS KINDS ... And
 this multiplicity is NOT SOMETHING FIXED, GIVEN ONCE FOR ALL; but NEW TYPES OF
 LANGUAGE, NEW LANGUAGE-GAMES, as we may say, COME INTO EXISTENCE, and others
 BECOME OBSOLETE AND GET FORGOTTEN.'
 THE LIST - deliberately disorderly

giving orders and obeying them | describing the appearance of an object or giving its measurements | constructing an object from a description (a drawing) | reporting an event | speculating about an event | forming and testing a hypothesis | presenting the results of an experiment in tables and diagrams | making up a story, and reading it | play-acting | singing catches | guessing riddles | making a joke, telling it | solving a problem in practical arithmetic | translating from one language into another | ASKING, THANKING, CURSING, GREETING, PRAYING

THE CLOSING CLAUSE 'the speaking of language is PART OF AN ACTIVITY, OR OF A FORM OF LIFE' <- the textual bridge the 2022 answer must quote

THREE CONSEQUENCES

- 1 the DISORDER IS THE ARGUMENT against one essence
- 2 DESCRIBING is ONE ITEM - demoted from the paradigm it was in the Tractatus and in logical positivism
- 3 LANGUAGE IS HISTORICAL - conceptual change without a theory of it

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 19/33: GRAMMAR - ESSENCE, SURFACE AND DEPTH, AND THE DIAGNOSTIC

371 'ESSENCE IS EXPRESSED BY GRAMMAR.'
373 'GRAMMAR TELLS WHAT KIND OF OBJECT ANYTHING IS.'
-> the metaphysical question 'what IS an X?' becomes 'HOW IS THE WORD X USED?'
496 grammar does not EXPLAIN but DESCRIBES the use of signs
664 SURFACE GRAMMAR (how a word is constructed, what part of speech it seems)
vs DEPTH GRAMMAR (its actual employment). 'I mean...' and 'I intend...'
look alike on the surface and differ in depth.

|
v

THE DIAGNOSTIC MODEL 350-351 'IT IS 5 O'CLOCK ON THE SUN'
grammatically IMPECCABLE and NO GAME HAS BEEN SPECIFIED
our practice of telling the time is tied to a PLACE and the SUN'S POSITION
VERDICT NOT FALSE. NOT UNVERIFIABLE. NO SPECIFIED USE.
X TRAP reaching for 'meaningless because unverifiable' here imports TOPIC 07's
criterion and forfeits the boundary in any comparison question.
WHY IT MATTERS THIS IS THE EXACT VERDICT-FORM LATER PASSED ON THE DIARIST'S 'S'.
89 Augustine on time: 'If no one asks me, I know; if I wish to explain it to
one who asks, I know not' - the classic case of the same phenomenon.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 20/33: FORMS OF LIFE - THE FOUR JOBS THE NOTION DOES

JOB 1 COMPLETES THE ACCOUNT OF LANGUAGE-GAMES 19, 23
19 'TO IMAGINE A LANGUAGE MEANS TO IMAGINE A FORM OF LIFE' - said while
asking whether the builders' 'Slab!' is a word or a sentence
23 'the speaking of language is PART OF an activity, or of a form of life'
JOB 2 ANSWERS THE RELATIVISM CHARGE 241, 242
JOB 3 MARKS WHERE JUSTIFICATION STOPS 211, 217
217 'If I have exhausted the justifications I have reached BEDROCK, and my
spade is turned. Then I am inclined to say: THIS IS SIMPLY WHAT I DO.'
CAUTION: 217 is a RULE-FOLLOWING remark. Using it to DEFINE form of life is
an interpretive EXTENSION - mark it as one.
JOB 4 SETS THE LIMIT OF INTELLIGIBILITY PPF / II xi
'IF A LION COULD TALK, WE COULD NOT UNDERSTAND HIM.'
SAYS vocabulary alone does not confer understanding where activities,
reactions and natural history diverge far enough
DOES NOT SAY that cultures are sealed, that translation is impossible, or
that cross-practice criticism is illegitimate. LIONS ARE NOT A CULTURE.
SPARSE-OCCURRENCE CAUTION the phrase occurs a handful of times: 19, 23, 241 and
PPF. Any large doctrine built on it is INTERPRETATION, not stated theory.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 21/33: AGREEMENT IN JUDGMENTS - THE PASSAGE THAT DOES THE WORK

241 INTERLOCUTOR: 'So you are saying that HUMAN AGREEMENT DECIDES what is true
and what is false?'
REPLY: 'IT IS WHAT HUMAN BEINGS SAY THAT IS TRUE AND FALSE; AND THEY AGREE
IN THE LANGUAGE THEY USE. THAT IS NOT AGREEMENT IN OPINIONS BUT IN FORM OF
LIFE.'
242 'If language is to be a means of communication there must be agreement not
only in DEFINITIONS but also (QUEER AS THIS MAY SOUND) IN JUDGMENTS.'
THE TEST: if the results of MEASURING varied wildly from person to person,
we should NOT have INACCURATE MEASURING - we should have NO MEASURING.

|
v

THE ASYMMETRY THAT SETTLES THE QUESTION
remove the shared background -> you do NOT get widespread ERROR
(error presupposes a subject-matter)
-> you get NO SUBJECT-MATTER AT ALL
THEREFORE agreement operates ONE LEVEL BELOW truth-value: it is the CONDITION

OF DETERMINATE ASSERTION, not its GROUND.
 THEREFORE disagreement - including radical disagreement - is EVIDENCE OF a shared practice, not evidence against one.
 WORKED PICTURE two people can argue whether the table is 180 or 182 cm; they cannot argue whether laying a rule alongside it is how length is settled.

ASCT MASTER FLOW - PANEL 22/33: BEDROCK, NATURAL HISTORY, AND THE TENABILITY VERDICT

NATURAL HISTORY 25 'COMMANDING, ASKING, RECOUNTING, CHATTING are as much a part of our NATURAL HISTORY as walking, eating, drinking, playing.' 415 'what we are supplying are really REMARKS ON THE NATURAL HISTORY OF HUMAN BEINGS.'
 TWO READINGS - name both, then take a side
 NATURALIST / ANTHROPOLOGICAL CULTURALIST
 shared natural history: reactions, 'forms of life' in the plural:
 the human body, common needs, historically specific religious,
 primitive behaviour scientific and legal practices
 anchors: 25, 415 anchors: the plural occurrences;
 23's historicity; manifest variety
 RECOMMENDED the readings are NOT exclusive: the SHAPE of the background is natural, its CONTENT largely cultural.
 THE TENABILITY TABLE (2022 asks you to ESTABLISH it)
 WOULD BE UNTENABLE IF WHY IT DOES NOT FOLLOW STILL OPEN
 consensus made claims true 241 separates the levels; is the line
 242's asymmetry always sharp?
 practices were immune to shared natural history and no theory of
 criticism comparison give purchase ADJUDICATION
 it rested on a rare phrase the work is done by 241-242 how much weight
 and 23, which are ARGUED the phrase bears
 VERDICT TENABLE as the ENABLING BACKGROUND. UNTENABLE as a theory of truth, of incommensurability, or of ultimate justification.

ASCT MASTER FLOW - PANEL 23/33: RULE-FOLLOWING - THE SETTING AND THE PUPIL AT 1000

THE TEMPTING PICTURE to follow a rule is to have it IN MIND and DERIVE each application; meaning something determines every future step in advance.
 THE PRESSURE (138-155)
 * the formula does not APPLY ITSELF * the examples are FINITE
 * a mental picture is ANOTHER SIGN, needing application in turn (139-141)
 * the 'aha!' can occur and be followed by FAILURE (151-155)
 |
 v
 PI 185 THE PUPIL
 taught the natural numbers, then '+2' up to 1000. Asked to continue, he writes
 ... 996 998 1000 1004 1008 1012
 We say: LOOK WHAT YOU HAVE DONE. He replies: 'BUT I WENT ON IN THE SAME WAY.'
 Repeating the examples does not refute him: 'IT COMES NATURAL TO THIS PERSON TO UNDERSTAND OUR ORDER WITH OUR EXPLANATIONS AS WE SHOULD UNDERSTAND THE ORDER: "Add 2 up to 1000, 4 up to 2000, 6 up to 3000 and so on."
 WHAT THE CASE SHOWS NOT that the pupil is right. NOT that we cannot correct him. THAT THE CORRECTION CANNOT BE DERIVED from anything already possessed - sign, examples, image, or further explanation.
 NOTE THE PHRASE 'it comes NATURAL to this person' locates the divergence at the level of REACTION - which is where the form-of-life background does its work.

ASCT MASTER FLOW - PANEL 24/33: PI 201 IN THREE PARTS - THE REDUCTIO

(i) THE PARADOX
 'THIS WAS OUR PARADOX: no course of action could be determined by a rule, because EVERY COURSE OF ACTION CAN BE MADE OUT TO ACCORD WITH THE RULE.'
 'If everything can be made out to accord with the rule, then it can also be made out to CONFLICT with it. And so there would be NEITHER ACCORD NOR CONFLICT here.'
 (ii) THE DIAGNOSIS
 'It can be seen that there is a MISUNDERSTANDING here from the mere fact that in the course of our argument we GIVE ONE INTERPRETATION AFTER ANOTHER; as if each one contented us at least for a moment, until we thought of yet another standing behind it.'
 KEY GLOSS INTERPRETATION = 'THE SUBSTITUTION OF ONE EXPRESSION OF THE RULE FOR ANOTHER'. Because an interpretation is ANOTHER EXPRESSION, it stands in exactly the need it was introduced to satisfy -> THE REGRESS IS STRUCTURAL -> THE FIRST STEP WAS THE MISTAKE.
 (iii) THE RESOLUTION
 'There is A WAY OF GRASPING A RULE WHICH IS NOT AN INTERPRETATION, but which is EXHIBITED IN WHAT WE CALL "OBEYING THE RULE" AND "GOING AGAINST IT" IN ACTUAL CASES.'
 X FATAL OMISSION quoting (i) and stopping converts a REDUCTIO into SCEPTICISM.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 25/33: PI 202, AND NORMATIVITY AGAINST REGULARITY

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PI 202  "OBEYING A RULE" IS A PRACTICE. AND TO THINK ONE IS OBEYING A RULE IS
NOT TO OBEY A RULE. HENCE IT IS NOT POSSIBLE TO OBEY A RULE "PRIVATELY":
otherwise THINKING one was obeying a rule would be THE SAME THING AS OBEYING IT.'
-> this does TWO jobs: it names the terminus of the rule-following argument,
    AND it announces the private-language argument FORTY REMARKS IN ADVANCE.
    258 IS 202 APPLIED TO A SENSATION-WORD.
PI 217  justifications exhausted, spade turned: 'THIS IS SIMPLY WHAT I DO.'
PI 211  reasons soon give out - and then I ACT, without reasons.
        |
        v
NORMATIVITY != REGULARITY - the discrimination that carries the most marks
REGULARITY      PRACTICE
described from OUTSIDE involves STANDARDS by which a performance
                    is CRITICISED
has EXCEPTIONS    has MISTAKES - failures by a standard the
                    agent himself acknowledges when shown
shared by a CROWD  a STANDARD can be misapplied by the WHOLE
                    CROWD AT ONCE

X THE MOST DAMAGING SENTENCE AVAILABLE 'for Wittgenstein, correctness is
whatever the community agrees on' - it recreates at GROUP level exactly the
collapse of 'right' into 'seems right' that 258 exploits at INDIVIDUAL level.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 26/33: KRIPKE 1982 - REPORT IT, THEN RULE ON IT

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THE READING Kripke, WITTGENSTEIN ON RULES AND PRIVATE LANGUAGE, 1982
201 read as a SCEPTICAL PARADOX: no fact about my past usage, dispositions or
mental history CONSTITUTES my having meant ADDITION rather than the deviant
function usually called QUADDITION - hence no fact makes '125' rather than
'5' the correct answer to '68 + 57'.
Answered by a SCEPTICAL SOLUTION: abandon truth-conditions for ASSERTION-
CONDITIONS; what licenses ascribing meaning is COMMUNAL AGREEMENT.
THREE THINGS TO SAY - three sentences, and the scholarship mark is secured
1 PROVENANCE Kripke presents it as 'WITTGENSTEIN'S ARGUMENT AS IT STRUCK
KRIPKE', not as exegesis. Scholarly shorthand: KRIPKENSTEIN.
2 THE OPPOSING READING BAKER and HACKER, and McDOWELL from another
direction: 201 calls the paradox a MISUNDERSTANDING and supplies a THIRD
PART that the reconstruction under-weights. The text DISSOLVES; it does not
concede.
3 THE RULING PHILOSOPHICALLY VALUABLE - it shows sharply why neither
INTERPRETATION nor DISPOSITION fixes normativity. EXEGETICALLY DOUBTFUL - a
sceptical SOLUTION is precisely the constructive theory 128 and 133 forbid.
OPTIONAL ONLY the plus/quus reconstruction and the sceptical-solution debate.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 27/33: THE PRIVATE-LANGUAGE TARGET - PI 243 AND FOUR NON-TARGETS

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PI 243 FIRST SETS ASIDE THE CASE THAT IS NOT AT ISSUE
human beings who speak ONLY IN MONOLOGUE - a researcher COULD learn their
language, because it accompanies their ordinary activities.
        |
        v
THEN THE REAL QUESTION
'But could we also imagine a language in which a person could WRITE DOWN or
GIVE VOCAL EXPRESSION to his INNER EXPERIENCES - his feelings, moods and the
rest - FOR HIS PRIVATE USE?'
'The individual words of this language are to REFER TO WHAT CAN ONLY BE KNOWN
TO THE PERSON SPEAKING; TO HIS IMMEDIATE PRIVATE SENSATIONS. So ANOTHER
PERSON CANNOT UNDERSTAND THE LANGUAGE.'
FOUR NON-TARGETS - each refutable by example in one sentence
X A SECRET CODE ..... an ENCRYPTED PUBLIC language, decipherable IN
PRINCIPLE; its words already have public meanings
X TALKING TO ONESELF .... ordinary use of a public language, performed alone
X PRIVATE THOUGHTS ..... never denied; 304 protects them explicitly
X PHYSICAL SOLITUDE ..... a solitary speaker may use PUBLIC-TYPE criteria:
stable techniques, repeatable circumstances
WHY THIS PARAGRAPH IS WORTH HALF THE MARKS a script that attacks a code has
answered a question that was not asked.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 28/33: THE DIARY - PI 258, 260, 265, 270

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SET-UP (258) 'I want to keep a DIARY about the recurrence of a certain
SENSATION. To this end I associate it with the sign "S" and write this sign in
a calendar for every day on which I have the sensation.'
STEP 1 no definition can be formulated - 'but still I can give myself a kind
of OSTENSIVE DEFINITION', by concentrating my attention and, as it

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were, POINTING INWARDLY

STEP 2 what does the ceremony achieve? 'It serves to establish the connexion between the sign and the sensation' - but 'I impress it on myself' can only mean: this process brings it about that I REMEMBER THE CONNEXION RIGHT IN FUTURE

STEP 3 'AND HERE WE HAVE NO CRITERION OF CORRECTNESS. One would like to say: WHATEVER IS GOING TO SEEM RIGHT TO ME IS RIGHT. And that only means that HERE WE CAN'T TALK ABOUT "RIGHT".'

260 'Well, I BELIEVE that this is the sensation S again.' - Perhaps you BELIEVE THAT YOU BELIEVE it.

265 the memory-check compared to buying SEVERAL COPIES OF THE MORNING PAPER to assure oneself that what it says is true; a table existing only in the imagination is NOT a table; 'justification consists in appealing to something INDEPENDENT'.

270 THE MANOMETER VARIANT suppose writing 'S' coincides with a rise in blood pressure a manometer registers. NOW THE SIGN HAS A USE - and note that WHETHER I IDENTIFIED THE SENSATION RIGHTLY HAS BECOME IRRELEVANT.

NOT AN ARGUMENT FROM FALLIBLE MEMORY the claim is that there is NOTHING HERE FOR MEMORY TO BE RELIABLE ABOUT. WHAT COLLAPSES IS 'RIGHT', NOT 'S'.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 29/33: THE BEETLE, THE FIVE-STEP CORE, AND WHAT SURVIVES

PI 293 'Suppose everyone had A BOX with something in it: we call it a "BEETLE". No one can look into anyone else's box, and everyone says he knows what a beetle is ONLY BY LOOKING AT HIS BEETLE.'

* the thing might be DIFFERENT in each box * it might be CONSTANTLY CHANGING

* THE BOX MIGHT BE EMPTY

CONCLUSION 'IF WE CONSTRUE THE GRAMMAR OF THE EXPRESSION OF SENSATION ON THE MODEL OF "OBJECT AND DESIGNATION" THE OBJECT DROPS OUT OF CONSIDERATION AS IRRELEVANT.' <- EXPRESSLY CONDITIONAL. The beetle attacks A MODEL.

ORDER OF ARGUMENT the DIARY carries the argument; the BEETLE removes a residual temptation about SHARED words. Leading with the beetle reverses the order.

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v

THE FIVE-STEP CORE - WRITE IT AS A NUMBERED ARGUMENT

- 1 A meaningful sign requires a RULE OF USE.
- 2 A rule requires a CRITERION OF CORRECTNESS independent of present seeming. [202]
- 3 A purely private 'rule' has NO such criterion: the only check is a further seeming of the same kind. [258, 265]
- 4 Therefore 'correct' and 'seems correct' COINCIDE - and where they coincide, 'correct' HAS NO APPLICATION. [258]
- 5 Therefore no rule, no meaning, NO PRIVATE LANGUAGE.

WHAT SURVIVES sensations (304) | the solitary speaker (public-TYPE criteria) | the first/third-person asymmetry (244, 246) | the inner life as describable (580)

WHAT IS CONTESTED the memory objection | actual community vs shareable standards | whether criterial grammar respects felt phenomenology

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 30/33: CRITERIA, SYMPTOMS, PI 580 AND THE AVOWAL

SOURCE the BLUE BOOK, DICTATED 1933-35, PUBLISHED 1958. Say 'in the Blue Book'.

CRITERION (Kriterium)	SYMPTOM (Symptom)
INTERNAL / GRAMMATICAL - part of what it IS for the concept to apply; taught with the word	EXTERNAL / INDUCTIVE - a correlation experience has taught us
established BY THE GRAMMAR of the game	established BY EMPIRICAL INVESTIGATION
if it failed we would no longer know	if it failed we would merely revise a
what the word MEANS	generalisation

ANGINA the BACILLUS in the blood, which we have DEFINED as the criterion the INFLAMED THROAT, which experience has taught us usually goes with it

PAIN criterion = PAIN-BEHAVIOUR IN APPROPRIATE CIRCUMSTANCES
symptom = a raised pulse, sweating, a groan produced by an ACTOR

PI 580 'AN "INNER PROCESS" STANDS IN NEED OF OUTWARD CRITERIA.'

- 1 to possess a concept is to master a technique of applying a word rightly and wrongly [143-202]
- 2 mastery requires circumstances in which application is right and wrong
- 3 for an 'inner' concept those circumstances CANNOT BE FURTHER INNER ITEMS - that restarts 258 one level down [258]
- 4 therefore they must be OUTWARD: behaviour, situation, what precedes and follows - the SURROUNDINGS (Umgebung) of the utterance
- 5 therefore 580.

PI 244 adults TEACH THE CHILD NEW PAIN-BEHAVIOUR: 'THE VERBAL EXPRESSION OF PAIN REPLACES CRYING AND DOES NOT DESCRIBE IT' -> AVOWAL (Aeusserung)

PI 246 'only I can know whether I am really in pain' is FALSE in one way (others often do know) and NONSENSE in another - it can be said of me only AS A JOKE that I KNOW I am in pain. CAUTION: not every first-person psychological

sentence is an avowal; 'I was frightened last Tuesday' is a REPORT.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 31/33: THE BEHAVIOURISM CHARGE, THE FOUR-MOVE REPLY, AND PI 354

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THE CHARGE, RAISED BY WITTGENSTEIN AGAINST HIMSELF 307-308

'Aren't you at bottom really saying that EVERYTHING EXCEPT HUMAN BEHAVIOUR IS A FICTION?' - 'If I do speak of a fiction, then it is of a GRAMMATICAL FICTION.'

THE REPLY IN FOUR MOVES

1 THE DENIAL IS OF A PICTURE, NOT A PHENOMENON 304

'It is NOT A SOMETHING, BUT NOT A NOTHING EITHER! The conclusion was only that A NOTHING WOULD SERVE JUST AS WELL AS A SOMETHING ABOUT WHICH NOTHING COULD BE SAID.' What is rejected is the INNER-OBJECT MODEL - not pain, joy or memory.

2 THE FIRST FALSE STEP 308

We begin by talking innocently of mental 'processes and states', leaving their nature undecided - 'and now the analogy which was to make us understand our thoughts falls to pieces ... THE DECISIVE MOVEMENT IN THE CONJURING TRICK HAS BEEN MADE, AND IT WAS THE VERY ONE THAT WE THOUGHT QUITE INNOCENT.'

3 CRITERIA ARE NOT DEFINITIONS

Because criteria are DEFEASIBLE, 'he is in pain' is NOT EQUIVALENT to any statement about behaviour. THE BEHAVIOURIST ASSERTS AN EQUIVALENCE; WITTGENSTEIN ASSERTS A GRAMMATICAL DEPENDENCE. Stating that difference is what the examiner is looking for. Pretence is not a counter-example - it is a possibility the account PREDICTS.

4 THE FIRST/THIRD-PERSON ASYMMETRY 244, 246

first person = AVOWAL; third person = BEHAVIOURAL AND SITUATIONAL CRITERIA.

PI 354 'THE FLUCTUATION IN GRAMMAR BETWEEN CRITERIA AND SYMPTOMS MAKES IT LOOK AS IF THERE WERE NOTHING AT ALL BUT SYMPTOMS.'

READING A candour about how concepts work | READING B the firewall is local

RECOMMENDED A, conceding that the firewall is secured CASE BY CASE.

VERDICT ANTI-CARTESIAN WITHOUT BEING A REDUCTIVE BEHAVIOURIST.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 32/33: SOLIPSISM, THERAPY AND THE ENRICHMENT FENCE

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SOLIPSISM EARLY (Tractatus 5.6 / 5.62 / 5.64): limits of MY language = limits of MY world | what the solipsist MEANS is correct but CANNOT BE SAID | strictly carried out it COINCIDES WITH PURE REALISM. Mechanism: SAYING and SHOWING. LATER: the ROUTE CHANGES - from the LIMIT of language to the GRAMMAR of his words. THE DILEMMA: either his terms are fixed by PRESENT SEEMING -> 258, no rule, NOTHING STATED; or by STABLE REPEATABLE TECHNIQUES -> he has CONCEDED the public-type practice he denies. VERDICT: SELF-UNDERMINING - a DISSOLUTION, NOT A REFUTATION. NOT PROVED: other minds | the external world | that solitude is impossible. 303 'try - in a real case - to doubt someone else's pain'.

THERAPY 38 language IDLES (wenn die Sprache feiert) | 109 battle against the BEWITCHMENT of our intelligence | 115 A PICTURE HELD US CAPTIVE, and it LAY IN OUR LANGUAGE | 122 PERSPICUOUS REPRESENTATION -> SEEING CONNECTIONS, find and INVENT intermediate cases | 123 'I DON'T KNOW MY WAY ABOUT' | 127 ASSEMBLE REMINDERS | 128 theses would be UNDEBATABLE | 129 hidden by SIMPLICITY AND FAMILIARITY | 133 METHODS, LIKE DIFFERENT THERAPIES; the real discovery lets one STOP | 255 treatment of an ILLNESS | 309 SHOW THE FLY THE WAY OUT OF THE FLY-BOTTLE | 124 'leaves everything as it is' - BOUNDED BY ITS FIRST CLAUSE to THE USE OF LANGUAGE.

ENRICHMENT FENCE ASPECT-SEEING (Part II xi / PPF; figure JASTROW 1899; 'I see that it has not changed; AND YET I SEE IT DIFFERENTLY'; the DAWNING OF AN ASPECT; ASPECT-BLINDNESS ties it to the EXPERIENCE OF MEANING) and ON CERTAINTY (notes 1949-51, published 1969, UNREVISED; answers MOORE; HINGE propositions) are ENRICHMENT. BUDGET: 10 marks NONE | 15 marks ONE SENTENCE | 20 marks TWO.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 33/33: THE CRITICISM LEDGER, THE PYQ ROUTING AND THE ANSWER SPINE

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CRITICISM LEDGER, RANKED 1 SELF-APPLICATION (133's plural; inherited from 6.54)

2 NORMATIVITY OF USE (hard cases remain) 3 KRIPKE (valuable, doubtful)

4 QUIETISM (bounded; discipline narrowed) 5 BEHAVIOURISM (defeasible criteria; 354 fluctuates) 6 RELATIVISM (241; no adjudication theory) 7 CRUSOE (logical privacy; community disputed) 8 CIRCULARITY (mistake distinguishes practice).

PYQ ROUTING, 7 OWNED PARTS

2018 Q1(c) 10 family resemblance upholding 'Language is a game'

2019 Q3(b) 15 solipsism CULMINATING in the private-language critique

2020 Q4(c) 15 the 243 question itself - 'for his private use?'

2022 Q1(c) 10 'MOTION of language as form of life' - PRINTED WORD RETAINED

2023 Q4(c) 15 reasons for the shift from picture-theory to use-theory

2024 Q1(d) 10 why there cannot be an essentially private language

2025 Q3(a) 20 the transition - UNMATCHED OPENING QUOTATION RETAINED

2021 owns NOTHING here; its Wittgenstein part belongs to TOPIC 06.

ANSWER SPINE, ALL LENGTHS state the CHANGE OF QUESTION -> give the LIMB with its exact texts -> give the SUPPORT that makes it executable -> name the OBJECTION and its RESIDUE -> close with a DEFENDED RULING.
CLOSING LINE Everyone else was hunting the hidden thing; he was explaining why the hunt felt compulsory.